DEPARTMENT OF WAR
Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) Program

2026 SBIR Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO)

IMPORTANT DATES

	Pre-Release	Open	Close
Release 1	Apr 13, 2026	May 06, 2026	Jun 03, 2026
Release 2	May 06, 2026	May 27, 2026	Jun 24, 2026
Release 3	Jun 03, 2026	Jun 24, 2026	Jul 22, 2026
Release 4	Jul 01, 2026	Jul 22, 2026	Aug 19, 2026
Release 5	Aug 05, 2026	Aug 26, 2026	Sep 23, 2026
Release 6	Sep 02, 2026	Sep 23, 2026	Oct 21, 2026

NOTE: DoW Services and Components may elect to release topics under this CSO once a month throughout fiscal year 2026. New research topics will pre-release on the first Wednesday of each month, based on the schedule above. Each release will have corresponding open and close dates applicable only to those topics within the release. If a topic in a release deviates from the open and close dates listed above, it will be noted within the Component-specific instructions and on DSIP.

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1.0 PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

1.1 Introduction

The Department of War (DoW) Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) Program's objectives include stimulating technological innovation by strengthening the role of small businesses in meeting DoW research and development (R&D) needs, delivering innovative technology to the Warfighter, and growing the defense industrial base through commercialization. The Small Business Administration (SBA), through its SBIR/Small Business Technology Transfer (STTR) Policy Directive, purposely departs from traditional government solicitation formats and requirements, simplifying the SBIR/STTR award process and minimizing the regulatory burden on small businesses. Consistent with the SBA SBIR/STTR Policy Directive, DoW is soliciting proposals as a Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO).

This CSO is authorized by 10 United States Code (U.S.C.) §3458 and implemented by Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) Subpart 212.70, *Defense Commercial Solutions Opening*. The guidelines in this CSO incorporate and make use of the SBA SBIR/STTR Policy Directive's flexibility to encourage scientific and technical proposals most likely to yield significant results for DoW and the private sector; and incorporate the required procedures listed in DFARS 212.70.

1.1.1 General CSO Procedures

This CSO permits the DoW to acquire the full spectrum of Research and Development (R&D) authorized under Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Part 35 and DFARS Part 235, enabling the DoW to pursue solutions that extend beyond early-stage research and are ready for prototype, demonstration, or system-level application. Unlike Broad Agency Announcements (BAA), which are typically limited to basic and applied research, this CSO allows for the direct acquisition of technologies tied to specific program requirements or end-user needs, accelerating fielding and transition opportunities.

This CSO may include broadly defined topics, as well as more specific, individual program requirements. Topics are intentionally non-prescriptive and structured to accommodate varied technical and scientific approaches, encouraging novel solutions that align with DoW modernization goals and to attract innovative applications of commercial technologies or emerging capabilities that may not fit traditional acquisition strategies. The DoW encourages eligible Small Business Concerns (SBCs), including non-traditional defense contractors, to submit proposals aligned with the technical areas and capability needs described in the release topics. Proposals should be responsive to the specific problem statement(s) and area(s) of interest outlined in the release topics.

To support DoW modernization goals, the department intends to obtain new, innovative solutions that:

- **Fulfill Requirements**: Provide solutions that meet DoW needs outlined in the released topic.
- **Bridge Capability Gaps**: Address unmet needs through new capabilities or offer innovative advancements that improve mission effectiveness.
- **Advance Technology in Novel Ways**: Present technically or scientifically distinct approaches concepts that are expected to yield meaningful and innovative solutions to the DoW's stated needs.

1.1.2 Acquisition Framework

The CSO streamlines the acquisition process by utilizing FAR Part 12 procedures. Technologies, processes or methods procured under this CSO shall be treated as commercial items, i.e. commercial products or commercial services, as defined in FAR 2.101, without requiring them to be pre-existing or

commercially available off-the-shelf. Rather, eligible solutions may include early commercial offerings, as well as concept demonstrations, pilots, and agile development activities that enhance commercial technologies, or improve existing Government-owned capabilities and concepts for broad defense application(s).

This CSO is for research topics accepting Phase I or Direct to Phase II proposals. A separate CSO will not be issued requesting Phase II proposals. All proposing SBCs that receive a Phase I award from this CSO will be eligible to participate in Phase II competitions and potential Phase III awards. DoW Services/Components will notify Phase I awardees of the Phase II proposal submission requirements.

The DoW intends to award Firm-Fixed-Price contracts under FAR Part 12 and may utilize other appropriate FAR parts (e.g., Part 13, 15, and/or 35). Depending on the nature of the proposed effort, and the statutory authority available, the Government retains the flexibility to award cooperative agreements or Other Transactions (OTs) under this solicitation. An award may be executed pursuant to 10 U.S.C. 4021 (Research Projects) or 10 U.S.C. 4022 (Prototype Projects). Follow-on production OTs may also be awarded in accordance with 10 U.S.C. 4022(f) if the statutory conditions are met. Separately, awards may also be made under 10 U.S.C. 4023 (Procurement for Experimental Purposes), when appropriate.

Multiple procurements are planned and anticipated to be awarded for each topic. Each proposal will be evaluated independently, and funding decisions will be made without regard to other submissions. DoW Services/Components may elect to fund several or none of the proposals received in response to a given topic. All awards are subject to both a risk-based due diligence security review and availability of funds, and the DoW is under no obligation to make any Phase I or Direct to Phase II awards under this CSO. Offerors are solely responsible for all costs incurred in the preparation and submission of proposals. The DoW will not reimburse any expenses related to proposal development or pre-award activities. This CSO is not a mechanism for submitting unsolicited proposals, and unsolicited proposals will not be considered nor receive a response. Only proposals that are responsive to a posted topic release will be considered.

The instructions contained in this CSO are applicable to all topic releases. Each release will have corresponding open and close dates applicable only to those topics contained within the release. Additional instructions specific to an individual topic release will be contained within the component-specific instructions. All proposals submitted in response to any topic posted under this solicitation will be governed by this CSO. Proposals must conform to this announcement's terms.

1.1.3 Funding Restrictions and Allowable Activities under this SBIR CSO

Consistent with CSO procedures, allowable activities under this solicitation must align with the requirement for innovative solutions established in section 1.1.2, above. Accordingly, SBIR/STTR funds may not be used for the purchase of existing items or services but may support efforts where such items are integral to a broader innovative approach. The following guidance outlines restrictions on the use of SBIR/STTR funds and clarifies when activities such as the purchase or modification of Commercial Off-the-Shelf (COTS) or Non-Developmental Items (NDI) may be considered allowable.

- Items purchased directly from a commercial source that can be utilized without alteration through design and development, or without modification, are classified as COTS or NDI. Examples include ready-to-use products, training services, and software licenses for ready-to-use software (including Software as a Service (SaaS)). Procurement of such items is not allowable under SBIR/STTR funding. However, if a COTS or NDI item is required for research, development, test and evaluation (RDT&E) purposes, the associated cost may be allowable. In addition, if an end item requires design and development to integrate the COTS or NDI, the design and development effort may be funded with SBIR/STTR dollars.

- Commercially available items that must be modified to satisfy DoW requirements are considered "modified COTS" or "modified NDI." For purposes of this CSO, a modification refers to a change that significantly alters the end item's performance envelope to meet user requirements and is distinct from routine maintenance or continuous technology refreshment. In these cases, SBIR/STTR funds may support the purchase of an initial item, the engineering and development necessary to perform the modification, and testing required to validate its performance. Modified COTS and NDI are treated as developmental items for purposes of SBIR/STTR funding, and associated costs may be allowable when testing is required to demonstrate performance prior to approval for service use or inventory. However, follow-on purchases of additional COTS or NDI units for production or sustainment are not allowable, and the number of modified COTS or NDI funded will not exceed what is necessary to conduct RDT&E acceptance testing.

- Finally, continuous technology refreshment, such as inserting newer technology during depot or field level maintenance to improve reliability, reduce cost, and/or add minor performance enhancements, is considered a sustainment activity is not allowable under SBIR/STTR funds.

1.2 A Three Phased Program

The SBIR Program has three phases, Phases I, II, and III. Phase I determines, to the extent possible, an idea's scientific, technical, and commercial merit and feasibility within the SBIR program. Phase I and II awards are made adhering to current SBA Policy Directive guidelines.

The Phase I period of performance is generally between six to twelve months. Proposals should focus on Research or Research & Development (R/R&D) to prove the proposed effort's scientific and technical feasibility, and commercialization potential, the successful completion of which is a prerequisite for further DoW support in Phase II. Proposing SBCs are encouraged to consider whether the research or R&D being proposed to DoW Services/Components also has private sector potential, either for the proposed application or as a base for other applications.

Phase II awards will be made to proposing SBCs based on results of Phase I awards and the Phase II proposal's scientific merit, technical merit, and commercialization potential. The period of performance is generally 24 months. The objective of Phase II is to continue and further develop the R/R&D effort from the completed Phase I award.

Phase III refers to work that derives from, extends, or completes an effort made under prior SBIR funding agreements, but is funded by sources other than the SBIR Program. Under Phase III, the SBC should focus on commercializing previously SBIR-funded technology and is required to obtain funding from either the private sector, a non-SBIR federal source, or both, to develop the prototype into a viable product or non-R&D service for sale in military or private sector markets.

1.3 OUSW(R&E) Critical Technology Areas

Although each DoW Service/Component develops SBIR and STTR topics tailored to their mission needs, topics may also align with the Office of the Under Secretary of Defense, Research & Engineering (OUSW(R&E)) Critical Technology Areas (CTAs). While many technologies may cross between these categories, these areas represent the broad and different approaches required to advance technologies crucial to the Department, with a focus on accelerating key capabilities' transitions to the Military Services and Combatant Commands.

OUSW(R&E) CTAs include:

- Applied Artificial Intelligence (AAI)
- Biomanufacturing (BIO)
- Contested Logistics Technologies (LOG)

- Quantum & Battlefield Information Dominance (QBID)
- Scaled Hypersonics (SHY)
- Scaled Directed Energy (SCADE)

Full descriptions of the OUSW (R&E) CTAs can be viewed here.

Below are additional Component Technology Priority Areas (TPAs) supporting DoW Services/Component-specific mission-critical areas:

- FutureG
- Trusted AI and Autonomy
- Biotechnology
- Advanced Computing and Software
- Integrated Sensing and Cyber
- Directed Energy (DE)
- Hypersonics
- Microelectronics
- Integrated Network Systems-of-Systems
- Quantum Science
- Space Technology
- Renewable Energy Generation and Storage
- Advanced Materials
- Human-Machine Interfaces
- Advanced Infrastructure & Advanced Manufacturing
- Combat Casualty Care
- Emerging Threat Reduction
- Military Infectious Diseases
- Military Operational Medicine
- Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness
- Nuclear
- Sustainment & Logistics

Full descriptions of the above TPAs can be reviewed here.

1.4 Eligibility and Performance Requirements

Each proposing entity must qualify as an SBC as defined in 13 C.F.R §§ 701-705 at time of award and certify to this in the proposal's cover sheet. The eligibility requirements for the SBIR/STTR programs are unique and do not correspond to those of other small business programs.

a. Proposing SBC must meet eligibility requirements for Small Business Ownership and Control (see 13 CFR § 121.702).
b. The proposing SBC must conduct a minimum of two-thirds of the Phase I research and/or analytical work. For Phase II, the proposing SBC must perform no less than 50 percent of the research and/or analytical work. The work percentage is measured via direct and indirect costs. Occasionally, deviations from these SBIR requirements may occur with the Funding Agreement officer's written approval after consultation with the agency SBIR/STTR program manager/coordinator. For more information on the percentage of work calculation during proposal submission, refer to section 3.7.
c. For both Phase I and II, the principal investigator's primary employment must be with the proposing SBC at the time of the award and during the conduct of the proposed effort. Primary employment means that more than one-half of the principal investigator's time is spent with the small business (based on a 40-hour work week). Primary employment with an SBC precludes full-time employment at another organization. Deviations from this requirement or changes to the principal investigator are subject to the Funding Agreement officer approval.
d. For both Phase I and Phase II, the SBC and its subcontractors must perform all research or R&D work in the United States.
e. Joint ventures and limited partnerships are permitted, provided that the entity qualifies as small business in accordance with the ownership requirements in 13 CFR 121.702(a)(1)(iii) and the size requirements in 13 CFR 121.702(c)(6). Proposing SBC must disclose joint ventures with existing

(or planned) relationships/partnerships with any foreign entity or any foreign government-controlled companies. See sections 2.6 and 3.7 for more detail.

1.5 Majority Ownership in Part by Multiple Venture Capital, Hedge Fund, and Private Equity Firms

Unless otherwise noted in the participating Service/Component instructions, proposing SBCs that are multiple venture capital operating companies (VCOCs), hedge funds, or private equity funds majority owned are **ineligible** to submit applications to or receive awards under this solicitation. If a Service/Component authorizes such participation, any proposing VCOC, hedge fund, and/or private equity fund-owned SBC, whether in part or in whole, must identify each foreign national, foreign entity, or foreign government holding or controlling greater than a 5 percent, either directly or indirectly held, equity stake in the proposing SBC. The proposing SBC must also identify any ultimate parent owner(s) and other entities and/or individuals owning more than a 5 percent equity stake in its ownership chain.

In accordance with the requirements of 13 CFR 121.702(a)(2), no single venture capital operating company, hedge fund, or private equity firm may own more than 50 percent of the concern unless that single venture capital operating company, hedge fund, or private equity firm qualifies as an SBC that is more than 50 percent directly owned and controlled by individuals who are citizens or permanent resident aliens of the United States.

1.6 Performance Benchmark Requirements/Increased Minimum Performance Standards for Experienced Firms

Proposing SBCs with multiple prior SBIR/STTR awards must meet minimum performance requirements to be eligible to apply for a new Phase I or Direct-to-Phase II award. The Phase I to Phase II Transition Rate addresses the extent to which an awardee progresses a project from Phase I to Phase II. The Commercialization Benchmark addresses the extent to which an awardee has moved past Phase II work towards commercialization.

The SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 (Pub. L. 117-183) amended the benchmarks' application for more experienced firms. Find detailed information on benchmark calculations, increased performance standards for more experienced firms and consequence of failure to meet benchmarks here. SBA will notify companies failing either benchmark and the relevant officials at the participating agencies.

The SBIR/STTR Policy Directive defines the Departments of the Army, Navy, and Air Force each as its own federal agency, and the remaining DoW Components as an executive agency of the Department of War. Therefore, companies that fail to meet either of the benchmarks under the Increased Performance Standards for More Experienced Firms may not receive more than an overall total of 80 awards from DoW, as detailed in the breakdown below:

Army – 20 total Phase I and Direct to Phase II awards
Navy – 20 total Phase I and Direct to Phase II awards
Air Force – 20 total Phase I and Direct to Phase II awards
All other DoW Components combined – 20 total Phase I and Direct to Phase II awards

1.7 Direct to Phase II Program

15 U.S.C. §638(cc), as amended by NDAA FY2012, Sec. 5106, and further amended by NDAA FY2019,Sec. 854, PILOT TO ALLOW PHASE FLEXIBILITY, allows DoW to make a SBIR Phase II award to an SBC with respect to a project, without regard to whether the SBC was provided a SBIR program Phase I award with respect to such project. DoW does not guarantee Direct to Phase II

opportunities will be offered in future solicitations.

Each eligible topic requires proposing SBCs provide documentation to demonstrate feasibility described in the Phase I section of the topic has been met. **Feasibility documentation cannot be based solely upon or logically extend from any prior or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR work.** The proposing SBC and/or the principal investigator must have substantially performed the work submitted in the feasibility documentation. The proposing SBC must demonstrate ownership or licensure of any intellectual property (IP) associated with such technology prior to proposal submission to enable it and its subcontractors to legally carry out the proposed work.

If the proposing SBC fails to demonstrate technical merit and feasibility equivalent to the Phase I level as described in the associated topic, the related Phase II proposal will not be accepted or evaluated, in accordance with the Service/Component-specific Direct to Phase II instructions.

Refer to the Service/Component-specific Direct to Phase II instructions for full details regarding Service/Component Direct to Phase II processes and proposal preparation requirements.

1.8 Program on Innovation Open Topics

15 U.S.C. §638 (ww) requires DoW establish innovation open topic activities to:

a. increase the transition of commercial technology to the DoW;
b. expand the small business nontraditional industrial base;
c. increase commercialization derived from DoW investments; and
d. expand the ability for qualifying SBCs to propose technology solutions to meet DoW needs.

Unlike conventional topics, which specify the desired technical objective and output, open topics use generalized mission requirements or specific technology areas to adapt commercial products or solutions to close capability gaps, improve performance, or provide technological advancements in existing capabilities.

Open topics released under this solicitation will be clearly identified as such in the title and topic objective. Proposal preparation instructions for open topics may vary significantly across DoW Services/Components. Proposing SBCs must carefully read and follow all instructions from the DoW Service/Component for the open topic of interest. Unless specifically noted in the Service/Component instructions, all requirements outlined in this solicitation remain in effect for open topics.

An SBC may only submit one proposal to each open topic. If an SBC submits more than one proposal for a single open topic, only the most recent certified proposal submitted prior to the submission deadline will receive an evaluation. All previously submitted proposals for the same open topic will be marked nonresponsive and will not receive an evaluation. Refer to the Service/Component-specific instructions for any additional requirements specific to open topics.

1.9 Discretionary Technical and Business Assistance (TABA)

DoW has not mandated the use of discretionary technical and business assistance (TABA). The proposing SBCs should review individual Service/Component-specific instructions to determine if TABA is offered by the Service/Component and follow instructions for requesting TABA funding.

1.10 Phase II Enhancement Policy

To further encourage the transition of SBIR research into both DoW acquisition programs and the private sector, certain DoW Services/Components developed their own Phase II Enhancement policies. Under this policy, the Service/Component will provide a Phase II awardee with additional Phase II SBIR

funding if the proposing SBC can match the additional SBIR funds with non-SBIR funds from DoW acquisition programs or the private sector.

See Service/Component instructions for more details on Phase II Enhancement opportunities.

1.11 Commercialization Readiness Program (CRP)

The SBIR/STTR Reauthorization Act of 2011 established the Commercialization Pilot Program (CPP) as a long-term program called the Commercialization Readiness Program (CRP). Each Military Department (Army, Navy, and Air Force) has a CRP; refer to the Service/Component instructions for further information.

The DoW SBIR/STTR Program has established the OSW Accelerated Research for Transition (ART) for purposes of technology maturation and transfer. For more information contact osd.ncr.ousd-r-e.mbx.sbir-sttr-tech-transition@mail.mil.

1.12 State and Other Available Assistance

Many states have established programs to provide services to those proposing SBCs and individuals wishing to participate in the Federal SBIR Program. These services vary from state to state, but may include:

a. Information and technical assistance;
b. Matching funds to SBIR recipients;
c. Assistance in obtaining Phase III funding.

Contact your State SBIR/STTR Support office for further information. SBCs may seek general administrative guidance from small and disadvantaged business utilization specialists located in various defense contract management activities throughout the continental United States.

1.13 Fraud and Fraud Reporting

Knowingly and willfully making any false, fictitious, or fraudulent statements or representations may be a felony under the Federal Criminal False Statement Act (18 U.S.C. Sec 1001), punishable by a fine of up to $10,000, up to five years in prison, or both.

The DoW Office of Inspector General Hotline ("Defense Hotline") is an important avenue for reporting fraud, waste, abuse, and mismanagement within the DoW. The Office of Inspector General operates this hotline to receive and investigate complaints or information from contractor employees, DoW civilians, Service members, and the public. Individuals who wish to report fraud, waste or abuse may contact the Defense Hotline at (800) 424-9098 between 8:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. Eastern Time or visit their website to submit a complaint. Mailed correspondence should be addressed to the Defense Hotline, The Pentagon, Washington, DC 20301-1900, or email addressed to hotline@dodig.mil.

2.0 CERTIFICATIONS AND REGISTRATIONS

2.1 System for Award Management (SAM) Registration

The System for Award Management (SAM) allows proposing SBCs to provide basic information on business structure, capabilities, and financial and payment information with the Federal Government. Proposing SBCs must register in SAM here. Registration in SAM will generate the Unique Entity ID (UEI) number and the Commercial and Government Entry (CAGE) code. The UEI is required for registration in the U.S. Small Business Administration's (SBA) Company Registry. A proposing SBC that is already registered in SAM should verify the registration is active, and its representations and certifications are current to avoid award delay.

2.2 SBA Company Registry

Proposing SBCs must be registered in the SBA Company Registry. SBCs will be required to verify registration by providing the SBC Control ID and Proof of Registration/Certification during proposal submission.

2.3 Defense SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP) Registration

Individuals from proposing SBCs must be registered in the DSIP to prepare and submit proposals. Proposing SBCs submitting through this site for the first time will be asked to register. All users are required to have an individual user account to access DSIP. It is recommended proposing SBCs register as soon as possible upon identification of a proposal opportunity to avoid delays in the proposal submission process.

DSIP user accounts are authenticated by Login.gov. Users who do not already have a Login.gov account will be required to create one. Users who already have a Login.gov account can link their existing Login.gov account with their DSIP account. Job Aids and Help Videos to walk you through the process are in the Learning & Support section of DSIP.

Be advised the sharing of accounts and passwords is a violation of the Terms of Use for Login.gov and DoW policy.

Registered SBCs will have a designated DSIP Firm Admin responsible for creating the Firm PIN, controlling access for other users in the SBC and completing and maintaining the Firm-level forms, which must be completed before any proposals can be submitted.

Users should complete their account registrations as soon as possible to avoid any delays in proposal submissions.

NOTE: The DSIP application is only accessible from within the United States, which is defined as the fifty states, the territories and possessions of the Federal Government, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, the Republic of the Marshall Islands, the Federated States of Micronesia, the Republic of Palau, and the District of Columbia.

2.3.1 DSIP Assistance and Support

For assistance with the DSIP application, please visit the Learning & Support section of DSIP. Email DSIP Support at DoDSBIRSupport@reisystems.com only for further assistance with issues pertaining directly to the DSIP application. Questions submitted to DSIP Support will be addressed in the order received during normal operating hours (Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. ET). Please include information on your SBC, a proposal number (if applicable), and screenshots of any pertinent errors or issues encountered.

DSIP Support cannot provide updates to proposal status after submission, such as proposal selection/non-selection status or contract award status. Contact the DoW Service/Component that originated the topic following the Service/Component-specific instructions given at the beginning of that Service/Component-specific instructions.

2.4 Required Certifications

At the time of proposal submission, each SBC must certify via the Cover Sheet of the proposal that it meets the size, ownership, and other requirements of the SBIR Program. In addition, the Policy Directive includes certification requirements set forth in the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 (Public Law

117-183). SBCs are required to certify that they are meeting the Program's requirements during the life cycle of the funding agreement: at the time of the Phase I and Phase II award, prior to final payment on the Phase I award, prior to receiving 50 percent of the total Phase II award amount, and prior to final payment on the Phase II award.

2.5 Due Diligence Program to Assess Security Risks

15 U.S.C. §638(vv) requires the DoW, in coordination with the SBA, to establish and implement a due diligence program to assess and, when possible, mitigate national security risks from SBCs seeking a federally funded award. The Department will use the proposal and information in response to the "Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries" (proposal submission Volume 7) to conduct a risk-based due diligence review of the following areas: cybersecurity practices; patent analysis; employee analysis and foreign ownership, including the SBC's financial ties and obligations (which shall include surety, equity, and debt obligations); and SBC employees' ties to a foreign country, foreign person, or foreign entity. Disclosure of foreign affiliations or relationships on this form does not mean denial. The Department will also assess proposals utilizing open-source analysis and analytical tools, for the purpose of confirming the accuracy of the information provided as well as determining if the proposing SBC failed to disclose the information set forth in 15 U.S.C. 638(g)(13).

After reviewing the proposing SBC's responses to the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries, if DoW determines it appropriate the Department may ask the SBC to provide true copies of any contractual or financial obligation or other agreement specific to a business arrangement or joint-venture like arrangement with an enterprise owned by a foreign state or any foreign entity in effect during the five-year period preceding the SBC's proposal submission.

The DoW may not make awards that pose unacceptable security risks pursuant to 15 U.S.C. §638(vv). If the risk-based due diligence review concludes that an SBC should not be eligible for the specific SBIR or STTR award due to a national security risk that cannot be adequately mitigated, the proposal will not receive consideration for possible award regardless of the results of the technical review of the proposal. Attachment 2: Defense SBIR and STTR Due Diligence Program Common Risk Matrix of the memo titled "Defense Small Business Innovation Research and Small Business Technology Transfer Due Diligence Program", dated 13 May 2024, provides details on the factors for assessing SBC risk during the due diligence review.

2.6 Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) Program

DoW has established the Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) Program in order to verify contractors have implemented required security measures necessary to safeguard Federal Contract Information (FCI) and Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI). CMMC requirements will apply to all DoW solicitations and contracts for which a defense contractor or subcontractor will process, store, or transmit FCI or CUI on its unclassified contractor information systems. It is important to note that subcontractors are subject to flow-down requirements if the subcontractor will process, store, or transmit FCI or CUI on its unclassified contractor information systems.

The CMMC Program provides assessments at three levels, each incorporating security requirements from existing regulations and guidelines.

Level 1: Basic Safeguarding of FCI

- Requirements: Annual self-assessment and annual affirmation of compliance with the 15 security requirements in FAR clause 52.204-21.

Level 2: Broad Protection of CUI

- Requirements:
    1. Either a self-assessment or an independent assessment by an authorized CMMC Third-Party Assessment Organization (C3PAO) every three years, as specified in the

solicitation.
    - Determined by the type of information processed, transmitted, or stored on the contractor or subcontractor information systems.
2. Annual affirmation, verify compliance with the 110 security requirements in NIST SP 800-171 Revision 2.

Level 3: Higher-Level Protection of CUI Against Advanced Persistent Threats

- Requirements:
    1. Achieve CMMC Status of Final Level 2.
    2. Undergo an assessment every three years by the Defense Contract Management Agency's (DCMA) Defense Industrial Base Cybersecurity Assessment Center (DIBCAC).
    3. Provide an annual affirmation verifying compliance with the 24 identified requirements from NIST SP 800-172.

Projected CMMC level requirements will be identified within the respective topic. Proposers should carefully review and consider these updated requirements when preparing their proposals, as compliance may impact proposed costs and technical approaches. For additional CMMC information and resources visit https://dodcio.defense.gov/cmmc/About/.

2.6.1 Resources for Understanding FOCI & Cybersecurity Readiness

DoW has partnered with Project Spectrum to provide online resources and courses on Understanding Foreign Ownership, Control, or Influence (FOCI) and improving cybersecurity readiness, resiliency, and compliance as it relates to CMMC. SBCs can register and access these courses and resources at projectspectrum.io.

2.7 Joint Ventures

A small business joint venture entity must submit, with its proposal, the representation required in paragraph (c) of FAR solicitation provision 52.212-3, Offeror Representations and Certifications-Commercial Products and Commercial Services, and paragraph (c) of FAR provision 52.219-1, Small Business Program Representations, in accordance with 52.204-8(d) and 52.212-3(b) for the following categories:

a. Small business;
b. Service-disabled veteran-owned small business;
c. Women-owned small business (WOSB) under the WOSB Program;
d. Economically disadvantaged women-owned small business under the WOSB Program; or
e. Historically underutilized business zone small business.

These representations can be found here and must be uploaded to Volume 5, Supporting Documents of the proposal submission in DSIP, if applicable.

2.8 Conflicts of Interest

Contract awards to an SBC owned by or employing current, or previous, Federal Government employees could create conflicts of interest for those employees, which may be a violation of federal law.

2.9 Organizational Conflicts of Interest (OCI)

FAR 9.5 Requirements

In accordance with FAR 9.5, proposing SBCs are required to identify and disclose all facts relevant to potential organizational conflicts of interest (OCIs) involving the proposing SBC's organization and any proposed team member (sub-awardee, consultant). The proposing SBC is responsible for providing this disclosure with each submitted proposal. The disclosure must include the proposing SBC's, and as applicable, proposed team member's OCI mitigation plan. The OCI mitigation plan must include a

description of the actions the proposing SBC has taken, or intends to take, to prevent the existence of conflicting roles that might bias the proposing SBC's judgment, and to prevent the proposing SBC from having unfair competitive advantage. The OCI mitigation plan will specifically discuss the disclosed OCI in the context of each of the OCI limitations outlined in FAR 9.505-1 through FAR 9.505-4.

Agency Supplemental OCI Policy

DoW Services/Components also may have a supplemental OCI policy prohibiting contractors/performers from concurrently providing scientific engineering technical assistance (SETA), advisory and assistance services (A&AS), or similar support services, and being a technical performer. As part of the FAR 9.5 disclosure requirement, a proposing SBC must affirm whether the proposing SBC or any proposed team member (sub-awardee, consultant) is providing SETA, A&AS, or similar support to any DoW Service/Component office(s) under: (a) a current award or sub-award; or (b) a past award or sub-award that ended within one calendar year prior to the proposal's submission date. If SETA, A&AS, or similar support is or was provided to any DoW Service/Component office(s), the proposal must include:

a. The name of the DoW Service/Component office receiving the support;
b. The prime contract number;
c. Identification of proposed team member (sub-awardee, consultant) providing the support; and
d. An OCI mitigation plan in accordance with FAR 9.5.

Government Procedures

In accordance with FAR 9.503, 9.504 and 9.506, the Government will evaluate OCI mitigation plans to avoid, neutralize, or mitigate potential OCI issues before award and determine whether it is in the government's interest to grant a waiver. The U.S. Government will only evaluate OCI mitigation plans for proposals determined selectable under the solicitation evaluation criteria and funding availability.

The government may require proposing SBCs provide additional information to support evaluation of the proposing SBC's OCI mitigation plan.

If the government determines a proposer failed to fully disclose an OCI; or failed to provide a government waiver as described above; or failed to reasonably provide additional information the government requested when evaluating the proposer's OCI mitigation plan, the government may reject the proposal and withdraw it from consideration for award.

2.10 Research Involving Human Subjects/Human Subject Research (RIHS/HSR)

All research involving human subjects, to include use of human biological specimens and human data, shall comply with the applicable federal and state laws, and agency policy/guidelines for human subject protection (see Section 5.2 and Appendix B).

Institutions receiving funding for research involving human subjects must provide documentation of a current federal assurance of compliance with federal regulations for human subject protection; for example a Department of Health and Human Services, Office for Human Research Protections federal-wide assurance (http://www.hhs.gov/ohrp). The awarding DoW Service/Component may also request additional federal assurance documentation. All institutions engaged in human subject research, to include subcontractors, must also have a valid assurance. In addition, personnel involved in human subject research must provide documentation of completed appropriate training for the protection of human subjects. Institutions proposing to conduct human subject research that meets one of the exemption criteria in 32 CFR 219.101 are not required to have a federal assurance of compliance. Proposing SBCs should clearly segregate research activities involving human subjects from other R&D activities in their proposal.

If selected, institutions must also provide documentation of institutional review board (IRB) approval, or a determination from an appropriate official in the institution, that the work meets one of the exemption criteria with 32 CFR 219. As part of the IRB review process, evidence that all investigators are appropriately trained should accompany the protocol. The protocol, separate from the proposal, must include a detailed description of the research plan, study population, risks and benefits of study participation, recruitment and consent process, and data collection and analysis.

The amount of time required for the IRB to review and approve the protocol will vary based on the IRB's procedures, the complexity of the research, the level of risk to study participants and the responsiveness of the investigator. The average IRB approval process can last between one and three months. Once the IRB has approved the research, the awarding DoW Service/Component will review the protocol and the IRB's determination to ensure that the research will be conducted in compliance with both DoW and Service/Component policies. The DoW review process can last between three to six months. Ample time should be allotted to complete both the IRB and DoW approval processes prior to recruiting subjects. **No funding can be used towards human subject research until ALL approvals are granted. Submitters proposing research involving human and/or animal use are encouraged to separate these tasks in the technical proposal and cost proposal to avoid potential contract award delays.**

2.11 Research Involving Animal Subjects

All research, development, testing, experimentation, education, or training involving the use of animals shall comply with the applicable federal and agency rules on animal acquisition, transport, care, handling, and use (see Section 5.2 and Appendix B).

For submissions containing animal use, proposals should briefly describe plans for their institutional animal care and use committee (IACUC) review and approval.

All recipients must receive their IACUC's approval, as well as secondary or headquarters-level approval from a DoW veterinarian trained or experienced in laboratory animal medicine and science. **No animal research may be conducted using DoW funding until all appropriate DoW office(s) grant approval. Submitters proposing research involving human and/or animal use are encouraged to separate these tasks in the technical proposal and cost proposal to avoid potential contract award delays.**

2.12 Research Involving Recombinant DNA Molecules

All research involving recombinant DNA molecules shall comply with the applicable federal and state law, regulation, and additional agency guidance. An institutional biosafety committee must approve the research.

In addition to the standard federal and DoW procurement certifications, the SBA SBIR Policy Directive requires the proposing business concerns provide certain information at time of award and during the award life cycle. Each proposing SBC must provide this additional information at the time of the Phase I and Phase II award, prior to final payment on the Phase I award, prior to receiving 50 percent of the Phase II total award amount, and prior to final payment on the Phase II award.

2.13 Federal Acquisition Supply Chain Security Act Orders

FAR 52.204-29 Federal Acquisition Supply Chain Security Act (FASCA) Orders—Representation and Disclosures and FAR 52.204-30 FASCA Orders—Prohibition are included in this solicitation. In accordance with FAR 52.204-29 and FAR 52.204-30, proposing SBCs must review FASCSA orders here for covered articles, or any products or services produced or provided by a source, that an applicable FASCSA order prohibits.

During contract performance, the contractor shall review SAM.gov at least once every three months, or as

the contracting officer advises, to check for covered articles, or products or services produced subject as part of any new FASCSA order(s) that could impact their supply chain, and report to the contracting officer any covered article, or product or service produced or provided by a source provided to the government or used during the contract performance.

The proposing SBC represents that, via proposal submission under this solicitation, it conducted a reasonable inquiry, and it does not propose to provide or use any covered article, or any products or services produced or provided by a source, if an applicable FASCSA prohibited the covered article or the source effective this solicitation's issue date.

2.14 BlueUAS Certification

SecWar *Unleashing U.S. Military Drone Dominance* memorandum dated 10 July 2025 provides a goal to eliminate barriers to purchase and train with emerging UAS technology. As of December 2025, the Department's BlueUAS Certification process has transitioned from the Defense Innovation Unit (DIU) to the Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA). Companies who are seeking BlueUAS certification can review the process and submit their product(s) for assessment via DCMA's Blue List portal: https://bluelist.appsplatformportals.us/Blue-UAS-Portal/.

IMPORTANT: Unless specifically required per the topic information, companies are not required to have BlueUAS certification to compete for awards as included in this solicitation, nor are DoW SBIR/STTR program offices responsible for reimbursement of costs incurred by companies pursuing BlueUAS certification.

3.0 PROPOSAL PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS AND REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Introduction

The proposal must provide sufficient information to demonstrate to the evaluator(s) that the proposed work represents an innovative approach to an important scientific or engineering problem and is worthy of support under the stated criteria. The proposed research or R&D must be responsive to the chosen topic, although it does not need to use the exact approach specified in the topic, if applicable. SBCs should consider the following:

a. Does the technical approach have a reasonable chance of meeting the topic objective (if applicable)?
b. Is this approach innovative, not routine, with potential for commercialization?
c. Does the proposing SBC have the capability to implement the technical approach or can it obtain the appropriate people and equipment for the task?

DSIP provides a structure for providing the following proposal volumes:

a. Volume 1: Proposal Cover Sheet
b. Volume 2: Technical Volume
c. Volume 3: Cost Volume
d. Volume 4: Company Commercialization Report
e. Volume 5: Supporting Documents
f. Volume 6: Fraud, Waste and Abuse Training
g. Volume 7: Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries

Each Service/Component guidance on allowable proposal content may vary. A completed proposal submission in DSIP does NOT indicate that each proposal volume has been completed in accordance with the Service/Component-specific instructions. Accordingly, it is the proposing

SBC's responsibility to consult the Service/Component-specific instructions for detailed guidance, including required proposal documentation and structure, cost and duration limitations, budget structure, TABA allowance and proposal page limits.

3.2 Export-Controlled Topic Requirements

Export of all unclassified technical data with military or space application in the possession of, or under the control of, a DoW Component information, which includes, in some circumstances, release to foreign nationals within the United States, without first obtaining approval, authorization, or license from the Department of State for items controlled by the International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR), or the Department of Commerce for items controlled by the Export Administration Regulations (EAR), may constitute a violation of law.

Pursuant to Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) Procedures Guidance and Information 225.7901-2, your firm should direct its attention to the clause at DFARS 252.225-7048, Export-Controlled Items for questions concerning compliance with ITAR/EAR.

Further, in accordance with DoW Directive 5230.25, Withholding of Unclassified Technical Data from Public Disclosure, contractors, or subcontractors that will handle technical data that might have military or space applications, must certify that they will comply with all applicable U.S. laws that control the export of sensitive data, as follows:

> If any portion of the proposed SBIR effort is subject to ITAR an SBC must complete a fully certified DD Form 2345, Military Critical Technical Data Agreement, and provide a copy or evidence of application submission within Volume 5. The DD Form 2345, Military Critical Technical Data Agreement, instructions, and Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) may be found at the United States/Canada Joint Certification Program (JCP) website, JCP Portal.
>
> If any portion of the proposed SBIR effort is subject to EAR, your firm must submit for and obtain the proper export licenses through the Department of Commerce's Bureau of Industry and Security on-line system, SNAP-R. Failure to obtain the proper export licenses in a timely manner will significantly delay contract award, become grounds for cancellation of the contract action, or become grounds for termination of an existing contract.

Topics under this announcement may be subject to ITAR/EAR and may be identified as such. However, export control compliance statements found in this document are not meant to be all inclusive. They do not remove any liability from the applicant to comply with applicable ITAR or EAR export control restrictions. For additional guidance on export control considerations, SBCs are encouraged to review the SBIR/STTR ITAR tutorial, which provides an overview of ITAR and EAR and their applicability to federally funded research.

3.3 Classified Proposals

Classified proposals will not be accepted under the DoW SBIR Program. If topics require classified work during Phase II, the proposing SBC must have a facility clearance to perform the work. For more information on facility and personnel clearance procedures and requirements, please visit the Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA) website at: https://www.dcsa.mil/mc/ctp/fc/.

3.4 Promotional Materials

Promotional and non-project related discussion is discouraged, and additional information provided via website links or on computer disks, CDs, DVDs, video tapes or any other medium will not be accepted or considered in the proposal evaluation.

3.5 Prior, Current, or Pending Support of Similar Proposals or Awards

While it is permissible, with proposal notification, to submit identical proposals or proposals containing a significant amount of essentially equivalent work for consideration under numerous federal program solicitations, it is unlawful to enter negotiation for contracts requiring essentially equivalent effort. If there is any question concerning prior, current, or pending support of similar proposals or awards, it must be disclosed to the soliciting agency or agencies as early as possible and declared on the proposal cover sheet.

3.6 Marking Proprietary Proposal Information

Proposing SBCs that include data in their proposals they do not want disclosed to the public for any purpose, or only used for government evaluation purposes, shall:

a. Mark the first page of each volume of the proposal submission with the following legend:

   "This proposal includes data that shall not be disclosed outside the Government and shall not be duplicated, used, or disclosed-in whole or in part-for any purpose other than to evaluate this proposal. If, however, a contract is awarded to this proposing SBC as a result of-or in connection with-the submission of this data, the Government shall have the right to duplicate, use, or disclose the data to the extent provided in the resulting contract. This restriction does not limit the Government's right to use information contained in this data if it is obtained from another source without restriction. The data subject to this restriction are contained in pages [insert numbers or other identification of sheets]"; and

b. Mark each sheet of data it wishes to restrict with the following legend:

   "Use or disclosure of data contained on this page is subject to the restriction on the first page of this volume."

The DoW assumes no liability for disclosure or use of unmarked data and may use or disclose such data for any purpose.

Restrictive notices notwithstanding, support contractors may handle proposals and final reports submitted through DSIP for administrative purposes only; they are required to adhere to appropriate non-disclosure agreements.

3.7 Phase I Proposal Instructions

a. **Proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1)**

   The proposal cover sheet is prepared on DSIP. The cover sheet must include a brief technical abstract that describes the proposed R&D project and an anticipated benefits and potential commercial applications discussion. Each section should be no more than 3,000 characters. **Do not include proprietary or classified information in the proposal cover sheet**. If your proposal is selected for negotiation and possible award, the technical abstract and anticipated benefits discussion may be publicly released online. DSIP will assign a proposal number once the cover sheet is saved. You may modify the cover sheet as needed until the topic closes.

   NOTE: the amounts listed in the percentage of work (POW) certification question on the proposal cover sheet are derived from SBC-entered information in the cost volume (Volume 3). Details on the calculation can be viewed in DSIP during proposal submission.

If the POW calculations fall below eligibility requirements, the funding agreement officer must upload either an explanatory letter or approval to the certification question to complete the submission. Some DoW Services/Components will not accept any deviations from the POW minimum requirements. Please refer to the Service/Component instructions regarding deviations acceptance to the POW requirements.

b. **Technical Volume Format (Volume 2)**

1. **File Type.** The Technical Volume must be a single PDF file, including graphics. Perform a virus check before uploading the technical volume file. If a virus is detected, the proposal may be rejected. **Do not lock, password protect or encrypt the uploaded file. Do not include or embed active graphics, such as videos, moving pictures, or other similar media, in the document.**

2. **Length.** It is the proposing SBC's responsibility to verify that the technical volume does not exceed the page limit after upload to DSIP. Please refer to Service/Component-specific instructions for how a technical volume is handled if the stated page count is exceeded. Some Services/Components will reject the entire technical proposal if the proposal exceeds the stated page count.

3. **Layout.** Number all proposal pages consecutively. Submit a direct, concise, and informative research or R&D proposal (no type smaller than 10-point on standard 8-1/2" x 11" paper with one-inch margins, including the header). Each header on each page in the technical volume should contain the proposing SBC's name, topic number, and the DSIP-assigned proposal number from the cover sheet.

c. **Technical Volume Content (Volume 2)**

The Technical Volume should cover the following items <u>in the order given below</u>:

1. Identification and Significance of the Problem or Opportunity
2. Phase I Technical Objectives
3. Phase I Statement of Work
4. Related Work
5. Relationship with Future Research or Research and Development
6. Commercialization Strategy
7. Key Personnel
8. Foreign Citizens
9. Facilities/Equipment
10. Subcontractors/Consultants
11. Prior, Current, or Pending Support of Similar Proposals or Awards
12. Identification and Assertion of Restrictions on the Government's Use, Release, or Disclosure of Technical Data or Computer Software

A Phase I technical volume template is available in Appendix A to provide details and helpful guidelines for completing each section of your Phase I technical proposal.

Refer to the Service/Component-specific Direct to Phase II instructions for details on proposal preparation and technical volume content requirements.

d. **Cost Volume Content (Volume 3)**

Complete the cost volume using the DSIP cost volume form. Some items in the cost breakdown may not apply to the proposed project. There is no need to provide information on each individual item; make sure to provide enough information for evaluators to understand the requested funds' planned use if a contract is awarded.

1. List all key personnels' names and include their individual hours dedicated to the project as direct labor.
2. While special tooling and test equipment and material cost may be included under Phase I, equipment and material inclusion will be carefully reviewed relative to need and appropriateness for the work proposed. Special tooling and test equipment purchases must, in the Service/Component contracting officer's opinion, be advantageous to the U.S. Government and should relate directly to the specific topic. These may include such items as innovative instrumentation or automatic test equipment. Title to property the U.S. Government furnished or acquired with government funds will be vested with the DoW Service/Component, unless it is determined that title transfer to the contractor would be more cost effective than the DoW Service/Component equipment recovery.
3. Cost for travel funds must be justified and related to the project needs.
4. Cost sharing is permitted for proposals under this solicitation; cost sharing is not required, nor will it be an evaluation factor in the Phase I proposal consideration.
5. A Phase I option (if applicable) should be fully costed separately from the Phase I (base) approach.
6. All subcontractor costs and consultant costs, such as labor, travel, equipment, materials, must be detailed at the same level as prime contractor costs. Provide detailed subcontractor costs substantiation in your cost proposal. Supporting Documents (Volume 5) may be used if additional space is needed.

If a proposal is selected for negotiation and possible award, you must be prepared to submit further documentation to the Service/Component contracting officer to substantiate costs (e.g., a cost estimates explanation for equipment, materials, and consultants or subcontractors). For more information about cost proposals and accounting standards, see visit DCAA's website.

e. **Company Commercialization Report (Volume 4)**

The company commercialization report (CCR) allows companies to report funding outcomes resulting from prior SBIR and STTR awards. SBA requires SBIR and STTR awardees to update and maintain their organization's CCR on SBIR.gov. Commercialization information is required upon the last deliverable's completion under the funding agreement. Thereafter, SBIR and STTR awardees are requested to voluntarily update the information in the database annually for a minimum 5-year period.

If the proposing SBC has prior DoW and/or non-DoW Phase I and/or Phase II SBIR/STTR awards, regardless of whether the project has any commercialization to date, the firm admin must download the CCR's PDF copy from SBIR.gov and upload it to DSIP's "Firm Forms" section. The DSIP firm admin completes the firm forms are completed and are applies them to all proposals the proposing SBC submits. To fulfill the DSIP CCR requirement complete the following:

1. Log into the firm account at https://www.sbir.gov/.
2. Navigate to My Dashboard > My Documents to view or print the information currently contained in the "Company Registry Commercialization Report."

3. Create or update the commercialization record, from the company dashboard, scroll to the "My Commercialization" section and click the "Create/Update Commercialization" tab under "Current Report Version." Please refer to the "Instructions" and "Guide" documents contained on dashboard for more detail on completing and updating the CCR. **Ensure the report is certified and submitted.**
4. Click the "Company Commercialization Report" PDF under the dashboard's "My Documents" section to download the CCR PDF.
5. Upload the CCR PDF (downloaded from SBIR.gov in previous step) to the "Company Commercialization Report" in DSIP's "Firm Forms" section. The firm admin must complete this upload action.

In Volume 4 of the DSIP proposal submission, the proposing SBC will be prompted to answer: "Do you have a new or revised Company Commercialization Report to upload?" There are three possible courses of action:

a. If the proposing SBC has prior DoW and/or non-DoW Phase I and/or Phase II SBIR/STTR awards and **has a new or revised CCR from SBIR.gov to upload to DSIP**, select YES.
   1. If the user is the firm admin, they can upload the CCR PDF from SBIR.gov directly on this page. It will also be updated in the "Firm Forms" and be associated with all new or in-progress proposals the proposing SBC submitted. If the user is not the firm admin, they will receive a message that they do not have access and must contact the firm admin to complete this action.
   2. **WARNING:** Uploading a new CCR under the DSIP "Firm Forms" section or clicking "Save" or "Submit" in one proposal's Volume 4 is considered a change for ALL proposals under any open solicitation. If a proposing SBC has previously certified and submitted any Phase I or Direct to Phase II proposals under ***any*** solicitation ***still open***, those proposals will be automatically reopened. Proposing SBCs will have to recertify and resubmit affected proposals. If a proposing SBC does not recertify or resubmit affected proposals, they will not be considered fully submitted and will not be evaluated.

b. If the proposing SBC has prior DoW and/or non-DoW Phase I and/or Phase II SBIR/STTR awards, and **no new or revised CCR from SBIR.gov to upload to DSIP**, select NO.
   1. If a prior CCR was uploaded to the "Firm Forms", the proposing SBC will see a file dialog box at the bottom of the page and can view the previously uploaded CCR. This read-only access allows the proposing SBC to confirm the firm admin uploaded the CCR.
   2. If no file dialog box appears at the bottom of the page **there is no previously uploaded CCR in the DSIP "Firm Forms**." To fulfill the DSIP CCR requirement the firm admin must follow steps 1-5 listed above to download a CCR PDF from SBIR.gov and upload it to the DSIP "Firm Forms" to be included with all proposal submissions.

c. If the proposing SBC has **NO** prior DoW and/or non-DoW Phase I and/or Phase II SBIR/STTR awards, the CCR upload from SBIR.gov is not required and SBC will select NO. The proposal's CCR section will be marked complete.

Please refer to the Service/Component-specific instructions for details on how the CCR information will be considered during proposal evaluations.

f. **Supporting Documents (Volume 5)**

Volume 5 is provided for proposing SBCs to submit additional documentation to support the Coversheet (Volume 1), Technical Volume (Volume 2), and the Cost Volume (Volume 3).

The following documents may be included in Volume 5, if applicable to the proposal. Refer to Service/Component-specific instructions for additional Volume 5 requirements. **Reminder: A completed proposal submission in DSIP does NOT indicate the mandatory supporting documents have been uploaded in accordance with the Service/Component-specific instructions.**

1. Letters of support
2. Additional cost information
3. Funding agreement certification
4. Technical data rights (assertions)
5. Lifecycle certification
6. Allocation of rights
7. Verification of Eligibility of Small Business Joint Ventures, if applicable
8. DD Form 2345, Militarily Critical Technical Data Agreement, if applicable (see section 3.2)

g. **Fraud, Waste, and Abuse Training (Volume 6)**

The fraud, waste, and abuse (FWA) training is **required** for DoW SBIR/STTR proposals. FWA training provides information on what represents FWA in the SBIR/STTR program, the most common mistakes that lead to FWA, as well as the penalties and ways to prevent FWA. The training currently consists of a 3-page PDF, consistent with the tutorial provided by the SBA. This training material must be thoroughly reviewed once per year and can be found here and in the DSIP proposal submission module for Volume 6. Plan time to review the tutorial during completion of Volume 6, prior to the proposal submission deadline. The individual designated as the Proposal Owner must complete this training on behalf of the proposing small business.

h. **Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7)**

In accordance with 15 U.S.C. §638 (vv) and the SBA SBIR/STTR Policy Directive, the DoW will review all proposals submitted in response to this solicitation to assess security risks of SBCs seeking a federally funded award. SBCs must complete the DSIP Volume 7 webform "Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries" (NOTE: PDF uploads are no longer accepted). The corporate official cannot certify and submit the full proposal until the Volume 7 webform is fully completed and submitted.

Please be aware that the "Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries" form WILL NOT be accepted as a supporting document in DSIP's Volume 5 proposal submission. Do not upload any previous versions of this form to Volume 5.

For additional details, please refer to Section 2.5. The disclosure questions are below:

1. Is any owner or covered individual of the applicant or awardee party to any malign foreign talent recruitment program? If yes, disclose the first and last name of each owner or covered individual, identify their role (i.e., owner or covered individual), and the malign foreign talent recruitment program.

2. Is there a parent company, joint venture, or subsidiary, of the applicant or awardee that is based in or receives funding from, any foreign country of concern? If yes, disclose the name, full address, applicant or awardee relationships (i.e., parent company, joint venture, or subsidiary) of each entity based in, or funded by, any foreign country of concern.
3. Does the applicant or awardee have any current or pending contractual or financial obligation or other agreement specific to a business arrangement, or joint venture-like arrangement with an enterprise owned by a foreign state or any foreign entity? If yes, disclose the name of each enterprise or foreign entity, type of obligation, agreement, or arrangement (*i.e.,* contractual, financial, or other), description of obligation, agreement, or arrangement, and the foreign state(s) and/or the country of the foreign entity (or entities).
4. Is the applicant or awardee wholly owned in a foreign country? If yes, disclose the foreign country.
5. Does the applicant or awardee have any venture capital or institutional investment? If yes, proceed to question 5a. If no, proceed to question 6.

   5a. Does the investing entity have a general partner or any other individual holding a leadership role who has a foreign affiliation with any foreign country of concern? If yes or unable to determine, disclose the venture capital or institutional investing entity's name, the percentage of ownership obtained by the investing entity, and the type of investment (i.e., equity, debt, or combination of equity and debt).
6. During the previous 5-year period, did the applicant or awardee have any technology licensing or intellectual property sales or transfers, to a foreign country of concern? If yes, disclose the name, address, and country, of the institution or entity that licensed, purchased, or received the technology or intellectual property.
7. Is there any foreign business entity, offshore entity, or entity outside the United States related to the applicant or awardee? If yes, disclose the entity name, relationship type (i.e., foreign business entity, offshore entity, entity outside the United States), description of the relationship to the applicant or awardee, and entity address and country.
8. Does the applicant or awardee have an owner, officer, or covered individual that has a foreign affiliation with a research institution located in a foreign country of concern? If yes, disclose the first and last name of each owner, officer, or covered individual that has a foreign affiliation with a foreign country of concern, identify their role (i.e., owner, officer, or covered individual), and the name of the foreign research institution and the foreign country of concern where it is located.

3.8 Phase II Proposal Information

Only Phase I awardees may submit Phase II proposals. Phase II proposals submission must follow individual Service/Component instructions. Awarding DoW Services/Component, either in the Phase I award or via subsequent notification, will provide details on Phase II proposal due date, content, and submission requirements. If a proposing SBC submits their Phase II proposal prior to the individual Service/Component's dates, it may be rejected without evaluation.

Due to specific limitations on the amount of funding and number of awards awarded to a particular proposing SBC per topic using SBIR/STTR program funds, head of agency determinations are required before a different agency may make an award using another agency's topic. This limitation does not apply to Phase III funding. Please contact your original sponsoring agency before submitting a Phase II proposal to an agency other than the one who sponsored the original topic.

SBIR/STTR Policy Directive Section 4(b)(1)(i) allows that, at the agency's discretion, projects awarded a Phase I under a solicitation for SBIR may transition in Phase II to STTR and vice versa. A proposing SBC wishing to transfer from one program to another must contact their designated technical monitor to discuss the reasons for the request and the agency's ability to it. The transition may be proposed prior to award or during the Phase II effort performance. Agency disapproval of a request to change programs shall not be grounds for granting relief from any contractual performance requirement. All approved transitions between programs must be noted in the contracting officer-signed Phase II award or award modification that indicates the removal or addition of the research institution and the revised percentage of work requirements.

3.8.1 Phase II Commercialization Strategy

At a minimum, the commercialization strategy must address the following five questions:

a. What will be the first product to use this technology?
b. Who will be the customers, and what is the estimated market size?
c. How much money is needed to bring the technology to market, and how will that money be raised?
d. Does the proposing SBC contain marketing expertise and, if not, how will the SBC acquire that expertise?
e. Who are the proposing SBC's competitors, and what is the price and/or quality advantage over those competitors?

The commercialization strategy must also include a schedule showing the anticipated quantitative commercialization results at 1) one year after the Phase II project starts, 2) at Phase II completion, and 3) after Phase II completion (i.e., additional investment amount, sales revenue, etc.). After Phase II award, the proposing SBC is required to report actual sales and investment data in its SBA company commercialization report via SBIR.gov's "My Dashboard" on a minimum annual basis. Please refer to the Service/Component-specific instructions for guidance on formatting, page count and other details.

3.8.2 Phase II Adequate Accounting System

To reduce the small business's risk and avoid potential contracting delays, companies interested in pursuing Phase II SBIR contracts and other contracts of similar size with the DoW, may require an adequate accounting system in place per General Accepted Accounting Principles, Generally Accepted Government Auditing Standards, Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) and Cost Accounting Standards. The Defense Contract Audit Agency (DCAA) will audit the accounting system. See DCAA's website for requirements and standards, the audit process overview, and a pre-award system adequacy checklist.

4.0 METHOD OF SELECTION AND EVALUATION CRITERIA

4.1 Evaluation Process

All proposals will be evaluated and judged on a competitive basis in terms of technical capability and technical value. Proposals will be initially screened to determine responsiveness to the topic objective. Proposals passing this initial screening will be technically evaluated by engineers, scientists, or subject matter experts to determine the most promising technical and scientific approaches. As a common statement of work does not exist, each proposal will be assessed on the merit of the approach in achieving the technical objectives established in the topic.

4.2 Evaluation Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated based on the criteria outlined below, unless otherwise specified in the Service/Component-specific instructions. Selections will be based on a determination of the overall technical value of each proposal and an evaluation of the cost volume, with the appropriate method of analysis given the contract type to be awarded, for selection of the proposal(s) most advantageous to the Government, considering the following factors which are listed in descending order of importance:

a. The soundness, technical merit, and innovation of the proposed approach and its incremental progress toward topic or subtopic solution.
b. The qualifications of the proposed principal/key investigators, supporting staff, and consultants. Qualifications include not only the ability to perform the R&D but also the ability to commercialize the results.
c. The potential for commercial (government or private sector) application and the benefits expected to accrue from this commercialization.

Cost or budget data submitted with the proposals will be considered during evaluation.

Technical reviewers will base their conclusions only on information contained in the proposal. Do not assume reviewers are acquainted with the proposing SBC, key individuals, or any referenced experiments. Relevant supporting data such as journal articles, literature, including Government publications, etc., should be included based on requirements listed in Service/Component-specific instructions.

4.3 Proposal Status & Feedback

Proposing SBCs will be notified of selection or non-selection status for an award by the DoW Service/Component that originated the topic <u>no later than 90 days</u> of the closing date for this solicitation. Please refer to the Service/Component-specific instructions for details.

After final selection decisions have been announced, the SBC may be provided proposal feedback in the form of a written debrief. This debriefing process varies across the DoW Services/Components. Please refer to the Service/Component-specific instructions for details on the debriefing processes.

4.4 Award Denials

The DoW will not make an award under the SBIR program if it determines:

a. The SBC submitting the proposal
    i. has an owner or covered individual that is party to a malign foreign talent recruitment program;
    ii. has a business entity, parent company, or subsidiary located in the People's Republic of China or another foreign country of concern; or
    iii. has an owner or covered individual that has a foreign affiliation with a foreign entity located in the People's Republic of China or another foreign country of concern; and
b. The relationships and commitments described in clauses (i) through (iii) of subparagraph (A)
    i. interfere with the capacity for DoW-supported activities to be carried out;
    ii. create duplication with DoW-supported activities;
    iii. present concerns about conflicts of interest;
    iv. were not appropriately disclosed to the DoW;
    v. violate Federal law or terms and conditions of DoW-awarded contracts or other agreements; or
    vi. pose a risk to national security.

4.5 Pre-Award and Post Award Solicitation Protests

Interested parties have the right to protest via procedures in FAR Subpart 33.1; protests exclusively

related to this solicitation's terms must be served to: osd.ncr.ousd-r-e.mbx.SBIR-STTR-Protest@mail.mil

For protests filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO), a copy of the protest shall be submitted to the email address listed above (pre-award ONLY) or DoW Service/Component POC (post-selection/award decision ONLY) within one day of filing with the GAO. Protests of small business status of a selected proposing SBC may also be made to the SBA via the procedures in FAR § 19.302.

For the purposes of a protest related to a particular topic selection, non-selection or award decision, protests should be served to the point-of-contact (POC) listed in the instructions of the DoW Component that authored the topic.

5.0 ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

5.1 Award Information

The number of awards will be consistent with the Component's RDT&E budget. No awards will be made until evaluation of all qualified proposals for a specific topic is complete.

Each proposal selected for negotiation and possible award will be funded under a negotiated instrument and may include a reasonable fee or profit consistent with normal profit margins consistent with normal profit margins provided to profit-making proposing SBCs for R/R&D work.

Contract value varies among the DoW Services/Components; it is important for proposing SBCs to review Service/Component-specific instructions regarding award size.

The SBA SBIR/STTR Policy Directive, Section 7(c)(1)(ii), states agencies should issue the award no more than 180 days after the closing date of the topic.

5.2 Contract Requirements

Upon contract award, the contractor will be required to make certain legal commitments through acceptance of U.S. Government contract clauses in the Phase I contract. The examples below are illustrative of the types of provisions the Federal Acquisition Regulation requires in the Phase I contract. This is not an exhaustive provisions list that could be included in Phase I contracts, nor does it contain specific clause wording. Appendix C of this solicitation contains additional potential required Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) and Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) clauses. Copies of complete general provisions will be made available prior to award.

While this solicitation does not address all potential clauses for resultant funding agreements, proposers are specifically directed to the Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) clause 252.204-7021, Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) Requirements. This clause update reflects significant changes to cybersecurity requirements. Additional information provided in section 2.13 of this solicitation.

Examples of general provisions:

a. **Standards of Work**. Work performed under the Funding Agreement must conform to high professional standards.
b. **Inspection**. Work performed under the Funding Agreement is subject to Government inspection and evaluation at all times.
c. **Examination of Records**. The Comptroller General (or a duly authorized representative) must have the right to examine any pertinent records of the Awardee involving transactions related to this Funding Agreement.

d. **Default**. The Federal Government may terminate the Funding Agreement if the contractor fails to perform the work contracted.
e. **Termination for Convenience**. The Funding Agreement may be terminated at any time by the Federal Government if it deems termination to be in its best interest, in which case the Awardee will be compensated for work performed and for reasonable termination costs.
f. **Disputes.** Any dispute concerning the Funding Agreement that cannot be resolved by agreement must be decided by the contracting officer with right of appeal.
g. **Contract Work Hours**. The Awardee may not require an employee to work more than 8 hours a day or 40 hours a week unless the employee is compensated accordingly (for example, overtime pay).
h. **Equal Opportunity**. The Awardee will not discriminate against any employee or applicant for employment because of race, color, religion, sex, or national origin.
i. **Equal Opportunity for Veterans**. The Awardee will not discriminate against any employee or application for employment because he or she is a disabled veteran or veteran of the Vietnam era.
j. **Equal Opportunity for People with Disabilities**. The Awardee will not discriminate against any employee or applicant for employment because he or she is physically or intellectually disabled.
k. **Officials Not to Benefit**. No Federal Government official may benefit personally from the SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement.
l. **Covenant Against Contingent Fees**. No person or agency has been employed to solicit or secure the Funding Agreement upon an understanding for compensation except bona fide employees or commercial agencies maintained by the Awardee for the purpose of securing business.
m. **Gratuities**. The Funding Agreement may be terminated by the Federal Government if any gratuities have been offered to any representative of the Government to secure the award.
n. **Patent Infringement**. The Awardee must report each notice or claim of patent infringement based on the performance of the Funding Agreement.
o. **American Made Equipment and Products**. When purchasing equipment or a product under the SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement, purchase only American-made items whenever possible.

5.3 Agency Recovery Authority and Ongoing Reporting

In accordance with Section 5 of the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022, the DoW will:

a. require an SBC receiving an award under its SBIR program to repay all amounts received from the federal agency under the award if,
    1. the SBC makes a material misstatement that the federal agency determines poses a risk to national security; or
    2. there is a change in the SBC's ownership, entity structure, or other substantial change in circumstances that the federal agency determines poses a risk to national security; and

b. require an SBC receiving an award under its SBIR program to regularly report to the federal agency and the administration throughout the duration of the award on
    1. any change to a disclosure required under the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries form;
    2. any material misstatement made under paragraph (A) above; and
    3. any change described in paragraph (B) above.

5.4 Copyrights

With prior written permission of the contracting officer, the awardee may copyright (consistent with any appropriate national security considerations) material developed with DoW support. DoW receives a royalty-free license for the Federal Government and requires that each publication contain an appropriate acknowledgment and disclaimer statement.

5.5 Patents

SBCs normally may retain the principal worldwide patent rights to any invention developed with U.S. Government support. The government receives a royalty-free license for its use, reserves the right to require the patent holder to license others in certain limited circumstances, and requires that anyone exclusively licensed to sell the invention in the United States must normally manufacture it domestically. 35 U.S.C. § 205 authorizes that the government will not make public any information disclosing a government-supported invention for a period of five years to allow the awardee to pursue a patent. See also Section 6.8, Invention Reporting.

5.6 Invention Reporting

SBIR awardees must report inventions to the Service/Component within two months of the inventor's report to the awardee, via either paper documentation submission, including fax, or through the Edison Invention Reporting System at www.iedison.gov for participating agencies.

5.7 Technical Data Rights

Rights in technical data, including software, developed under the terms of any contract resulting from proposals submitted in response to this solicitation generally remain with the contractor, except that the U.S. Government obtains a royalty-free license to use such technical data only for government purposes during the period commencing with contract award and ending not less than twenty years after that date. This data should be marked with the restrictive legend specified in DFARS 252.227-7018 (JAN 2025). Upon expiration of the twenty-year restrictive license, the government has government purpose rights in the SBIR data. During the license period, the U.S. Government may not release or disclose SBIR data to any person other than its support services contractors except: (1) for evaluation purposes; (2) as expressly permitted by the contractor; or (3) a use, release, or disclosure that is necessary for emergency repair or overhaul government-operated items.

If a proposing SBC plans to submit assertions in accordance with DFARS 252.227-7017 (JAN 2025), those assertions must be identified and assertion of use, release, or disclosure restriction must be included with your proposal submission, at the end of the technical volume. The contract cannot be awarded until assertions are approved.

5.8 Final Technical Reports - Phase I through Phase III

a. **Content**: A final report is required for each project phase. The reports must contain in detail the project objectives, work performed, results obtained, and estimates of technical feasibility. A completed SF 298, "Report Documentation Page," will be used as the first page of the report. The DoW Service/Component also may require monthly status and/or progress reports.

b. **SF 298 Form "Report Documentation Page" Preparation**:
   a. If desirable, the proposing SBC may also use language from its Phase II proposal to cover Phase I progress in the final report.

   b. For each unclassified report, the proposing SBC submitting the report should fill in Block 12 (Distribution/Availability Statement) of the SF 298, "Report Documentation Page," with the following statement: "Distribution authorized to U.S. Government only; Proprietary Information, (Date of Determination). Other requests for this document shall be referred to the Service/Component SBIR Program Office."

   Note: Data developed under a SBIR contract is subject to SBIR Data Rights, under which DFARS 252.227-7018 (JAN 2025) (see Section 5.7, Technical Data Rights) provides

protection. The sponsoring DoW activity, after reviewing the proposing SBC's entry in Block 12, has final responsibility for assigning a distribution statement.

For additional information on distribution statements see the following Defense Technical Information Center (DTIC) website.

c. Block 14 (Abstract) of the SF 298, "Report Documentation Page" must include as the first sentence, "Report developed under SBIR contract for topic [insert solicitation topic number. [Follow with the topic title, if possible.]" The abstract must identify the work's purpose and briefly describe the work conducted, the findings or results, and the effort's potential applications. **Since DoW will publish the abstract, it must not contain any proprietary or classified data, and type "UU" in Block 17.**

d. Block 15 (Subject Terms) of the SF 298 must include the term "SBIR Report".

c. **Submission**: In accordance with DFARS 252.235-7011, submit an electronic copy of the approved final scientific or technical report, not a summary, delivered under the contract to the Defense Technical Information Center (DTIC) through the web-based input system at https://discover.dtic.mil/submit-documents/ as required by DoW Instruction 3200.12, DoW Scientific and Technical Information Program (STIP). Include a completed Standard Form (SF) 298, Report Documentation Page, in the document, or complete the web-based SF 298. Additional submission resources are available here.

Delivery will normally be within 30 days after completion of the Phase I technical effort.

Other requirements regarding reports and/or other deliverables submission will be defined in each contract's contract data requirements list (CDRL). Special instructions for submitting CLASSIFIED reports will be defined in the contract's delivery schedule.

DO NOT email classified or controlled unclassified reports, or reports containing SBIR Data Rights protected under DFARS 252.227-7018 (JAN 2025).

6.0 PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

6.1 Submission Details

DSIP is the official portal for DoW SBIR/STTR proposal submission. Proposers are required to submit proposals via DSIP; proposals submitted by any other means will be disregarded. Detailed guidance on DSIP proposal submission is found here.

Deadline for Receipt: Complete proposals must be certified and submitted in DSIP no later than the close date of the release listed on the cover page of this solicitation. Proposals cannot be submitted in DSIP after the deadline is reached and will not be accepted or evaluated.

The final proposal submission includes successful completion of all firm level forms, all required proposal volumes, and electronic corporate official certification. Although signatures are not required on the electronic forms at the time of submission, the proposal must be certified electronically by the corporate official for it to be considered submitted. If the proposal is selected for negotiation and possible award, the DoW Component program will contact the proposing SBC for signatures prior to award. **Please plan to submit proposals as early as possible to allow time for troubleshooting any possible issues before the topic close. DSIP Support is unable to assist with submission issues once a**

deadline has passed and cannot provide submission extensions. DoW is not responsible for missed proposal submission due to system latency.

If the proposal status is "In Progress" or "Ready to Certify" it will NOT be considered submitted, even if all volumes are added prior to the topic close date. The proposing SBC may modify all proposal volumes prior to the topic close date.

6.2 Technical Questions

a. **Direct Contact with Topic Authors**. During the pre-release period, the names of the topic authors, their phone numbers and/or email addresses are published with the topic on the DSIP Topics and Topic Q&A page. During this time, proposing SBCs can contact topic authors via telephone or email to ask technical questions about specific solicitation topics. Questions must be limited to specific information related to understanding a particular topic's requirements. Proposing SBCs may not ask for advice or guidance on solution approach and may not submit additional material to the topic author.
   If information provided during an exchange with the topic author is deemed necessary for proposal preparation, that information will be made available to all parties through DSIP Topic Q&A.
   After the pre-release period, questions must be asked through DSIP Topic Q&A as described below. No further direct contact is allowed between proposing SBCs and topic authors, unless the topic author is responding to a question submitted during the pre-release period.

b. **DSIP Topic Q&A.** Proposing SBCs may submit written questions through DSIP Topic Q&A here, where all questions and answers are posted on a non-attribution basis for public viewing. DSIP Topic Q&A opens on the pre-release date and closes two weeks prior to the topic close date.

   Proposing SBCs may use the topic search feature on DSIP to locate a topic of interest. Use the form at the bottom of the topic description, enter and submit the question. Answers are generally posted within seven business days of question submission and also e-mailed directly to the inquirer.

   Questions submitted through the DSIP Topic Q&A are limited to technical information focused on understanding a topic's requirements. Any other questions, such as asking for advice or guidance on solution approach, or administrative questions, such as SBIR or STTR program eligibility, technical proposal/cost proposal structure and page count, budget and duration limitations, or proposal due date are not appropriate and will not receive a response; for administrative questions, refer to a topic's Service/Component-specific instructions.

   Once the proposal submission closes, no communication of any kind is allowed either with the topic author or through topic Q&A regarding submitted proposals.

Throughout the topic solicitation period, proposing SBCs should frequently monitor DSIP for updates and amendments to the topics and DSIP Topic Q&A for questions and answers.

7.0 Participating Component Instructions & Research Topics

The following section contains all Component-specific proposal preparation instructions and research topics this BAA.

DoW 2026 SBIR CSO
Release 1

April 13, 2026: Topics Pre-Release
May 06, 2026: Topics Open; DoW begins accepting proposals in DSIP
May 20, 2026: DSIP Topic Q&A closes to new questions at **12:00 p.m. ET**
June 03, 2026: Topics Close; Deadline for receipt of proposals is **12:00 p.m. ET**

Participating Services/Components:

- Department of the Army (Army)
- Department of the Navy (Navy)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
2026 Small Business Innovative Research (SBIR) Program
FY26 Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO)
Component-Specific Proposal Instructions
Release 1

To the extent possible, all Department of the Army component specific text follows the same numbering as the related sections in the Department of War (DoW) 2026 SBIR Program CSO. Supplemental numbering is used only when the text cannot be integrated intelligibly with the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO counterpart.

Each Small Business Concern (SBC) (also referred to herein as "proposer", "offeror", and/or "firm") is encouraged to thoroughly review the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, to include any amendments/revisions, and the Army component-specific proposal instructions herein.

Please note that these instructions contain active hyperlinks. Offerors are encouraged to utilize these hyperlinks for additional information and resources. Ensure your browser or Portable Document Format viewer settings permit hyperlink access to take full advantage of these resources.

The following resources are provided to assist SBCs with SBIR Program Opportunities:

- The DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO is located at: https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/solicitation-documents/active-solicitations.

- To remain apprised of important programmatic and solicitation changes, SBCs should register for the Defense SBIR / Small Business Technology Transfer (STTR) Innovation Portal (DSIP) Listserv at: https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/login.

- Department of the Army's SBIR|STTR Website: https://www.armysbir.army.mil/.

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1.0 PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

1.1 Introduction

The future Army must be capable of conducting Multi-Domain Operations (MDO) as part of an integrated Joint Force across an array of situations in multiple theaters by 2035. The MDO concept describes how the Army will support the Joint Force in the rapid and continuous integration of all domains of warfare – land, sea, air, and cyberspace – to deter and prevail as we compete short of conflict, and fight and win if deterrence fails. The Army must provide game-changing capabilities to our Soldiers. To capitalize on small business innovation and reduce the time from solicitation to award, the Army leverages an approach that advertises SBIR funding opportunities through the DoW SBIR CSO process, with monthly topic releases. Additionally, the Army has established a contracting activity dedicated to executing all SBIR|STTR Phase I and Phase II awards for Army customers.

1.5 Majority Ownership in Part by Multiple Venture Capital, Hedge Fund, and Private Equity Firms

Under the Department of the Army's SBIR Program, proposing SBCs that are owned in majority part by multiple venture capital operating companies (VCOCs), hedge funds (HF), or private equity funds (PEF) are eligible to submit applications or receive awards. Reference may be made to the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, including revisions/amendments, as well as 13 CFR 121.702, regarding eligibility standards, to include ownership and control requirements, applicable to the SBIR program.

All applicants that are majority-owned by multiple VCOC, HF or PEF, and are submitting a proposal to an Army Topic, shall complete the certification at Verification of Eligibility of Small Business Joint Ventures, prior to submitting an application/proposal and must include the certification with their submission.

1.7 Direct to Phase II (DP2) Program

Implementing the authority granted by 15 U.S.C. §638 (cc), as amended, the U.S. Army will be conducting 'Direct to Phase II' awards for eligible SBIR topics. For topics leveraging this authority, please refer to Section 3.9, Direct to Phase II (DP2) Proposal Instructions, below.

1.8 Program on Innovation Open Topics

This release may contain an open topic. Proposing SBCs shall refer to the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, to include any amendments/revisions, for additional information regarding open topic submissions.

1.9 Discretionary Technical and Business Assistance (TABA)

The Army's SBIR and STTR Policy Directive, Section 9(b), authorizes the provision of Technical Assistance and Business Assistance (TABA) to awardees. TABA aims to support awardees in several key areas, including making informed technical decisions, overcoming technical challenges, mitigating technical risks, and facilitating the commercialization of their SBIR|STTR projects. While participation in the Army SBIR|STTR TABA program is voluntary, the Army encourages awardees to utilize its preferred vendor, FedTech, for these services. Instructions to complete the Army's preferred vendor application will be provided upon contract award.

Alternatively, proposing SBCs may choose to contract TABA services themselves through one or more providers. To do so, the SBC must explicitly state in its Army SBIR|STTR proposal its intention to use a different TABA provider. The cost of TABA services, not exceeding the resource limitations specified below, must be included in the Cost Volume (Volume 3) of the proposal. This amount cannot include

any profit/fee for the proposing SBC. Additionally, TABA costs cannot be factored into the calculation of general and administrative expenses (G&A) for the proposing SBC. **The required justification for using a firm-selected TABA vendor must be provided in Supporting Documentation (Volume 5), following the instructions outlined in that section.**

The Army SBIR program sponsors participation in the TABA program. The resource limitations for each firm is as follows:

Phase I Firms:

- Army-Preferred Vendor: If approved, the contractor may receive up to $6,500 for assistance services per project (in addition to the maximum award funding guideline limitation specified in the respective SBIR|STTR Topic). The Army's preferred provider currently offers the following TABA services for Phase I awardees:
    - Commercial Pitch Deck Review
    - Commercialization Strategy Review
- Firm-Selected Vendor: If approved, the contractor may receive up to $6,500 in contract obligations per project (this amount must be included as part of the maximum award funding guideline limitation specified in the respective SBIR|STTR Topic). **Firm-Selected Vendor TABA funding will be denied if the offeror fails to include the cost in the Phase I proposal.**

Phase II Firms:

- Army-Preferred Vendor: If approved, the contractor may receive up to $50,000 for assistance services per project (in addition to the maximum award funding guideline limitation specified in the respective SBIR|STTR Topic). The Army's preferred provider currently offers the following TABA services for Phase II awardees:
    - Customized market research and strategy
    - IP support
    - Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) compliance
    - Defense Contract Audit Agency (DCAA) compliance
    - Communications and Marketing
- Firm-Selected Vendor: If approved, the contractor may receive up to $50,000 in contract obligations per project (this amount must be included as part of the maximum award funding guideline limitation specified in the respective SBIR|STTR Topic). **Firm-Selected Vendor TABA funding will be denied if the offeror fails to include the cost in the Phase II proposal.**

For additional resources regarding the Army SBIR Program's TABA, please refer the following link: https://www.armysbir.army.mil/taba/

1.10.1 Department of the Army Phase II Enhancement Policy

1.10.1 Overview

To further encourage the transition of SBIR|STTR research into DoW acquisition programs as well as the private sector, the Department of the Army may provide a Phase II awardee with up to $500,000.00 in matching SBIR funding (on a dollar-for-dollar basis) if the performer obtains commitment of non-SBIR|STTR funding from a DoW component(s), Federal Agency(ies), and/or a commercial investor(s).

Enhancement funding is typically applied to an active Phase II award via a contract modification and will result in an additional period of performance that is commensurate with the total funding received, typically 6 to 18 months (18 months being the maximum). On a case-by-case basis, however, a new

Phase II contract may be awarded if appropriate. The proposed Enhancement effort must develop, deliver, and integrate a technology or product into a program within a DoW component(s), Federal Agency(ies), and/or the commercial sector.

1.10.2 Application Process

Enhancement requests should be submitted at least 6 months prior to the end of the Phase II period of performance to allow adequate time to complete the contracting process. Applications to the Enhancement Program will be reviewed for overall merit, transition potential, commercialization strategy, and value to the Army mission and are typically initiated through the Contracting Officer Representative (COR), Technical Point(s) of Contact (TPOC), SBIR|STTR Coordinator, and/or the Army SBIR|STTR Program Office, with oversight and input from the Contracting Officer.

Upon Army SBIR|STTR Program's Source Selection Authority (SSA) approval to proceed, assigned contracting personnel will prepare and issue a letter request for proposal (RFP), soliciting the firm's Enhancement proposal.

1.10.3 Limitations

All Enhancement requests are subject to the approval of the Army SBIR|STTR Program's SSA, successful completion of negotiations, and the availability of funding.

In order to be considered for matching SBIR funds under a Phase II Enhancement, the Contracting Officer must receive certified proof of the non-SBIR|STTR funding transfer. Certification consists of a notarized letter, stating that "$ in cash has been transferred to [company name] from [investor name] in accordance with the DA Enhancement Program procedures" that is signed by both the awardee and its investor. The letter must be sent to the Contracting Officer along with a copy of the SBIR awardees bank statement showing the funds were deposited. This certification should be received by the Contracting Officer within 45 days of the Enhancement approval notification. Failure of the awardee to certify and provide proof of the Investor's total cash contribution may significantly delay the Phase II enhancement or result in the awardee becoming ineligible for the Phase II Enhancement.

"Outside investment" must meet DoW Guidelines to qualify for Phase II Enhancement matching funds.

Eligible third-party investors include:

- Non-SBIR|STTR Department of Defense funds
- Any other non-SBIR|STTR federal agency funds
- An SBC other than the eligible/performing SBC
- Venture capital firms
- Individual investors
- A non-SBIR|STTR federal, state, or local government; or
- Any combination thereof

Ineligible sources include:

- The eligible SBC's internal research and development funds
- Funding in forms other than cash (such as in-kind or other tangible assets)
- Funding from the owners of the eligible SBC, or the family members or affiliates of such owners; or
- Funding attained through loans or other forms of debt obligations

2.0 CERTIFICATIONS AND REGISTRATIONS

2.1 System for Award Management (SAM) Registration

Interested SBCs are required to be registered and active in SAM in accordance with FAR Provision 52.204-7, System for Award Management, when submitting an offer or quotation and at time of award. Proposals or offers submitted by firms failing to meet this requirement may be deemed unresponsive.

SBCs may only submit offers using their legal business name or 'Doing Business As' (DBA) name, as indicated in the SAM registration for the provided Unique Entity Identifier (UEI). A firm submitting an offer using a DBA name shall have the DBA registered and linked to their current, active, SAM registration. Please refer to section 2.3 below for instructions regarding the correlation between your firm's DSIP account profile, and the SAM.

Firms must not be debarred, suspended, proposed for debarment, or voluntarily excluded from Government contracting within the SAM –

- Contractors debarred, suspended, proposed for debarment, or voluntarily excluded, are excluded from receiving an award. Contractors that are debarred, suspended, proposed for debarment, or voluntarily excluded, are also excluded from conducting business with the Government as agents or representatives of other contractors.
- Contractors and other entities that have an active exclusion record in SAM because they have been declared ineligible on the basis of statutory or other regulatory procedures are excluded from receiving an award under the conditions and for the period set forth in the statute or regulation.
- The Army SBIR|STTR Program will not consent to subcontracts with these contractors.

2.3 Defense SBIR|STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP) Registration

It is the SBCs responsibility to ensure that the firm's DSIP account profile information correlates to the data found within the firm's SAM registration. This includes, but is not limited to the following:

- 5-Digit Commercial and Government Entity Code
- 12-Digit UEI
- Legal Business Name
- "Doing Business As" Name
- Physical Address

Failure to correlate the SBCs entity information between the DSIP application and SAM and/or submit required certifications may significantly delay funding agreement award or become grounds for cancellation of the funding agreement.

3.0 PROPOSAL PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS AND REQUIREMENTS

3.7 Phase I Proposal Instructions

The following proposal instructions supplement, and in some cases, supersede, those found within the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, including any amendments/revisions/appendices.

a. Proposal Coversheet (Volume 1)

The proposal coversheet is prepared on DSIP and in accordance with the DoW solicitation.

b. Technical Volume Format (Volume 2)

Proposals shall adhere to the formatting instructions provided in the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, including any amendments/revisions, as supplemented by the technical volume formatting requirements described herein. Information provided in these Service/Component-specific proposal instructions take precedence over any instructions listed in the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO. **Submissions that fail to conform to the technical volume formatting requirements shall be deemed unresponsive.**

1. **File Type**: The Technical Volume shall be a single Adobe Acrobat (supporting Windows 10-11) Portable Document Format (.pdf) searchable text format file, including graphics. PDF files that cannot be opened using Adobe Acrobat products may be rejected by the Government. Perform a virus check before uploading the technical volume file. If a virus is detected, the proposal may be rejected. Do not lock, password protect or encrypt the uploaded file. Do not include or embed active graphics, such as videos, moving pictures, or other similar media, in the document.

2. **Length**: The Technical Volume shall not exceed seven (7) pages including all key sections described in Section 3.7(c), Technical Volume Content. The seven (7) page limit applies to the entire Technical Volume submission as uploaded to DSIP. At the Government's discretion, if included in the submission, pages that clearly do not substantiate or contribute to the technical approach, such as a cover sheet or table of contents, may be excluded from the page count. However, any appendices or supplemental content/materials that expand upon the requirements described in section 3.7(c), shall count toward the seven (7) page limitation. SBCs may allocate any portion of the technical volume page limit to each of the key sections, as desired. It is the proposing SBCs responsibility to ensure that the Technical Volume file uploaded to DSIP complies with the stated page limitation.

3. **Layout**: Number all proposal pages consecutively. Submit a direct, concise, and informative research or R&D proposal (no type smaller than 10-point on standard 8-1/2" x 11" paper with one-inch margins, including the header). The header on each page of the technical volume, which may be included in the one-inch margin, should contain the proposing SBC's name, topic number, and the DSIP assigned proposal number from the cover sheet.

4. **General**:
   - Technical volume MUST be a single Adobe Acrobat PDF file
   - Graphics are strongly encouraged to be included throughout the white paper as you see fit. Ensure they are logical and easy to read. Supporting images should be thoughtful and visually attractive.
   - For plots and charts: Include title, caption, axes labels, and be sure to include scale.
   - Avoid jargon and define all technical terms
   - Use the "Compress Pictures" feature to reduce file size when possible.

c. Technical Volume Content (Volume 2)

The following technical volume content instructions supersede those stated in the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, including any amendments/revisions/appendices.

Offerors must address the requirements outlined for the Non-Proprietary Work Plan in Supporting Documents (Volume 5). This overview should directly reflect the key elements of the

technical approach detailed in this volume, ensuring consistency between both documents.

The Technical Volume shall be structured in the following order:

i. **Introduction;**
ii. **Army Benefits;**
iii. **Technical Approach;**
iv. **Programmatic Potential; and**
v. **Commercial Potential**

Each of the key sections align directly with the evaluation rubric, Phase I Evaluation Criteria (Appendix A), ensuring clarity in how proposals will be assessed. The following outlines the specific content expectations for each section of the Technical Volume, as guided by the evaluation criteria in Appendix A. Offerors should ensure their proposals clearly address the key elements identified in the rubric to maximize the proposal's competitiveness.

i. **Introduction**: Write a clear, concise description of what your innovation does or will do, and where you are in your evolution. Make clear its intended impact on the Army. Evaluators should "get it" after reading this.

ii. **Army Benefits**: Briefly describe any identified Army use cases, the solutions' advantages and potential level of impact and scale of impact the solution would have for the Army. If you are unsure how an Army end-user might benefit from this technology or the scale of impact it could have, please provide an analogous use case to allow the Army evaluators a way to connect the dots using their knowledge of potential Army use cases when evaluating this section. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:
   - **Alignment.** Argue your technology innovation is aligned with this Army topic's priorities as defined in the solicitation.
   - **Solution's Advantages.** Prove your prospective customers will choose you given limited resources and myriad choices. Have you accounted for indirect substitute products as well as direct competitors?
   - **Solution's Impact.** The Army seeks higher-risk, high-impact solutions through SBIR - not engineering changes or incremental improvements. Use this section to describe your technology's impact and improvement upon the state of the art.

iii. **Technical Approach**: Provide details and supporting data on how the proposer is going to solve the problem. It shall detail key elements of the firm's approach, the technical team, and any risks and mitigation plans identified. Use data to substantiate your claims that your technical risk mitigation plans are credible. Show us quality data attributed to reliable, credible sources. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:
   - **Scientific Feasibility.** Convince readers that your innovation is built atop sound scientific and/or engineering principles. Ensure that your feasibility argument adequately responds to the requirements this Army topic.
   - **Enabling Technologies.** Do the required enabling technologies introduce added risk?
   - **Technical Team.** Briefly list and describe your core scientific and technical team with an emphasis on their past accomplishments and experiences that would relate to this Army SBIR topic.

- **Technical Risk and Mitigation Plans.** Describe any technical risks that still exist between you and a fully mature solution and your plans to mitigate those risks.

iv. **Programmatic Potential**: Outline where your company is today, what will be accomplished under this SBIR effort with Army customer discovery and in identifying the risks and mitigation plans for successfully transitioning beyond SBIR funding into a contract with an Army or integration with an Army system. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:

- **Project Milestone Schedule.** Outline your execution plan. What milestones do you hope to accomplish, and what deliverables if any do you hope to produce during this phase and subsequent phases of the effort.
- **Army Customer Discovery and Validation.** Argue you are "getting out of the building" to engage in productive customer-discovery with Army stakeholders and describe any customer validation you may have received formally or informally to date on this proposed technology.
- **Army Transition Pathways.** Describe the next type of deal you aim to make with the Army following this award. Briefly outline your current plan to unlock that next opportunity and/or share the biggest risks you see post this SBIR award to transition this technology to the Army.

v. **Commercialization Potential**: Highlight any commercial market for this solution that the DoW can build upon. Describe your past success and future potential in commercial applications. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:

- **R&D to Product Revenue.** Argue that your team members have transitioned research and development efforts into products successfully, as evidenced by product revenue. (Product revenue is realized by directly selling a solution to solve a problem vs. selling consulting, services, or research activities.)
- **Competitive Edge.** Why will you win? A small company needs to have a competitive edge in the marketplace: Something your team does very well that is difficult to match. Some examples may include: well protected intellectual property; unmatched relevant experience; a novel business model; network effects; etc.
- **Other People's Money.** Make the case for the commercial market (non-DoW) potential of your technology from which the Army will benefit.

d. Cost Volume Content (Volume 3)

Cost and duration limits are detailed within each topic. With the exception of the instructions provided below, Offerors must comply with all Cost Volume (Volume 3) requirements outlined in the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO. Note: Options are not anticipated at this time. If an option is identified in the topic posting, costs for the Base and Option shall be separated and clearly identified.

In anticipation of a possible contract award, all proposed costs shall be accompanied by documentation to substantiate how the cost was derived. Failure to include supporting documentation with the proposal may delay any potential contract award, as the proposer will be asked to submit the necessary documentation to the Contracting Officer to substantiate costs. It is important to respond as quickly as possible to the Contracting Officer's request for documentation. Failure or refusal to provide documentation may result in dissolution of the contract action.

e. Company Commercialization Report (Volume 4)
Completion of the CCR as Volume 4 of the proposal submission in DSIP is required for prior SBIR|STTR awardees. Please refer to the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO for full details on this requirement.

f. Supporting Documents (Volume 5)
Volume 5 is provided for proposing SBCs to submit additional documentation to support the Cover Sheet (Volume 1) and the Technical Volume (Volume 2), and the Cost Volume (Volume 3). A completed proposal submission in DSIP does NOT indicate that the mandatory supporting documents have been uploaded. It is the responsibility of the proposing SBC to ensure that the mandatory documents listed above have been uploaded and included with the proposal submission.

All proposing SBCs are REQUIRED to submit the following documents to Volume 5:

1. Non-Proprietary Work Plan: This summary, which should be based upon the technical approach discussed in your Technical Volume (Volume 2), is subject to a two (2) page limit and should provide a clear and concise overview of the proposed project's technical objectives, key milestones and their target completion dates, associated key deliverables, and the anticipated project duration. This information will serve as the basis for publicly releasable information about the project and will serve as the basis for establishing performance requirements within the contract. Therefore, the summary should be written in a manner understandable to a technically literate audience without disclosing sensitive or proprietary information.
2. Key Personnel Table. This table must identify all key personnel expected to execute work on the project, including individuals from the prime, subcontractors, or Research Institution (as applicable). Failure to provide this information may significantly delay selection, and/or any potential contract award. The table must include the following information for each individual:
    a. Employee Name
    b. Labor Category
    c. Description of Work to be Performed on the Project
    d. Employee (Prime, Subcontractor, Consultant, Research Institution)
    e. Country of Origin

All proposing SBCs are required to submit the following documents to Volume 5, *if applicable*:

3. Verification of Eligibility of Small Business Joint Ventures
4. Assertion of use, release, or disclosure restriction (in accordance with DFARS 252.227-7017)
5. DD Form 2345, Military Critical Technical Data Agreement – Applicable to actions subject to ITAR
6. Foreign National/Persons Information
   Identify any foreign citizens or individuals expected to be involved on your project as a direct employee, subcontractor, or consultant. For these individuals, please specify their country of origin, the type of visa or work permit under which they are performing and an explanation of their anticipated level of involvement on this project. **Note**: You may be asked to provide additional information during proposal evaluation and/or negotiations in

order to verify the foreign citizen's eligibility to participate on a SBIR contract.

7. Justification for SBC-selected TABA vendor
   In two (2) pages or less, clearly demonstrate the firm-selected TABA provider's unique qualifications and suitability for your project. Provide the TABA vendor's firm name and the point of contact's name, email address, and phone number. Detail the specific reasons this TABA provider is uniquely qualified to address your project's needs, focusing on their relevant expertise, experience, and specialized capabilities. Clearly outline the tasks they will perform, including the purpose and objectives of their assistance in relation to your project goals. Include a cost breakdown with the total cost of TABA services, the number of support hours, and labor rates (an average/blended rate is acceptable). Remember, the TABA provider cannot be your firm or any affiliated entity, and TABA costs must be directly related to their services, excluding indirect costs, profit, or fees passed through by your company.

In addition to the Volume 5 requirements, the Department of the Army may accept the following documents in Volume 5:

8. Cost/Pricing Information
9. SBIR|STTR Funding Agreement Certification
10. Other (only as specified in the topic)

Please only submit documents that are identified immediately above, and as required by the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO. All other documents submitted will be disregarded, including but not limited to promotional and non-project related information.

g. Fraud, Waste and Abuse Training (Volume 6)
Fraud, Waste and Abuse training material can be found in the Volume 6 section of the proposal submission module in DSIP and must be thoroughly reviewed once per year to proceed with proposal submission.

h. Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7)
SBCs must complete the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries webform in Volume 7 of the DSIP proposal submission.

Please be aware that the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries WILL NOT be accepted as a PDF Supporting Document in Volume 5 of the DSIP proposal submission. Do not upload any previous versions of this form to Volume 5. For additional details, please refer to the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO.

3.8 Phase II Proposal Information
Unless a Topic posting specifies that the DA will be accepting Direct to Phase II proposal submissions, Phase II proposals may only be submitted by Phase I awardees. Submission of Phase II proposals is not permitted at this time, and if submitted, will be rejected without evaluation. Phase II proposal preparation and submission instructions will be provided via subsequent notification.

3.9 Direct to Phase II (DP2) Proposal Instructions
Offerors may submit DP2 proposals only if allowed pursuant to the topic posting. With the exception of

the DP2 component specific proposal instructions for the Technical Volume (Volume 2), identified below, DP2 Proposals shall follow the Phase I Proposal Instructions described above.

b. Technical Volume Format (Volume 2)

2. **Length**: The Technical Volume shall not exceed 15 pages including all key sections described in Section 3.9(c), Technical Volume Content. The 15-page limit applies to the entire Technical Volume submission as uploaded to DSIP. At the Government's discretion, if included in the submission, pages that clearly do not substantiate or contribute to the technical approach, such as a cover sheet or table of contents, may be excluded from the page count. However, any appendices or supplemental content/materials that expand upon the requirements described in section 3.9(c), shall count toward the 15-page limitation. SBCs may allocate any portion of the technical volume page limit to each of the key sections, as desired. It is the proposing SBCs responsibility to ensure that the Technical Volume file uploaded to DSIP complies with the stated page limitation.

c. Technical Volume Content (Volume 2)

The following instructions supersede those stated in the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, including any amendments/revisions/appendices.

Offerors must address the requirements outlined for the Non-Proprietary Work Plan in Supporting Documents (Volume 5). This overview should directly reflect the key elements of the technical approach detailed in this volume, ensuring consistency between both documents.

The Technical Volume shall be structured in the following order:

i. **Introduction;**
ii. **Army Benefits;**
iii. **Feasibility for Direct to Phase II;**
iv. **Technical Approach;**
v. **Programmatic Potential; and**
vi. **Commercial Potential**

Each of the key sections align directly with the evaluation rubric, Direct to Phase II Evaluation Criteria (Appendix B), ensuring clarity in how proposals will be assessed. The following outlines the specific content expectations for each section of the Technical Volume, as guided by the evaluation criteria in Appendix B. Offerors should ensure their proposals clearly address the key elements identified in the rubric to maximize the proposal's competitiveness.

i. **Introduction**: Write a clear, concise description of what your innovation does or will do, and where you are in your evolution. Make clear its intended impact on the Army. Evaluators should "get it" after reading this.

ii. **Army Benefits**: Briefly describe any identified Army use cases, the solutions' advantages and potential level of impact and scale of impact the solution would have for the Army. If you are unsure how an Army end-user might benefit from this technology or the scale of impact it could have, please provide an analogous use case to allow the Army evaluators a way to connect the dots using their knowledge of potential Army use cases when evaluating this section. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:

- **Alignment.** Argue your technology innovation is aligned with this Army topic's priorities as defined in the solicitation.
- **Solution's Advantages.** Prove your prospective customers will choose you given limited resources and myriad choices. Have you accounted for indirect substitute products as well as direct competitors?
- **Solution's Impact.** The Army seeks higher-risk, high-impact solutions through SBIR - not engineering changes or incremental improvements. Use this section to describe your technology's impact and improvement upon the state of the art.

iii. **Feasibility for Direct to Phase II:** Provide documentation that demonstrates the scientific and technical merit, feasibility, and commercialization potential of ideas that would otherwise have been accomplished in a SBIR Phase I feasibility study. Use data to substantiate your claims. Documentation should include all relevant information including, but not limited to: technical reports, test data, prototype designs/models, and performance goals/results. Work submitted within this section must have been substantially performed by the proposer and/or the Principal Investigator. Feasibility documentation cannot be based upon any prior or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR work and DP2 proposals MUST NOT logically extend from any prior or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR work. DP2 authority is intended for companies that have matured their technologies ***outside*** of the SBIR/STTR pipeline, and who are ready for Phase II development without requiring a Phase I feasibility study. This ensures that DP2 funding is directed towards novel, non-SBIR/STTR funded R&D, rather than the continuation or repurposing of work already supported through prior SBIR/STTR awards. Proposals that derive from previously funded SBIR/STTR work are not eligible for DP2 consideration. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:

- **Proof of Feasibility.** Provide documentation to substantiate the scientific and technical merit and feasibility has been met.
- **Work Ownership.** Document the people, organizations, and any intellectual property (IP) ownership responsible for the work products in this section. The work must have been at least "substantially" performed by your organization and/or the proposed principal investigator for this research, and your firm must either own any IP discussed outright or have appropriate and sufficient licenses thereto.
- **New Research.** Prove that the proposed DP2 research is not in any way a logical extension of previous or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR research.
- **Prototype Delivery.** Demonstrate that the research will result in appropriately mature Prototype at the conclusion of the DP2 SBIR contract.

iv. **Technical Approach**: Provide details and supporting data on how the proposer is going to solve the problem. It shall detail key elements of the firm's approach, the technical team, and any risks and mitigation plans identified. Use data to substantiate your claims that your technical risk mitigation plans are credible. Show us quality data attributed to reliable, credible sources. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:

- **Scientific Feasibility.** Convince readers that your innovation is built atop sound scientific and/or engineering principles. Ensure that your feasibility argument adequately responds to the requirements this Army topic.
- **Enabling Technologies.** Do the required enabling technologies introduce added

risk?

- **Technical Team.** Briefly list and describe your core scientific and technical team with an emphasis on their past accomplishments and experiences that would relate to this Army SBIR topic.
- **Technical Risk and Mitigation Plans.** Describe any technical risks that still exist between you and a fully mature solution and your plans to mitigate those risks.

v. **Programmatic Potential**: Outline where your company is today, what will be accomplished under this SBIR effort with Army customer discovery and in identifying the risks and mitigation plans for successfully transitioning beyond SBIR funding into a contract with an Army or integration with an Army system. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:

- **Project Milestone Schedule.** Outline your execution plan. What milestones do you hope to accomplish, and what deliverables if any do you hope to produce during this phase and subsequent phases of the effort.
- **Army Customer Discovery and Validation.** Argue you are "getting out of the building" to engage in productive customer-discovery with Army stakeholders and describe any customer validation you may have received formally or informally to date on this proposed technology.
- **Army Transition Pathways.** Describe the next type of deal you aim to make with the Army following this award. Briefly outline your current plan to unlock that next opportunity and/or share the biggest risks you see post this SBIR award to transition this technology to the Army.

vi. **Commercialization Potential**: Highlight any commercial market for this solution that the DoW can build upon. Describe your past success and future potential in commercial applications. The rubric prompts below are provided to guide you in preparing this section:

- **R&D to Product Revenue.** Argue that your team members have transitioned research and development efforts into products successfully, as evidenced by product revenue. (Product revenue is realized by directly selling a solution to solve a problem vs. selling consulting, services, or research activities.)
- **Competitive Edge.** Why will you win? A small company needs to have a competitive edge in the marketplace: Something your team does very well that is difficult to match. Some examples may include: well protected intellectual property; unmatched relevant experience; a novel business model; network effects; etc.
- **Other People's Money.** Make the case for the commercial market (non-DoW) potential of your technology from which the Army will benefit.

3.10 Expeditionary Technologies (xTech) Prize Competition Selectees

This section applies exclusively to companies selected as winners in Part 2 of the respective Expeditionary Technologies (xTech) Prize Competition. These companies, having successfully pitched their solutions to Army and DoW experts, are the only SBCs eligible to submit Army SBIR proposals under the corresponding topic area.

xTech Prize Competition selectees must follow the Army Phase I Proposal Submission Instructions, with one important exception regarding the Technical Volume (Volume 2). In lieu of submitting a full Technical Volume (Volume 2), xTech selectees shall submit the Non-Proprietary Work Plan, outlined in

Section f. Supporting Documents (Volume 5) of the Army Phase I Proposal Submission Instructions, in place of a Technical Volume. This waives the requirement to include the Non-Proprietary Work Plan in Volume 5 – Supporting Documents. Ensure your Non-Proprietary Work Plan adheres to the guidelines outlined in Section f. Supporting Documents (Volume 5), including the two (2) page limitation.

All remaining proposal volumes, including any applicable and/or optional documents discussed in Section f. Supporting Documentation (Volume 5) must be completed according to the standard Army Phase I Proposal Submission Instructions.

NOTE: The Technical Evaluation (Section 4.1.2) and Selection (Section 4.1.3) guidance defined below do not apply to xTech Prize Competition selectees. Your proposals have already undergone a comprehensive evaluation as part of the xTech competition.

3.11 Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI)

Successful firms will be required to comply with CUI DoDI 5200.48. Firms must monitor CUI for aggregation and compilation based on the potential to generate classified information pursuant to security classification guidance addressing the accumulation of unclassified data or information. Firms shall report the potential of classification of aggregated or compiled CUI to ASA(ALT) Security Manager. Firms, pursuant to mandatory DoW contract provisions, will submit unclassified DoW information for review and approval for release and approval for release in accordance with the standard DoDI 5230.09. All CUI records must follow the approved mandatory disposition authorities whenever the DoW provides CUI to, or CUI is generated by, non-DoW entities in accordance with Section 1220-1236 of Title 36, CFR, Section 3301a of Title 44, U.S.C., DoDI 5200.48.

3.12 Arms, Ammunition, and Explosives (AA&E)

If the proposed statement of work requires the use, development, production, manufacture, purchase, or delivery of Arms, Ammunition and Explosives (AA&E) data and/or hardware, the offeror shall follow the following instructions:

a. References:

    1. MIL-STD-1168 - Ammunition Lot Numbering and Ammunition Data Cards
    2. DODM 5100.76 - Physical Security of Sensitive Conventional Arms, Ammunition, and Explosives (AA&E)
    3. AR 190-11 - Physical Security of Arms, Ammunition, and Explosives
    4. Defense Transportation Regulation 4500.9-R
    5. Technical Bulletin (TB) 700-2

b. The offeror, in its proposal, and resulting contractor, in performance of the work, shall comply with the requirements of the following DFARS provisions/clauses:

    1. 252.223-7002, Safety Precautions for Ammunition and Explosives (NOV 2023);
    2. 252.223-7003, Change in Place of Performance-Ammunition and Explosives (DEC 1991); and
    3. 252.223-7007, Safeguarding Sensitive Conventional Arms, Ammunition, and Explosives (NOV 2023).

c. The offeror, in its proposal, and resulting contractor, in performance of the work, shall provide proper storage and accountability. These standards are set forth in Department of War (DOW) 5100.76-M, entitled "Physical Security of Sensitive Conventional Arms, Ammunition and Explosives".

d. Prior to any contract award, the offeror must first pass a pre-award physical security inspection of its and its subcontractor's facilities, conducted by Defense Security Service (DSS). See DOD 5100.76-M, Appendix 2, Attachment 1, for a listing of DSS regions. Facilities, including any subcontractor facilities, that do not meet all of the security requirements of DOD 5100.76-M will not be awarded a contract.

e. If the proposed statement of work requires transportation of Sensitive Conventional AA&E, the standards set forth in Defense Transportation Regulation 4500.9-R., Defense Traffic Management, shall be followed.

f. Place of Performance: In accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) provision/clause 52.215-6, Place of Performance (OCT 1997), and DFARS provision/clause 252.223-7003, Change in Place of Performance—Ammunition and Explosives (DEC 1991), the offeror shall include the following information in Volume 5 of its proposal. Failure to include this information in proposals involving AA&E may result in the proposal being deemed unresponsive.

    1. The offeror, in the performance of any contract resulting from this solicitation, □ intends, □ does not intend [check applicable block] to use one or more plants or facilities located at a different address from the address of the offeror as indicated in its proposal.
    2. If the offeror or respondent checks "intends" in paragraph (a), it shall include the following required information for each and every plant or facility (including subcontractor plants or facilities) located at a different address from the address of the offeror as indicated in its proposal.
        i. Firm Name
        ii. Place of Performance (Street Address, City, State, County, ZIP Code)
        iii. Name and Address of Owner and Operator of the Plant or Facility

g. In accordance with local procedures and DFARS provision/clause 252.223-7007, Safeguarding Sensitive Conventional Arms, Ammunition, and Explosives (NOV 2023), the offeror shall include the following information in Volume 5 of its proposal for itself and for each plant or facility (including subcontractor plants or facilities) that the offeror listed as a "Place of Performance". The offeror shall include the information to the best of its ability in order to avoid delay in contract award. Do not include locations that will not use, develop, produce, manufacture, purchase, or deliver AA&E in performance of the work.

    1. Firm Name
    2. Identify if the firm is the prime-contractor or sub-contractor
    3. Place of Performance (Street Address, City, State, County, ZIP Code)
    4. Unique Entity Identification (UEI) and Cage Code
    5. Confirm that address and cage code match the information in SAM.gov ("unknown" is an acceptable response if unable to look up sub-contractors)
    6. Full name, phone number, and email address for a point of contact at this location
    7. Description of the AA&E and/or work involving AA&E
    8. National Stock Number (NSN) of the AA&E (if none exist, indicate "N/A")

9. Identify the Security Risk Classification (SRC) of the AA&E (Instructions for determining the SRC are found in Enclosure 7 (p. 40 - p.46) of DODM 5100.76) (The SRC can be either I, II, III, IV or U) ("unknown" is an acceptable response if Government input is required to make this determination)
10. Identify the hazard classification (HC) of the AA&E (Instructions for determining the HC are found in Chapter 2 (p.2) of TB 700-2) ("unknown" is an acceptable answer if Government input is required to make this determination)
11. Identify whether the AA&E will be furnished by the Government as Government Furnished Property (GFP) or if it will be developed, produced, manufactured, or purchased by the prime or sub-contractor

4.0 METHOD OF SELECTION AND EVALUATION CRITERIA

4.1 Evaluation Process

4.1.1 Initial Screening

Proposals will only be evaluated in response to an active, corresponding Army topic. Proposals will be initially screened to determine responsiveness, timeliness, and SBC eligibility. Assessment of responsiveness and eligibility may continue during technical evaluation, and after selection. For purposes of this solicitation, these terms are defined as:

Responsiveness: When a proposal fails to meet a material requirement of the solicitation, to include compulsory terms and conditions, the proposal shall be deemed unresponsive.

Timeliness: A Timely Proposal is one that is received by the Government on or before the due date and prior to the established set time.

SBC Eligibility: To be eligible, SBCs must meet all requirements listed in the "Eligibility" section, Title 13 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Section 121.702, and the SBA SBIR|STTR Policy Directive.

4.1.2 Technical Evaluation (Not Applicable to xTech Prize Competition Selectees)

Proposals passing the initial screening will receive a technical evaluation using 'Valid Eval,' a secure, cloud-based assessment and feedback system employed by the Army under an enterprise software license. The platform enables the Army to invite and manage evaluators, capture feedback, and organize assessments using structured scoring rubrics. It also facilitates evaluator assignment and compiles inputs into visualizations, such as heatmaps and statistical overviews that support consistent application of the evaluation criteria. Valid Eval does not evaluate proposals, participate in deliberations, or make aware recommendation to the Army's source selection authority. All evaluation judgments and decisions remain solely the responsibility of the Government.

Each proposal is reviewed by a cadre of subject matter experts (typically engineers, scientists, and/or program managers) against the evaluation criteria outlined in the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, with further guidance provided by the Army's Phase I and Direct to Phase II evaluation rubrics (Appendix A and B respectively). These Army-specific criteria provide additional detail, including sub-dimensions and elements for consideration, as described in Appendices A and B, and further explained under section 4.2, Evaluation Criteria, below.

It is the policy of the Army to ensure equitable and comprehensive proposal evaluations based on the evaluation criteria, and to select the source (or sources) whose proposal best meets the Government's technical, policy, and programmatic objectives. Selections for further consideration of possible contract award will be based on a determination of the overall technical merit of each proposal. As a common statement of work does not exist, each proposal is assessed on their own individual merit to determine how well the proposal meets the criteria stated in this CSO and the corresponding opportunity. Proposals will not be evaluated against each other during the evaluation process.

Note: Designated support contractors may review submissions for the purposes of technical evaluation. All support contractors are bound by appropriate non-disclosure agreements.

4.1.3 Selection (Not Applicable to xTech Prize Competition Selectees)

Proposing firms will be notified via email of selection or non-selection status of its Phase I or DP2 proposal within 90 days of the closing date of the Topic. The notification will be sent to the Corporate Official listed on the proposal cover sheet, from the Army SBIR|STTR Program Office mailbox.

Selected proposals are not guaranteed a contract award. Proposers shall not regard the notification email (selection decision notice) as an authorization to commit or expend funds. Upon selection, proposals are forwarded to a Government Contracting Officer for further evaluation and contract negotiation. A Government Contracting Officer may contact the proposer to discuss and request additional information required for award. This may include representations and certifications, certified or other than certified cost data, and/or other information as applicable to the proposed award. Proposers shall not regard these communications as an authorization to commence work or commit or expend funds.

4.2 Evaluation Criteria

To apply the DoW Evaluation criteria, the Army uses structured scoring rubrics that are developed and approved by Army SBIR|STTR program stakeholders. These rubrics, which are implemented in Valid Eval, define the evaluation factors, scoring scales, and any assigned weightings applied, ensuring proposals are evaluated consistently, transparently, and in direct alignment with the solicitation's stated criteria.

Please refer to Appendices A and B for the Army's Phase I and Direct to Phase II evaluation rubrics, respectively.

4.3 Proposal Status and Feedback

The Army promotes transparency regarding the technical evaluation for all Army SBIR proposals. The Army will provide feedback to offerors in accordance with the SBA SBIR|STTR Policy Directive. The selection decision notice contains instructions for obtaining feedback. Offerors are entitled to no more than one feedback per proposal.

NOTE: Feedback is not the same as a FAR Part 15 debriefing. The competitive procedures for this solicitation are governed by the SBA SBIR|STTR Policy Directive. Therefore, offerors are neither entitled to, nor will they be provided FAR Part 15 debriefs.

4.5 Pre-Award and Post Award Protests

Pre-award agency protests related to the terms of the CSO must be served to the point of contact listed in the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO.

Post award agency protests related to a selection or award decision must be served to the following address:

Email: usarmy.SBIRSTTR@army.mil
Mailing Address:
U.S. Army SBIR|STTR Office
2530 Crystal Drive; Suite 11192
Arlington, Virginia 22202

Firms shall follow the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO for protests filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO) and size protests regarding the small business status of a selected proposing small business concern.

5.0 ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

5.1 Award Information

a. Number of Awards. The number of awards will depend upon funds availability. The Army reserves the right to award none, one, or more than one contract under any topic. No awards will be made until evaluation of all qualified proposals for a specific topic have been made. The Army is not responsible for costs incurred before award receipt.

b. Type of Funding Agreement. The Army plans to execute funding agreements as FAR-based, firm-fixed-price contracts. Fixed price payments shall be tied to measurable milestones or deliverables, as agreed to by the Government. Milestone schedules are used as a means to monitor technical progress, to mitigate technical and cost risk, and to address the cashflow needs of awardees. The Government Contracting Officer retains the right to negotiate a contract type and price (or estimated cost and fee) that will promote the Government's interest, result in reasonable contractor risk, and provide the contractor with the greatest incentive for efficient and economical performance (FAR Subpart 16.1 – Selecting Contract Types).

c. Dollar Value and Period of Performance. Award funding guideline and associative period of performance limitations have been established for each SBIR|STTR Topic. **Proposals exceeding these limitations will be deemed unresponsive**.

5.1.1 Additional Award Considerations

a. Contractor Responsibility: SBCs will be evaluated for responsibility, meaning the prospective SBC meets the standards set forth in FAR 9.104. A prospective contractor must affirmatively demonstrate its responsibility, including, when necessary, the responsibility of its proposed subcontractors.

b. Use of Foreign Nationals/Persons: In considering an SBC's utilization of foreign national personnel, the Government may withdraw from negotiations based on deleterious findings associated with a firm's Foreign Disclosure (Volume 7) or matters of national security not limited to: persons tied to foreign countries of concern; foreign influence or ownership; inability to clear the firm or personnel for security clearances; risk associated with Military Critical Technologies;

or other related issues.

c. Fair and Reasonable Price: In accordance with FAR 15.402(a), Contracting officers shall purchase supplies and services from responsible sources at fair and reasonable prices. As a result, Contracting Officials will conduct proposal analysis in accordance with the techniques identified at FAR 13.106-3 and/or 15.404-1. Proposals lacking a fair and reasonable price will be deemed unsuccessful.

5.1.2 Possible Contract Award

If at any point the proposal is deemed untimely, unresponsive, or the SBC (or its subcontractors) is deemed ineligible or non-responsible, the proposal will be unsuccessful, meaning the proposal is not one that will result in an award (it is un-awardable). Successful proposals, therefore, are those that have met all stated requirements and qualifications and will receive an award.

Upon an affirmative determination of proposal timeliness, responsiveness, compliance, and price reasonableness, as well as prospective contractor eligibility and responsibility, the Contracting Officer may proceed with an award, subject to the availability of funds. Unless a Government Contracting Officer signs an award document (e.g., contract), no obligations to provide funding are made. The Government may cancel award of the contract action at any time.

If signed by the Government Contracting Officer, the award document is the official and authorizing instrument, thereafter, referred to as the "contract". The period of performance will begin upon the effective date of the contract. The Contracting Officer will email the signed contract to the principal investigator and/or an authorized organization representative.

5.2 Contract Requirements

In addition to the contractual requirements specified in the DoW 2026 SBIR Program CSO, awards under the Army SBIR|STTR Program are also subject to the following:

5.2.1 Deliverable Requirements

a. Hardware (Prototype) Deliverables (if applicable): See topic for information to determine if development and delivery of prototypes is required. If your proposal identifies hardware that will be delivered to the government, be aware of the possible requirement for unique item identification in accordance with DFARS Clause 252.211- 7003, Item Unique Identification and Valuation. More information regarding item identification and valuation requirements may be found at DFARS Section 211.274.

b. Data Deliverables (Contract Data Requirements Lists – CDRLS):
Data can be in the form of test data, computer software, algorithms, design details, progress reports, technical data, financial or management reports, or any information required by contract to be delivered. Data is ordered using single or multiple DD Form 1423, Contract Data Requirements Lists (CDRLS), which will be located in the contract at Section J, Exhibits. A CDRL is the "data delivery" vehicle providing the what, when, who, and how of the delivery. CDRLS require the contractor to formally deliver the data (contractual obligation) to the Government. Each CDRL will reference a Data Item Description (DID) that describes data content, format, media, and intended use of a single data product. Each DID is uniquely numbered to identify the data deliverables in terms of purpose, description, requirements, and

preparation instructions. DIDs may be viewed using the Acquisition Streamlining and Standardization Information System (ASSIST).

All funding agreements executed under the Army SBIR|STTR Program shall include the following CDRL requirements:

1. Status Reports: Under the authority of DID number DI-MGMT-80368A, status reports are due at a specified time after contract award and periodically (e.g., Monthly, Bi-monthly, Quarterly) thereafter in accordance with the prepared DD Form 1423 that will be incorporated via Section J, Exhibits of any resultant contracts.

2. Scientific and Technical Report: Under the authority of DID number DI-MISC-80711A, a final report shall be delivered in accordance with the prepared DD Form 1423 that will be incorporated via Section J, Exhibits of any resultant contract.

The Army end-user or customer may require additional deliverables or documentation including Software documentation and user manuals; Engineering drawings; Operation and Maintenance documentation; Safety hazard analysis when the project will result in partial or total development/ delivery of hardware; and/or updated commercialization results.

5.2.2 Meeting Requirements:

a. Start of Work Meeting: The contractor shall hold a start of work meeting at its facility, unless some other location is designated in the contract, within 30 calendar days after contract award. The Start of Work Meeting is to assure a clear and mutual understanding of the contract terms, conditions, line items, technical requirements and sequence of events needed for successful execution of the contracted effort. The contractor shall coordinate with the Government to arrange a schedule and agenda for the meeting.

b. Periodic (e.g., Monthly, Bi-Monthly, Quarterly) Review Meetings: Periodic review meetings shall be conducted to monitor and report on status of contractor effort towards achieving contract objectives, identify accomplishments to date and difficulties encountered, and compare the status achieved to planned goals and the resources expended.

5.6 Invention Reporting

In accordance with FAR clause 52.227-11, “Patent Rights-Ownership by the Contractor”, and DFARS clause 252.227-7039, “Patents – Reporting of Subject Inventions”, the contractor shall execute the following:

a. Interim Report of Inventions and Subcontracts: Under all Phase II SBIR contracts, the contractor shall deliver an Interim Report of Inventions and Subcontracts, DD Form 882,12-months from the date of initial contract award, listing subject inventions during that period and stating that all subject inventions have been disclosed or that there are no such inventions.

b. Final Report of Inventions and Subcontracts: Under all Phase I and Phase II SBIR contracts, the contractor shall deliver a Final Report of Inventions and Subcontracts, DD Form 882, within six

(6) months after completion of the contracted work, listing all subject inventions or stating that there were no such inventions.

c. SBIR awardees must report inventions within two months of the inventor's report to the awardee. The reporting of inventions may be accomplished by submitting paper documentation, including fax, or through the Edison Invention Reporting System at www.iedison.gov.

6.0 PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

6.3 Contact Information

SBC's may direct questions to the following Points of Contact, as described below:

a. Army Component Specific Proposal Instructions: General questions regarding the administration of the Army SBIR Program, and the Army Component-Specific Proposal Instructions should be submitted as soon as possible, but not later than 15 days prior to solicitation closing, and can be directed to the following:
Email: usarmy.SBIRSTTR@army.mil
Website: https://www.armysbir.army.mil/
Mailing Address: U.S. Army SBIR|STTR Office
2530 Crystal Drive, Suite 11192
Arlington, Virginia 22202

Army 2026 SBIR CSO Topic Index
Release 1

ARM26BX01-NV001 TITLE: In Transit Visibility Blockchain

- Phase I (Feasibility)
- 1-6 months, up to $300,00

ARM26BX01-NV002 TITLE: Modular Payloads for UAS

- Phase I (Feasibility)
- 1-3 months, up to $150,000

Note: The topic listed below is part of the xTech|Phantum Prize Competition. See the full xTech|Phantum competition RFI here: https://www.xtech.army.mil/competitions/
xTech|Phantum will be used to identify small business concerns that meet the criteria for award. Winners selected from the xTech|Phantum prize competition will be the only firms eligible to submit a SBIR proposal under topic ARM26BX01-NP003. Proposals submitted by non-winners of the xTech|Phantum competition will not be evaluated.

ARM26BX01-NP003 TITLE: xTechPhantum Competition

- Phase I (Feasibility)
- 1-6 months, up to $300,000
- **Deadline to Apply:** May 13, 2026 via link above

ARM26BX01-NV001 TITLE: In Transit Visibility Blockchain

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Applied Artificial Intelligence (AAI); Quantum and Battlefield Information Dominance (Q-BID);

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Advanced Computing and Software; Integrated Sending and Cyber; Quantum Science; Trusted AI & Autonomy

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 1

OBJECTIVE: This topic seeks to develop and optimize a real-time In-Transit Visibility (ITV) system that enables military commanders and logistical staff from Corps to Battalion level to overcome limitations in tracking and managing the movement of supplies and personnel through the integration of data from various enterprise systems and sensor technologies. The objective is to enhance command and control (C2) of logistical operations for improved situational awareness and responsiveness, enabling proactive redirection of assets, accurate arrival time predictions, and efficient resource allocation while minimizing delays, disruptions, and manual data processing.

DESCRIPTION: Military logistics systems offer significant potential for improvement, yet their ability to fully address the complexities of modern operations is limited by disparate data sources, manual reporting processes, and a lack of real-time visibility into the movement of assets. To overcome these challenges, novel approaches that integrate decentralized distributed ledger, sensor fusion, automated data collection, and user-friendly visualization tools within the Command Post Computing Environment (CPCE) are needed to enable a robust and adaptive ITV capability.
This topic focuses on advancing near real-time logistics tracking and management, with a specific emphasis on providing commanders with a comprehensive common operating picture (COP) of the location, status, and contents of all in-transit assets (Classes of Supply I-X). Proposed solutions should prioritize interoperability, modularity, and scalability, ensuring that the ITV system can be integrated across various existing military platforms (AFRL's distributed ledger technology infrastructure, CPCE, mobile handheld devices, mounted systems) and enterprise databases (TCAIMS-II, IBS, GATES, CMOS) with minimal customization. Research should explore predictive modeling algorithms, user-defined alert systems, and secure data sharing protocols to ensure reliability, resilience, and security under dynamic operational conditions.
The performance metrics outlined below are intended as target thresholds, not hard requirements, and are meant to illustrate the desired technical capabilities. Proposals that meet some, but not all, of the listed metrics or that propose alternative approaches will be evaluated equally and are strongly encouraged. The goal is to cast a wide net and support a range of innovative technologies aligned with the problem space.
Quantifiable Performance Requirements:

- Proposals should address the following measurable technical performance metrics:
- Location Accuracy: The system should achieve 95% accuracy in reporting the location of tracked assets under various operational environments.
- Update Frequency: The system should provide location updates at a minimum of every 15 minutes for ground transport and every 15 minutes for air transport.
- System Latency: End-to-end latency from data acquisition to display on the COP should not exceed 3 minutes.
- Platform Compatibility: The solution should operate effectively across CPCE, mobile handheld, and mounted computing environments, requiring no more than 10% system redesign or configuration for each platform.
- Deployment Time: Deployment/setup time for deploying a single tracker should not exceed 1 hour, and user training should require no more than 2 hours.

- Physical tags: Should be multi-modal, to include the ability to leverage satellite, cell towers, and internet. The tags should also be able to transmit encrypted data to AFRL's existing distributed ledger technology infrastructure.
- Distributed Ledger Technology: Should be able to tokenize assets, creating a digital twin and be able to connect with AFRL's existing distributed ledger technology and be able to create a unique chain that interoperates with AFRL's existing one.

Proposal Expectations:
Successful proposals should include hypothesis-driven research that combines fundamental modeling with prototype development or proof-of-concept demonstration. Teams must outline an experimental validation plan, including testing in simulated operational scenarios with representative data sets and user interactions , with clearly defined success criteria for each milestone. Cross-disciplinary approaches, integrating software engineering, data analytics, human-computer interaction, and military logistics expertise, are strongly encouraged.

PHASE I: This topic is accepting Phase I submissions for a cost limit of $300,000 and a 6-month period of performance.
A white paper outlining how the proposer will meet the expected metrics outlined in the topic description.

PHASE II: A successful deliverable is a distributed ledger that should be able to tokenize assets, creating a digital twin and be able to connect with AFRL's existing distributed ledger technology and be able to create a unique chain that interoperates with AFRL's existing one.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS:
1. Supply Chain & Asset Tracking: Enables faster, more accountable disaster relief operations. Supports interagency coordination across federal, state, and local responders. Ensures asset provenance and reduces fraud during urgent mobilizations. Strengthens public trust and delivery of mission-critical aid.
2. Fraud Prevention in Grants/Contracts: Addresses a high-visibility government risk area: financial accountability. Improves the auditability and efficiency of public sector funds distribution. Demonstrates responsible tech innovation by stopping fraud before it scales. Applicable across FEMA disaster grants, COVID relief, education funding, or infrastructure stimulus. Reinforces the government’s stewardship mission.
3. Tamper-Proof Government Records: Mission Relevance: Ensures continuity of governance and auditability of official data in contested or degraded environments. Aligns with continuity-of-operations planning
4. Transportation & logistics: Used in real-time, multimodal shipment tracking and custody handoffs with automated milestone verification.
5. Retail & e-commerce: Used in fulfillment visibility, returns fraud mitigation, and last-mile proof-of-delivery.
6. Pharmaceuticals & healthcare: Used in compliant track-and-trace, cold-chain condition logging, and recall execution.
7. Food & agriculture: Used in provenance tracking, contamination traceback, and sustainability/ethical sourcing attestation.
8. Airports & industrial campuses: Used in workforce credentialing, zone access logs, and synchronized movement tracking of personnel and critical assets.

REFERENCES:
1. https://breakingdefense.com/2025/01/blockchain-big-data-and-genai-us-army-usesnovel-tech-to-track-billions-in-ukraine-aid/

KEYWORDS: Distributed-ledger; tokenization; blockchain; encryption; in transit visibility

ARM26BX01-NV002 TITLE: Modular Payloads for UAS

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Applied Artificial Intelligence (AAI); Quantum and Battlefield Information Dominance (Q-BID);

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Human-Machine Interfaces; Integrated Sending and Cyber; Trusted AI & Autonomy

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 1

OBJECTIVE: The objectives for this effort are to enhance and refine various payload types and integrate them using a modular specification for unmanned aircraft systems (UAS). Experimentation, testing, and evaluation for this effort will use a Soldier-centered iterative design process.

DESCRIPTION: Current UAS and payloads are often proprietary and designed to be mission-specific. Some systems offer swappable payloads; however, these payloads aren't interchangeable across UAS manufacturers, and additional capabilities depend on the same manufacturer developing new payloads. To maximize battlefield usability, the Army needs the ability to swap payloads using common connections. This solicitation supports a directed requirement for brigade-level UAS by developing payload technologies that will inform future UAS requirements and unit-level tactics, techniques, and procedures. The intent is to explore, test, refine, and advance modular payload technologies as an industry-government team, experimenting iteratively through Soldier touchpoints.

The selected vendor will deliver a modular payload and integrate the payload with one or more government-provided UAS platforms. Desired types of modular payloads include the following:

- Electro-optical (EO) and infrared (IR) laser rangefinder and designator
- Communications relay (voice and data)
- Electronic warfare (EW)
- Signals intelligence
- Cargo resupply up to 20 lb
- Other novel payloads that can provide Soldiers an offensive or defensive advantage

In this effort, awardees are asked to adapt their payload technology for compatibility with the Picatinny Common Lethality Interface Kit (CLIK) specification developed by DEVCOM Armaments Center. The Picatinny CLIK specification defines a physical interface, electrical connection, and signals to enable the integration of lethal and nonlethal payloads with small UAS. The references section of this solicitation contains a link to the Army Applications Laboratory topic page that links to the Picatinny CLIK specification. Vendors will also have the option to collaborate with DEVCOM Armaments Center to continue to refine the Picatinny CLIK specification.

Awardees will collaborate with UAS vendors to integrate their payloads with one or more government-provided UAS and demonstrate interoperability. The UAS platform provided by the government will have capabilities of upper Group 2 or lower Group 3 UAS, with payload capacity of at least 20 lb. Once awardees have integrated their payloads using Picatinny CLIK, they will provide their payloads for unit field experimentation and further refine their payload technology. The vendor should specify in their proposal how they intend to enhance their technology throughout the period of performance using the feedback provided through the Soldier-centered iterative design process.

Examples of desirable technology improvements include, but are not limited to:

- Reducing size, weight, power, and cost (SWaP-C) of the payload
- Working toward compliance with relevant standards, airworthiness, and packaging requirements

- Improving user interface and autonomous behaviors
- Compatibility with a broader variety of UAS and controllers, including common controllers such as UVC (Uncrewed Vehicle Control)

PHASE I: This topic is for Phase I submission only. The Department of the Army will accept Phase I proposals for a cost of up to $150,000 for a 3-month period of performance. In Phase I, awardees will collaborate with government stakeholders and UAS vendors to plan for the integration of their payloads using Picatinny CLIK, along with developing plans for technology improvements to their payloads.
Phase I deliverables will include:

- Technical designs for integration of the awardee's payload with one or more government-provided UAS and for technology improvements to the payload
- Initial Safety Assessment Report (SAR), technical documentation, test plans, and other information required to obtain approval for hands-on Soldier touchpoints and experimentation
- Participation in a virtual kickoff and in-person final presentation, along with virtual touchpoints
- Monthly reports that document technical progress
- A Phase II proposal, if desired by the vendor

PHASE II: Phase II is anticipated to have a 12-month period of performance. In Phase II, awardees will deliver prototypes of their modular payloads adapted to use the Picatinny CLIK specification, and will support hands-on experimentation to make iterative improvements to their technology.
Phase II deliverables will include:

- A quantity of at least 2 of the modular payload, to be left behind with units at the conclusion of the period of performance
- Integration of the modular payload with one or more government-provided UAS using the Picatinny CLIK specification
- Support for Soldier experimentation touchpoints at unit locations to perform Soldier-centered iterative design. Proposers should budget for a total of 5 trips with a duration of 1 week per trip to unit locations or experiment sites within the continental U.S. Proposals should include all anticipated personnel, travel costs, and support equipment
- Integration of experimentation results into technology improvements to the payload
- Monthly reports that document lessons learned from experimentation and their application to technology development
- Proposal for a sequential award, if desired by the vendor, to continue technology development based on lessons learned from experimentation

The following timeline illustrates the concept of execution during the Phase II period of performance. Awardees should anticipate timeline changes during execution due to technology development risk, unit availability for experimentation, and scheduled experimentation events. Applicants may propose timelines that follow the general model below.

- Month 1-2: Adapt the payload to use the Picatinny CLIK specification based on plans developed during Phase I. Collaborate with UAS vendors to integrate the payload with government-provided UAS. Continue touchpoints with Soldiers and Army organizations. Deliver an updated Safety Assessment Report (SAR) and other documentation to support safety releases for Soldier testing.
- Month 3-10: Deliver quantity 2 of the modular payload adapted to use the Picatinny CLIK specification. Train Soldiers to use the modular connection and payload. Support experimentation touchpoints and use Soldier-centered iterative design to improve the payload technology.
- Month 11-12: Deliver the final payload prototypes to the unit. Attend a culminating training event or experiment with the unit to further experiment with and develop the payload technology. Demonstrate interoperability of the payload with government-provided UAS using the Picatinny CLIK specification. Finalize and document payload technology improvements and lessons learned.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS:

- Cargo delivery
- Law enforcement sensing and surveillance
- UAS-based communications

REFERENCES:

1. Army Applications Laboratory. Modular Payloads for UAS (Topic Page). Contains a link to information about the Picatinny CLIK specification. https://aal.mil/modular-payloads-uas/
2. Continuous Transformation: Transformation in Contact. Military Review. Gen. James E. Rainey, U.S. Army. https://www.armyupress.army.mil/Journals/Military-Review/Online-Exclusive/2024-OLE/Transformation-in-Contact/
3. Aviation Today. "Army Looks To Field Brigade UAS." https://www.aviationtoday.com/2025/08/21/after-ftuas-cut-army-looks-to-field-brigade-uas-in-fy-26-to-replace-shadow-drones/

KEYWORDS: UAS, UAV, Payloads, Modularity, Communications, Electronic Warfare, Signals Intelligence, Cargo

ARM26BX01-NP003 TITLE: xTech|Phantum Competition

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Quantum and Battlefield Information Dominance (Q-BID); Quantum Science; Integrated Sensing and Cyber; Integrated Network Systems-of-Systems

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Integrated Sending and Cyber; Quantum Science; Integrated Network Systems-of-Systems

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 1

OBJECTIVE: The U.S. Army is seeking innovative quantum sensor and photonics solutions from eligible small businesses across the U.S. through the xTech|Phantum competition. This platform offers participants the opportunity to engage with the Department of War (DoW), earn prize money and submit a Phase I Army Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) proposal.

The Assistant Secretary of the Army for Acquisition, Logistics and Technology (ASA(ALT)) is partnering with the U.S. Army Directorate for Strategy & Transformation (DAMI-ST) to deliver the xTech|Phantum competition. The Army recognizes that the DoW must enhance engagements with U.S. small businesses by (1) understanding the spectrum of world-class technologies being developed commercially that may benefit the DoW; (2) integrating the sector of non-traditional innovators into the DoW Science and Technology (S&T) ecosystem; and (3) providing expertise and feedback to accelerate, mature, and transition technologies of interest to the DoW.

DESCRIPTION:

Note: The topic listed below is part of the xTech|Phantum Prize Competition. See the full xTech|Phantum competition RFI here: https://www.xtech.army.mil/competitions/.

xTech|Phantum will be used to identify small business concerns that meet the criteria for award. Winners selected from the xTech|Phantum prize competition will be the only firms eligible to submit a SBIR proposal under the topic listed above. Proposals submitted to the topic listed above by non-winners or non-participants of the xTech|Phantum competition will not be evaluated.

May 13, 2026: White paper submission deadline via link above

Topic 1: Quantum Sensors and Quantum Clocks for Position, Navigation, and Timing (PNT)

Topic Objective: The objective of this topic is to advance and develop quantum sensor and quantum clock technologies that support non-GPS position, navigation, and timing (PNT) capabilities.

Topic Description: The Army is seeking innovative quantum sensors and quantum clocks to supplement existing GPS systems and provide alternative PNT functionality in the event of GPS failure or non-availability:

1. Quantum sensors (e.g., inertial, magnetic, etc.) that enable accurate positioning information for ground vehicles, aircraft, and munitions navigation without requiring GPS.
2. Quantum clocks that provide precise time references, improve time-difference-of-arrival (TDOA) calculations, and enable reliable, non-GPS PNT solutions.

Topic 2: Quantum Radio Frequency Sensors

Topic Objective: The objective of this topic is to advance the development of quantum sensor technologies that can provide field-demonstrable alternatives to existing radio frequency (RF) antenna systems.

Topic Description: The Army is seeking novel radio frequency (RF) sensors leveraging quantum mechanics that provide wider access to the RF spectrum, more sensitive reception of signals, and greater flexibility in the size, weight and power (SWaP) compared to existing Army radio frequency (RF) systems. This topic intends to further develop these sensors with a focus on ruggedization (hardening for temperature and environmental conditions such as weather, dust, etc.) and miniaturization. Key application areas include:

1. Ultra-wideband RF sensing, with the ability to cover exceedingly large frequency ranges (ELF-EHF) from a single antenna aperture without the need to change hardware.
2. Ultra-sensitive RF sensing, with the ability to pull signals out of the noise floor of a loud RF environment or increase the range of detection of signals.

Topic 3: Quantum Electromagnetic Sensors

Topic Objective: The objective of this topic is to advance the development of quantum sensor technologies with a narrower frequency range for detection of low power, non-RF electromagnetic fields.

Topic Description: The Army is seeking quantum electromagnetic sensors outside of the radio frequency range that can augment use cases with narrower frequency ranges.

1. Detection of low power static fields:
    a. Field sensors that can detect minute environmental anomalies, such as magnetic or gravitational disturbances, to identify subsurface, terrestrial, air and space vehicles (e.g., stealth aircraft, submersibles, etc.). Small, light, and low-power systems are preferable to enable sensors to be located on both aerial platforms (e.g., Group 1 and 2 UAS, High Altitude Balloon Systems, etc.) and ground platforms (e.g., vehicles, robots, etc.).
    b. Field sensors that can detect minute environmental anomalies, such as magnetic or gravitational disturbances, to identify hidden underground bunkers, tunnels, or resource caches. Small, light, and low-power systems are preferable to enable sensors to be located on both aerial platforms (e.g., Group 1 and 2 UAS, High Altitude Balloon Systems, etc.) and ground platforms (e.g., vehicles, robots, etc.).
2. Detection of bioelectric activity in the human body: Small form factor electric field sensors that can measure electrical signals in the human body (e.g., electroencephalograms and electrocardiograms) accurately and quickly to augment field medicine.

Topic 4: Photonics

Topic Objective: The objective of this topic is to advance and develop innovative technologies that leverage photonics for secure, high-speed communication and data processing.

Topic Description: The Army is seeking advanced and scalable photonics components and systems to enhance mission-critical capabilities in communication and edge processing. Key application areas include:

1. Secure, High-Bandwidth Communications:
    a. High-speed optical electronics for rapid, high-volume data transfer.

b. Secure and resilient data links between assets (air-to-ground, ship-to-shore). Functionality through smoke, camouflage, and all weather is preferable, as well as resilience to electronic warfare attacks (e.g., jamming, interception). Data link range should reflect the targeted platform (e.g., 35km or less for Group 1 and 2 UAS, 1,000+km for high altitude platforms and jets, etc.).
c. High-bandwidth line-of-sight communications for transferring large files. Functionality through smoke, camouflage, and all weather is preferable, as well as resilience to electronic warfare attacks (e.g., jamming, interception). Multiple applications are of interest:
    i. Transferring data from the edge to Battalion and Brigade headquarters at a range of 2-35km.
    ii. Transferring data from brigade headquarters to Echelons above Corps at a range of 1,000+ km.
    iii. Transferring data from on-the-move robots, vehicles, or aircraft traversing the battlefield to fixed sites at a range of 1,000+ km.

2. Edge Processing & Computing:
    a. Photonic components or integrated circuits optimized for real-time, onboard analysis of sensor data at the point of collection, such as object recognition from hyperspectral video feeds and pre-processing of data on unmanned platforms. Applications of interest span multiple data types, from small microsensor outputs to large full motion video feeds.
    b. Photonic components that replace conventional RF electronics (e.g., in voice and data radios, SATCOM, RADAR) to reduce size, weight, and power (SWaP) while increasing resilience and performance.

PHASE I: This topic is accepting Phase I submissions for a cost limit of $300,000 and a 6-month period of performance. Only winners of the xTech|Phantum competition are permitted to submit a phase I proposal for this topic.

Companies will complete a feasibility study that demonstrates the firm's competitive technical advantage relative to other commercial products (if other products exist) and develop concept plans for how the company's technology can be applied to Army modernization priority areas. Studies should clearly detail and identify a firm's technology at both the individual component and system levels, provide supporting literature for technical feasibility, highlight existing performance data, showcase the technology's application opportunities to a broad base of customers outside the defense space, a market strategy for the commercial space, how the technology directly addresses the Army's modernization area as well as include a technology development roadmap to demonstrate scientific and engineering viability.

At the end of Phase I, the company will be required to provide a concept demonstration of their technology to demonstrate a high probability that continued design and development will result in a Phase II mature product.

PHASE II: Produce prototype solutions that will be easy to operate by a Soldier. These products will be provided to select Army units for further evaluation by the soldiers. In addition, companies will provide a technology transition and commercialization plan for DOD and commercial markets.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: Complete the maturation of the company's technology developed in Phase II to TRL 6/7 and produce prototypes to support further development and commercialization. The Army will evaluate each product in a realistic field environment and provide small solutions to stakeholders for further evaluation. Based on soldier evaluations in the field, companies will be requested to update the previously delivered prototypes to meet final design configuration.

REFERENCES:

1. https://www.xtech.army.mil/competitions/

KEYWORDS: Quantum Sensors; Position, Navigation, and Timing (PNT); Radio Frequency (RF) Sensors; Size, Weight, and Power (SWaP), Electromagnetic; UAS; Photonics

Appendix A
Army Phase I Evaluation Criteria

Army SBIR STTR Phase I Evaluation Criteria v4-0

		DEFINITION
INTRODUCTION	*weight 3%*	Write a clear, concise description of what your innovation does or will do, and where you are in your evolution. Make clear its intended impact on the Army. Evaluators should "get it" after reading this.
ARMY BENEFITS	ALIGNMENT	Argue your technology innovation is aligned with this Army topic's priorities as defined in the solicitation.
	SOLUTION'S ADVANTAGES	Prove your prospective customers will choose you given limited resources and myriad choices. Have you accounted for indirect substitute products as well as direct competitors?
weight 15%	SOLUTION'S IMPACT	The Army seeks higher-risk, high-impact solutions through SBIR/STTR not engineering changes or incremental improvements. Use this section to describe your technology's impact and improvement upon the state of the art.
TECHNICAL APPROACH	SCIENTIFIC FEASIBILITY	Convince readers that your innovation is built atop sound scientific and/or engineering principles. Ensure that your feasibility argument adequately responds to the requirements this Army topic.
	ENABLING TECHNOLOGIES	Do the required enabling technologies introduce added risk?
	TECHNICAL TEAM	Briefly list and describe your core scientific and technical team with an emphasis on their past accomplishments and experiences that would relate to this Army SBIR/STTR topic.
	TECHNICAL RISKS AND MITIGATION PLANS	Describe any technical risks that still exist between you and a fully mature solution. What are your plans to mitigate those risks?
weight 35%	DATA QUALITY, TECHNICAL	Use data to substantiate your claims that your Technical Approach (this section of your proposal) is credible. Provide quality data attributed to reliable, credible sources.
PROGRAMMATIC POTENTIAL	PROJECT MILESTONE SCHEDULE	Outline your execution plan. What milestones do you hope to accomplish, and what deliverables (if any) do you hope to produce during this phase and subsequent phases of the effort?
	ARMY CUSTOMER DISCOVERY & VALIDATION	Argue you are "getting out of the building" to engage in productive customer-discovery with Army stakeholders. Describe any customer validation you may have received formally or informally to date on this proposed technology.
weight 20%	ARMY TRANSITION PATHWAY	Describe the next type of deal you aim to make with the Army following this award. Briefly outline your current plan to unlock that next opportunity and/or share the biggest risks you see post this SBIR/STTR award to transition this technology to the Army.
COMMERCIAL POTENTIAL	R&D TO PRODUCT REVENUE	Argue that your team members have transitioned research and development efforts into products successfully, as evidenced by product revenue. (Product revenue is realized by directly selling a solution to solve a problem vs. selling consulting, services or research activities.)
	COMPETITIVE EDGE	Why will you win? A small company needs to have a competitive edge in the marketplace: Something your team does very well that's difficult to match. Some examples include: well protected intellectual property, unmatched relevant expertise, a novel business model, or network effects.
weight 25%	OTHER PEOPLE'S MONEY	Make the case for the commercial market (non-DOD) potential of your technology from which the Army will benefit.
PROPOSAL QUALITY	QUALITY OF PROSE	Provide a clear, well written, and convincing proposal. Avoid jargon and define technical terms.
weight 2%	IMAGES, CHARTS, GRAPHICS	Graphics are encouraged throughout. Ensure they are logical and easy to read. Supporting images should be thoughtful and visually attractive. For plots and charts include: title, axis labels and captions. For technical images include appropriate scales or legends.

Army SBIR STTR Phase I Evaluation Criteria v4-0

		UNSATISFACTORY	MARGINAL	SATISFACTORY	SUPERIOR
INTRODUCTION	*weight 3%*	Ineffective introduction. Failed to provide concise innovation proposition.	Adequate introduction. Gradually conveyed innovation's purpose and value. Should be more crisp.	Effective introduction. Systematically conveys innovation's purpose and value.	Exceptional introduction. Immediately conveys innovation's purpose and value.
ARMY BENEFITS	ALIGNMENT	Not aligned with this Army topic's priorities.	Somewhat aligned with this Army topic's priorities.	Aligned with this Army topic's priorities.	Perfectly aligned with this Army topic's priorities.
	SOLUTION'S ADVANTAGES	No evidence of competitive analysis. Undifferentiated product.	Incomplete or too narrow competitive analysis. Weak product differentiation.	Thorough competitive analysis. Strongly differentiated product. Accounted for most substitutes.	Persuasive competitive analysis. Highly differentiated, accounted for all substitutes, provides novel solution.
weight 15%	SOLUTION'S IMPACT	If successful, no improvement vs. the state of the art.	If successful, incremental improvement vs. the state of the art.	If successful, significant improvement vs. the state of the art.	If successful, radical improvement vs. the state of the art.
TECHNICAL APPROACH	SCIENTIFIC FEASIBILITY	No scientific basis for presented approach.	Incomplete scientific basis for presented approach.	Credible scientific basis for presented approach.	Convincing scientific basis for presented approach.
	ENABLING TECHNOLOGIES	Requires nonexistent or unavailable technology.	Requires emerging, cutting edge technology.	Requires proven technologies.	Requires Army-fielded technologies.
	TECHNICAL TEAM	Technical people lack qualifications OR have no experience.	Technical people are somewhat qualified and have some experience.	Technical people are highly qualified OR have significant experience.	Technical people are highly qualified AND have significant experience.
	TECHNICAL RISKS AND MITIGATION PLANS	Failed to present challenges and risks.	Inadequate risk analysis. Mitigation marginally addressed.	Credible risk analysis. Mitigation effectively addressed.	Highly credible risk analysis. Mitigation convincingly addressed.
weight 35%	DATA QUALITY, TECHNICAL	Poorly supported by data. Little to no data attribution.	Partially supported by data. Some data attribution.	Credibly supported by data. Adequate data attribution.	Persuasively supported by meaningful data. Comprehensive data attribution.
PROGRAMMATIC POTENTIAL	PROJECT MILESTONE SCHEDULE	Unclear or non-credible project milestones, or timing.	Mostly clear, credible project milestones and timing. Mostly appropriate level of detail.	Mostly clear, credible project milestones and timing. Appropriate level of detail.	Completely clear, credible project milestones and timing. Appropriate level of detail.
	ARMY CUSTOMER DISCOVERY & VALIDATION	No customer interviews completed. No validation.	A handful customer interviews completed. No validation.	Extensive interviews completed. Early validation beginning to inform transition strategy.	Exhaustive interviews completed. Validation informs credible transition strategy.
weight 20%	ARMY TRANSITION PATHWAY	Fails to identify next contract goal and/or fails to present a plan for near-term execution.	Identifies next contract goal. Has a plan for near-term execution.	Identifies stage-appropriate next contract goal. Credible plan for near-term execution.	Identifies ideal next contract goal. Convincing plan for near-term execution.
COMMERCIAL POTENTIAL	R&D TO PRODUCT REVENUE	No evidence of creating product revenue from R&D efforts.	Evidence of R&D yielding product revenue at previous company(ies).	Evidence of R&D yielding product revenue at this company.	Evidence of R&D yielding product revenue sufficient to fuel this company's growth.
	COMPETITIVE EDGE	Undifferentiated firm. Fails to argue it has an advantage.	Weakly differentiated firm. Some evidence of an advantage.	Strongly differentiated firm. Credibly argues it has durable advantage.	Highly differentiated firm. Convincingly argues it has durable advantage.
weight 25%	OTHER PEOPLE'S MONEY	Fails to present non-DoD sources for future R&D funding.	Evolving non-DoD sources of future R&D funding.	Secure non-DoD source(s) of future R&D funding.	Diverse and robust non-DoD sources of future R&D funding.
PROPOSAL QUALITY	QUALITY OF PROSE	Poorly written. Very difficult to impossible to follow argument. Several spelling or grammar errors.	Moderately written. Sometimes difficult to follow argument. A few spelling / grammar errors.	Effectively written. Convincing, easy to follow argument. No spelling or grammar errors.	Clearly and persuasively written. Compelling arguments. No spelling or grammar errors.
weight 2%	IMAGES, CHARTS, GRAPHICS	Poor visual aids. Often difficult to understand, distracting, or irrelevant.	Inadequate visual aids. Sometimes difficult to understand, distracting, or irrelevant.	Effective visual aids. Support argument in relevant ways, aiding comprehension.	Exceptional visual aids. Greatly enhance delivery and understanding.

Appendix B
Army Direct to Phase II Evaluation Criteria

Army SBIR DP2 Evaluation Criteria

		DEFINITION
INTRODUCTION	weight 2%	Write a clear, concise description of what your innovation does or will do, and where you are in your evolution. Make clear its intended impact on the Army. Evaluators should "get it" after reading this.
ARMY BENEFITS	ALIGNMENT	Argue your technology innovation is aligned with this Army topic's priorities as defined in the solicitation.
	SOLUTION'S ADVANTAGES	Prove your prospective customers will choose you given limited resources and myriad choices. Have you accounted for indirect substitute products as well as direct competitors?
weight 15%	SOLUTION'S IMPACT	The Army seeks higher-risk, high-impact solutions through SBIR/STTR not engineering changes or incremental improvements. Use this section to describe your technology's impact and improvement upon the state of the art.
FEASIBILITY FOR DP2	PROOF OF FEASIBILITY	Provide documentation to substantiate the scientific and technical merit and feasibility has been met.
	WORK OWNERSHIP	Document the people and organizations and any intellectual property (IP) ownership responsible for the work products in this section. The work must have been at least "substantially" performed by your organization and/or the proposed principle investigator for this research, and your firm must either own any IP discussed outright, or has appropriate and sufficient licenses thereto.
	NEW RESEARCH	Prove that the proposed DP2 research is a not in any way a logical extension of previous or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR research.
weight 15%	PROTOTYPE DELIVERY	Demonstrate that the research will result in appropriately mature Prototype at the conclusion of the DP2 SBIR contract.
TECHNICAL APPROACH	SCIENTIFIC FEASIBILITY	Convince readers that your innovation is built atop sound scientific and/or engineering principles. Ensure that your feasibility argument adequately responds to the requirements this Army topic.
	ENABLING TECHNOLOGIES	Do the required enabling technologies introduce added risk?
	TECHNICAL TEAM	Briefly list and describe your core scientific and technical team with an emphasis on their past accomplishments and experiences that would relate to this Army SBIR/STTR topic.
	TECHNICAL RISKS AND MITIGATION PLANS	Describe any technical risks that still exist between you and a fully mature solution. What are your plans to mitigate those risks?
weight 25%	DATA QUALITY, TECHNICAL	Use data to substantiate your claims that your Technical Approach (this section of your proposal) is credible. Provide quality data attributed to reliable, credible sources.
PROGRAMMATIC POTENTIAL	PROJECT MILESTONE SCHEDULE	Outline your execution plan. What milestones do you hope to accomplish, and what deliverables (if any) do you hope to produce during this phase and subsequent phases of the effort?
	ARMY CUSTOMER DISCOVERY & VALIDATION	Argue you are "getting out of the building" to engage in productive customer-discovery with Army stakeholders. Describe any customer validation you may have received formally or informally to date on this proposed technology.
weight 20%	ARMY TRANSITION PATHWAY	Describe the next type of deal you aim to make with the Army following this award. Briefly outline your current plan to unlock that next opportunity and/or share the biggest risks you see post this SBIR/STTR award to transition this technology to the Army.
COMMERCIAL POTENTIAL	R&D TO PRODUCT REVENUE	Argue that your team members have transitioned research and development efforts into products successfully, as evidenced by product revenue. (Product revenue is realized by directly selling a solution to solve a problem vs. selling consulting, services or research activities.)
	COMPETITIVE EDGE	Why will you win? A small company needs to have a competitive edge in the marketplace: Something your team does very well that's difficult to match. Some examples include: well protected intellectual property, unmatched relevant expertise, a novel business model, or network effects.
weight 20%	OTHER PEOPLE'S MONEY	Make the case for the commercial market (non-DOD) potential of your technology from which the Army will benefit.
PROPOSAL QUALITY	QUALITY OF PROSE	Provide a clear, well written, and convincing proposal. Avoid jargon and define technical terms.
weight 3%	IMAGES, CHARTS, GRAPHICS	Graphics are encouraged throughout. Ensure they are logical and easy to read. Supporting images should be thoughtful and visually attractive. For plots and charts include: title, axis labels and captions. For technical images include appropriate scales or legends.

Army SBIR DP2 Evaluation Criteria

		UNSATISFACTORY	MARGINAL	SATISFACTORY	SUPERIOR
INTRODUCTION	weight 2%	Ineffective introduction. Failed to provide concise innovation proposition.	Adequate introduction. Gradually conveyed innovation's purpose and value. Should be more crisp.	Effective introduction. Systematically conveys innovation's purpose and value.	Exceptional introduction. Immediately conveys innovation's purpose and value.
ARMY BENEFITS	ALIGNMENT	Not aligned with this Army topic's priorities.	Somewhat aligned with this Army topic's priorities.	Aligned with this Army topic's priorities.	Perfectly aligned with this Army topic's priorities.
	SOLUTION'S ADVANTAGES	No evidence of competitive analysis. Undifferentiated product.	Incomplete or too narrow competitive analysis. Weak product differentiation.	Thorough competitive analysis. Strongly differentiated product. Accounted for most substitutes.	Persuasive competitive analysis. Highly differentiated, accounted for all substitutes, provides novel solution.
weight 15%	SOLUTION'S IMPACT	If successful, no improvement vs. the state of the art.	If successful, incremental improvement vs. the state of the art.	If successful, significant improvement vs. the state of the art.	If successful, radical improvement vs. the state of the art.
FEASIBILITY FOR DP2	PROOF OF FEASIBILITY	Fails to demonstrate Feasibility of solution.	Partially demonstrates Feasibility of solution.	Successfully demonstrates Feasibility of solution.	Unquestionably demonstrates Feasibility of solution.
	WORK OWNERSHIP	Fails to document prior Feasibility work was substantially completed by the offeror and/or the PI, AND offer's IP rights are unclear.	Partially documents prior Feasibility work was substantially completed by the offeror and/or the PI, AND offeror's rights to any necessary IP.	Sufficiently documents prior Feasibility work was substantially completed by the offeror and/or the PI, AND offeror's rights to any necessary IP.	Persuasively documents prior Feasibility work was substantially completed by the offeror and/or the PI, AND offeror's rights to any necessary IP.
	NEW RESEARCH	This research is likely a logical extension of offeror's prior SBIR / STTR work.	This research might be a logical extension of offeror's prior SBIR / STTR work.	Evidence this research is not a logical extension of offeror's prior SBIR / STTR work.	Compelling evidence this research is not a logical extension of offeror's prior SBIR / STTR work, OR offeror has no prior SBIR / STTR contracts.
weight 15%	PROTOTYPE DELIVERY	Unlikely that an appropriately mature prototype can be delivered.	Flawed argument that an appropriately mature prototype can be delivered.	Credible argument that an appropriately mature prototype can be delivered.	Convincing argument that an appropriately mature prototype can be delivered.
TECHNICAL APPROACH	SCIENTIFIC FEASIBILITY	No scientific basis for presented approach.	Incomplete scientific basis for presented approach.	Credible scientific basis for presented approach.	Convincing scientific basis for presented approach.
	ENABLING TECHNOLOGIES	Requires nonexistent or unavailable technology.	Requires emerging, cutting edge technology.	Requires proven technologies.	Requires Army-fielded technologies.
	TECHNICAL TEAM	Technical people lack qualifications OR have no experience.	Technical people are somewhat qualified and have some experience.	Technical people are highly qualified OR have significant experience.	Technical people are highly qualified AND have significant experience.
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PROGRAMMATIC POTENTIAL	PROJECT MILESTONE SCHEDULE	Unclear or non-credible project milestones, or timing.	Mostly clear, credible project milestones and timing. Mostly appropriate level of detail.	Mostly clear, credible project milestones and timing. Appropriate level of detail.	Completely clear, credible project milestones and timing. Appropriate level of detail.
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weight 20%	ARMY TRANSITION PATHWAY	Fails to identify next contract goal and/or fails to present a plan for near-term execution.	Identifies next contract goal. Has a plan for near-term execution.	Identifies stage-appropriate next contract goal. Credible plan for near-term execution.	Identifies ideal next contract goal. Convincing plan for near-term execution.
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	COMPETITIVE EDGE	Undifferentiated firm. Fails to argue it has an advantage.	Weakly differentiated firm. Some evidence of an advantage.	Strongly differentiated firm. Credibly argues it has durable advantage.	Highly differentiated firm. Convincingly argues it has durable advantage.
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DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY (DON)
Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR)
DoW 2026 SBIR CSO Release 1
Phase I Open Topics Proposal Submission Instructions

IMPORTANT

- **The following instructions apply to topic:**
  - **DON26BX01-NP001**

- Submitting small business concerns (SBCs) are encouraged to thoroughly review the DoW SBIR/STTR Program Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) and register for the DSIP Listserv to remain apprised of important programmatic changes.
  - The DoW Program CSO is located at: https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/login.
  - Register for the DSIP Listserv at: https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/login.

- The information provided in the DON Proposal Submission Instructions takes precedence over the DoW Instructions posted for this CSO.

- Proposing SBCs that are more than 50% owned by multiple venture capital operating companies (VCOC), hedge funds (HF), private equity firms (PEF) or any combination of these are eligible to submit proposals in response to DON topics advertised in this CSO.

- Phase I Technical Volume (Volume 2) and Supporting Documents (Volume 5) templates, specific to DON topics, are available at https://www.navysbir.com/links_forms.htm.

- The DON provides notice that Prototype Other Transaction (OT) will be used for Phase I.

- This CSO is issued under regulations set forth in DFARS Subpart 212.70. and is considered competitive for the purposes of 10 U.S.C. chapter 127 and FAR 6.102. DON will treat items, technologies, and services acquired under this CSO as commercial items. This CSO includes no requirement for a commercial product or service to be an already-developed, off-the-shelf item. Please review the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO for more information.

INTRODUCTION

The DON SBIR/STTR Programs are mission-oriented programs that integrate the needs and requirements of the DON's Fleet through research and development (R&D) topics that have dual-use potential, but primarily address the needs of the DON. More information on the programs can be found on the DON SBIR/STTR website at www.navysbir.com.

For questions regarding this CSO use the information in Table 1.

TABLE 1: POINTS OF CONTACT FOR QUESTIONS REGARDING THIS CSO

Type of Question	When	Contact Information
Program and administrative	Always	Navy SBIR/STTR Program Management Office usn.pentagon.cnr-arlington-va.mbx.navy-sbir-sttr@us.navy.mil or appropriate Program Manager listed in Table 2 (below)

Topic-specific technical questions	CSO Pre-release	Technical Point of Contact (TPOC) listed in each topic on the DoW SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP). Refer to the Proposal Submission section of the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO for details.
	CSO Open	DoW SBIR/STTR Topic Q&A platform (https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions) Refer to the Proposal Submission section of the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO for details.
Electronic submission to the DoW SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP)	Always	DSIP Support via email at dodsbirsupport@reisystems.com
Navy-specific CSO instructions and forms	Always	DON SBIR/STTR Program Management Office usn.pentagon.cnr-arlington-va.mbx.navy-sbir-sttr@us.navy.mil

TABLE 2: DON SYSTEMS COMMANDS (SYSCOM) SBIR PROGRAM MANAGERS

Topic Numbers	Point of Contact	SYSCOM	Email
DON26BX01-NP001	Mr. Shadi Azoum	Naval Information Warfare Systems Command (NAVWAR)	info@navwarsbir.com

OPEN TOPIC SUBMISSIONS:
This CSO release contains Open Topics. As outlined in section 7 of the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022, innovation Open Topic activities—

a. Increase the transition of commercial technology to the DoW;
b. Expand the small business nontraditional industrial base;
c. Increase commercialization derived from investments of the DoW; and
d. Expand the ability for qualifying SBCs to propose technology solutions to meet the needs of the DoW.

Unlike Conventional Topics, which specify the desired technical objective and output, Open Topics can use generalized mission requirements or specific technology areas to adapt commercial products or solutions to close capability gaps, improve performance, or provide technological advancements in existing capabilities.

An SBC may only submit one (1) proposal to each Open Topic. If more than one proposal from an SBC is received for a single Open Topic, only the most recent proposal to be certified and submitted in DSIP prior to the submission deadline will receive an evaluation. All prior proposals submitted by the SBC for the same Open Topic will be marked as nonresponsive and will not receive an evaluation.

PHASE I SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

The following section details requirements for submitting a compliant Phase I proposal to the DoW SBIR/STTR Programs.

NOTE: Proposing SBCs are advised that support contract personnel will be used to carry out administrative functions and may have access to proposals, contract award documents, contract

deliverables, and reports. All support contract personnel are bound by appropriate non-disclosure agreements.

DoW SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP). Proposing SBCs are required to submit proposals via the DoW SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP); and follow proposal submission instructions in the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO on the DSIP at https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions. Please refer to the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO for further information.

Proposal Volumes. The following seven volumes are required.

- **Proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1).** As specified in DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO.

- **Technical Proposal (Volume 2)**
  - Technical Proposal (Volume 2) must meet the following requirements or the proposal will be REJECTED:
    - Not to exceed ten (10) pages, regardless of page content
    - Single column format, single-spaced typed lines, 8 ½" x 11" paper, margins one inch on all sides, font size of not less than 10-point
    - Include, within the ten-page limit of Volume 2, an Option that furthers the effort in preparation for Phase II and will bridge the funding gap between the end of Phase I and the start of Phase II. Tasks for both the Phase I Base and the Phase I Option must be clearly identified. Phase I Options are exercised upon selection for Phase II.
    - Work proposed for the Phase I Base must be exactly four (4) months.
    - Work proposed for the Phase I Option must be exactly six (6) months.

  - Additional information:
    - A Phase I Open Topic proposal template specific to DON to meet Phase I requirements is available at https://navysbir.com/links_forms.htm

- **Cost Volume (Volume 3).**
  - Cost Volume (Volume 3) must meet the following requirements or the proposal will be REJECTED:
    - The Phase I Base amount must not exceed $75,000.
    - Phase I Option amount must not exceed $100,000.
    - Costs for the Base and Option must be separated and clearly identified in Volume 3.
    - For Phase I, a minimum of two-thirds of the work is performed by the proposing SBC. The two-thirds percentage of work requirement must be met in the Base costs as well as in the Option costs. DON will not accept deviations from the minimum percentage of work requirements for Phase I. The percentage of work is measured by both direct and indirect costs. The following is used to calculate the minimum percentage of work:
      - Proposing SBC Costs (numerator for SBC calculation):
        - Total Firm Costs

        NOTE: G&A, if proposed, will only be attributed to the proposing SBC.
      - Subcontractor Costs (numerator for subcontractor calculation):
        - Total Subcontractor Costs (TSC)
      - Total Cost (i.e., Total Cost before Profit Rate is applied, denominator for either calculation)
    - **Cost Sharing: Cost sharing is not accepted on DON Phase I proposals. A value above or below $0.00 entered in the Cost Sharing field will not be considered in the Phase I contract award.**

- Additional information:
  - Provide sufficient detail for subcontractor, material, and travel costs. Subcontractor costs must be detailed to the same level as the prime contractor. Material costs must include a listing of items and cost per item. Travel costs must include the purpose of the trip, number of trips, location, length of trip, and number of personnel.
  - Inclusion of cost estimates for travel to the sponsoring SYSCOM's facility for one day of meetings is recommended for all proposals.
  - The "Additional Cost Information" of Supporting Documents (Volume 5) may be used to provide supporting cost details for Volume 3. A selected proposal may be required to submit further documentation to the SYSCOM Contracting Officer to substantiate costs.

- **Company Commercialization Report (Volume 4)**. DoW collects and uses Volume 4 and DSIP requires Volume 4 for proposal submission. Please refer to the Proposal Preparation Instructions and Requirements section of the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO for details to ensure compliance with DSIP Volume 4 requirements.

- **Supporting Documents (Volume 5).** Volume 5 is for the submission of administrative material that DON may require to process a proposal, if selected, for contract award.

  - Proposing SBCs must review and submit the following items, as applicable:
    - **Majority Ownership in Part.** Proposing SBCs that are more than 50% owned by multiple venture capital operating companies (VCOC), hedge funds (HF), private equity firms (PEF), or any combination of these as set forth in 13 C.F.R. § 121.702, are eligible to submit proposals in response to DON topics advertised within this CSO. Complete the certification as detailed under ADDITIONAL SUBMISSION CONSIDERATIONS.

  - Additional information:
    - Proposing SBCs may include administrative materials in Supporting Documents (Volume 5); a template is available at https://navysbir.com/links_forms.htm to provide guidance on optional material the proposing SBC may include in Volume 5:
      - Additional Cost Information to support the Cost Volume (Volume 3)
      - SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement Certification
      - Data Rights Assertion
      - Disclosure of Information (DFARS 252.204-7000)
      - Prior, Current, or Pending Support of Similar Proposals or Awards
      - Foreign Citizens
    - Details of Request for Discretionary Technical and Business Assistance (TABA), if proposed, is to be included under the Additional Cost Information section if using the DON Supporting Documents template.
    - Do not include documents or information to substantiate the Technical Volume (Volume 2) in Volume 5 (e.g., resumes, test data, technical reports, or publications). Such documents or information will not be considered.

- **Fraud, Waste and Abuse Training Certification (Volume 6)**. DoW requires Volume 6 for submission. Please refer to the Proposal Preparation Instructions and Requirements section of the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO for details.

- **Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7)**. In accordance with Section 4 of the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 and the SBA SBIR/STTR

Policy Directive, the DoW will review all proposals submitted in response to this CSO to assess security risks presented by SBCs seeking a Federally funded award. SBCs must complete the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries webform in Volume 7 of the DSIP proposal submission. Please refer to the Proposal Preparation Instructions and Requirements section of the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO for details.

PHASE I EVALUATION AND SELECTION

The following section details how the DON SBIR/STTR Programs will evaluate Phase I proposals.

Proposals meeting DSIP submission requirements will be forwarded to the DON SBIR/STTR Programs. Prior to evaluation, all proposals will undergo a compliance review to verify compliance with DoW and DON SBIR/STTR proposal eligibility requirements. Proposals not meeting submission requirements will be REJECTED and not evaluated. Due to limited funding, the DON reserves the right to limit the number of awards under any topic.

- **Proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1).** The Proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1) will undergo a compliance review to verify the proposing SBC has met eligibility requirements and followed the instructions for the Proposal Cover Sheet as specified in the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO.

- **Technical Volume (Volume 2).** The DON will evaluate and select Phase I proposals using the evaluation criteria specified in the Method of Selection and Evaluation Criteria section of the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO, with technical merit being most important, followed by qualifications of key personnel and commercialization potential of equal importance. The information considered for this decision will come from Volume 2. This is not a FAR Part 15 evaluation. Proposals will not be compared to one another.

- **Cost Volume (Volume 3).** The Cost Volume (Volume 3) will not be considered in the selection process and will only undergo a compliance review to verify the proposing SBC has met the requirements of Volume 3.

- **Company Commercialization Report (CCR) (Volume 4).** Not evaluated.

- **Supporting Documents (Volume 5).** Supporting Documents (Volume 5) will not be considered in the selection process and will only undergo a compliance review to ensure the proposing SBC has included items in accordance with the PHASE I SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS section above.

- **Fraud, Waste, and Abuse Training Certificate (Volume 6).** Not evaluated.

- **Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7)**. Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7) will be assessed as part of the Due Diligence Program to Assess Security Risks. Refer to the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO to ensure compliance with Volume 7 requirements.

ADDITIONAL SUBMISSION CONSIDERATIONS

This section details additional items for proposing SBCs to consider during proposal preparation and submission process.

Due Diligence Program to Assess Security Risks. The SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 (Pub. L. 117-183) requires the Department of War, in coordination with the Small Business Administration, to establish and implement a due diligence program to assess security risks presented by SBCs seeking a

Federally-funded award. Please review the Certifications and Registrations section of the DoW SBIR/STTR Program CSO for details on how DoW will assess security risks presented by SBCs. The Due Diligence Program to Assess Security Risks will be implemented for all Phases.

Discretionary Technical and Business Assistance (TABA). The SBIR and STTR Policy Directive section 9(b) allows the DON to provide TABA to its awardees. The purpose of TABA is to assist awardees in making better technical decisions on SBIR/STTR projects; solving technical problems that arise during SBIR/STTR projects; minimizing technical risks associated with SBIR/STTR projects; and commercializing the SBIR/STTR product or process, including intellectual property protections. Proposing SBCs may request, in their Phase I Cost Volume (Volume 3) and Phase II Cost Volume, to contract these services themselves through one or more TABA providers in an amount not to exceed the values specified below. The Phase I TABA amount, if proposed, cannot include any profit/fee by the proposing SBC and must be inclusive of all applicable indirect costs. TABA cannot be used in the calculation of general and administrative expenses (G&A) for the SBIR proposing SBC. An SBC receiving TABA will be required to submit a report detailing the results and benefits of the service received. This TABA report will be due at the time of submission of the final report.

Request for TABA funding will be reviewed by the DON SBIR/STTR Program Management Office.

If the TABA request does not include the following items the TABA request will be denied.

- TABA provider(s) (firm name)
- TABA provider(s) point of contact, email address, and phone number
- An explanation of why the TABA provider(s) is uniquely qualified to provide the service
- Tasks the TABA provider(s) will perform (to include the purpose and objective of the assistance)
- Total TABA provider(s) cost, number of hours, and labor rates (average/blended rate is acceptable)

TABA must <u>NOT</u>:

- be subject to any indirect costs, profit, or fee by the SBIR proposing SBC
- propose a TABA provider that is the SBIR proposing SBC
- propose a TABA provider that is an affiliate of the SBIR proposing SBC
- propose a TABA provider that is an investor of the SBIR proposing SBC
- propose a TABA provider that is a subcontractor or consultant of the requesting SBC otherwise required as part of the paid portion of the research effort (e.g., research partner, consultant, tester, or administrative service provider)

TABA requests must be included in the proposal as follows:

- Phase I:
  - Online DoW Cost Volume (Volume 3) – the value of the TABA request.
  - Supporting Documents (Volume 5) – a detailed request for TABA (as specified above) specifically identified as "TABA" in the section titled Additional Cost Information when using the DON Supporting Documents template.
- Phase II:
  - DON Phase II Cost Volume (provided by the DON SYSCOM) - the value of the TABA request.
  - Supporting Documents (Volume 5) – a detailed request for TABA (as specified above) specifically identified as "TABA" in the section titled Additional Cost Information when using the DON Supporting Documents template.

Proposed values for TABA must <u>NOT</u> exceed:

- Phase I: A total of $6,500, in addition to the Phase I award amount.

- Phase II: A total of $25,000 per award, not to exceed $50,000 per Phase II project, included in the Phase II award amount.

Disclosure of Information (DFARS 252.204-7000). In order to eliminate the requirements for prior approval of public disclosure of information (in accordance with DFARS 252.204-7000) under this award, the proposing SBC shall identify and describe all fundamental research to be performed under its proposal, including subcontracted work, with sufficient specificity to demonstrate that the work qualifies as fundamental research. Fundamental research means basic and applied research in science and engineering, the results of which ordinarily are published and shared broadly within the scientific community, as distinguished from proprietary research and from industrial development, design, production, and product utilization, the results of which ordinarily are restricted for proprietary or national security reasons (defined by National Security Decision Directive 189). An SBC whose proposed work will include fundamental research and requests to eliminate the requirement for prior approval of public disclosure of information must complete the DON Fundamental Research Disclosure and upload as a separate PDF file to the Supporting Documents (Volume 5) in DSIP as part of their proposal submission. The DON Fundamental Research Disclosure is available on https://navysbir.com/links_forms.htm and includes instructions on how to complete and upload the completed Disclosure. Simply identifying fundamental research in the Disclosure does **NOT** constitute acceptance of the exclusion. All exclusions will be reviewed and, if approved by the Government Contracting Officer, noted in the contract.

Majority Ownership in Part. Proposing SBCs that are more than 50% owned by multiple venture capital operating companies (VCOC), hedge funds (HF), private equity firms (PEF), or any combination of these as set forth in 13 C.F.R. § 121.702, **are eligible** to submit proposals in response to DON topics advertised within this CSO.

For proposing SBCs that are a member of this ownership class the following must be satisfied for proposals to be accepted and evaluated:

a. Prior to submitting a proposal, SBCs must register with the SBA Company Registry Database.
b. The proposing SBC within its submission must submit the Majority-Owned VCOC, HF, and PEF Certification. A copy of the SBIR VC Certification can be found on https://navysbir.com/links_forms.htm. Include the SBIR VC Certification in the Supporting Documents (Volume 5).
c. Should a proposing SBC become a member of this ownership class after submitting its proposal and prior to any receipt of a funding agreement, the proposing SBC must immediately notify the Contracting Officer, register in the appropriate SBA database, and submit the required certification, which can be found on https://navysbir.com/links_forms.htm.

System for Award Management (SAM). It is strongly encouraged that proposing SBCs register in SAM, https://sam.gov, by the Close date of this CSO, or verify their registrations are still active and will not expire within 60 days of CSO Close. Additionally, proposing SBCs should confirm that they are registered to receive contracts (not just grants) and the address in SAM matches the address on the proposal. An SBC selected for an award MUST have an active SAM registration at the time of award or they will be considered ineligible.

Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) Program. DoW has established the CMMC Program to verify that awardees have implemented required security measures necessary to safeguard Federal Contract Information (FCI) and Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI). CMMC Level requirements are identified within each topic. Proposing SBCs should anticipate that a Projected CMMC Level for Phase II award may be higher than the Projected CMMC Level advertised in the Phase I topic. Proposing SBCs should carefully review and consider the CMMC requirements as compliance may

impact proposed costs and technical approach. Please review the DoW SBIR/STTR Program BAA for additional information on the CMMC Program.

Notice of NIST SP 800-171 Assessment Database Requirement. The purpose of the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Special Publication (SP) 800-171 is to protect Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) in Nonfederal Systems and Organizations. As prescribed by DFARS 252.240-7997, in order to be considered for award, an SBC is required to implement NIST SP 800-171 and shall have a current assessment uploaded to the Supplier Performance Risk System (SPRS) which provides storage and retrieval capabilities for this assessment. The platform Procurement Integrated Enterprise Environment (PIEE) will be used for secure login and verification to access SPRS. For brief instructions on NIST SP 800-171 assessment, SPRS, and PIEE, please visit https://www.sprs.csd.disa.mil/nistsp.htm. For in-depth tutorials on these items, please visit https://www.sprs.csd.disa.mil/webtrain.htm.

Human Subjects, Animal Testing, and Recombinant DNA. Due to the short timeframe associated with Phase I of the SBIR/STTR process, the DON does **not** recommend the submission of Phase I proposals that require the use of Human Subjects, Animal Testing, or Recombinant DNA. The ability to obtain Institutional Review Board (IRB) approval for proposals that involve human subjects can take 6-12 months, and that lengthy process can be at odds with the Phase I goal for time-to-award. Before the DON makes any award that involves an IRB or similar approval requirement, the proposing SBC must demonstrate compliance with relevant regulatory approval requirements that pertain to proposals involving human, animal, or recombinant DNA protocols. It will not impact the DON's evaluation, but requiring IRB approval may delay the start time of the Phase I award and if approvals are not obtained within two months of notification of selection, the decision to award may be terminated. If the use of human, animal, and recombinant DNA is included under a Phase I or Phase II proposal, please carefully review the requirements at: https://www.nre.navy.mil/work-with-us/how-to-apply/compliance-and-protections/research-protections. This webpage provides guidance and lists approvals that may be required before contract/work can begin.

Government Furnished Equipment (GFE). Due to the typical lengthy time for approval to obtain GFE, it is recommended that GFE is not proposed as part of the Phase I proposal. If GFE is proposed, and it is determined during the proposal evaluation process to be unavailable, proposed GFE may be considered a weakness in the technical merit of the proposal.

International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR). For topics indicating ITAR restrictions or the potential for classified work, limitations are generally placed on disclosure of information involving topics of a classified nature or those involving export control restrictions, which may curtail or preclude the involvement of universities and certain non-profit institutions beyond the basic research level. SBCs must structure their proposals to clearly identify the work that will be performed that is of a basic research nature and how it can be segregated from work that falls under the classification and export control restrictions. As a result, information must also be provided on how efforts can be performed in later phases if the university/research institution is the source of critical knowledge, effort, or infrastructure (facilities and equipment).

SELECTION, AWARD, AND POST-AWARD INFORMATION

Notifications. Email notifications for proposal receipt (approximately one week after the Phase I CSO Close) and selection are sent based on the information received on the proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1). Consequently, the e-mail address on the proposal Cover Sheet must be correct.

Proposal feedback. DON anticipates fulfilling proposal feedback requests using automated standardized language associated with the technical evaluation. Proposal feedback is not the same as a FAR Part 15 debriefing.

Protests. Interested parties have the right to protest in accordance with the procedures in FAR Subpart 33.1.

Protests related to the terms of the CSO must be served to: osd.ncr.ousd-r-e.mbx.SBIR-STTR-Protest@mail.mil. A copy of a pre-award Government Accountability Office (GAO) protest must also be filed with the aforementioned email address within one day of filing with the GAO.

Protests related to a selection or award decision should be filed with the appropriate Contracting Officer for an Agency Level Protest or with the GAO. Contracting Officer contact information for specific DON Topics may be obtained from the DON SYSCOM Program Managers listed in Table 2 above. For protests filed with the GAO, a copy of the protest must be submitted to the appropriate DON SYSCOM Program Manager and the appropriate Contracting Officer within one day of filing with the GAO.

Awards. Due to limited funding, the DON reserves the right to limit the number of awards under any topic. Any notification received from the DON that indicates the proposal has been selected does not ultimately guarantee an award will be made. This notification indicates that the proposal has been selected in accordance with the evaluation criteria and has been sent to the Contracting Officer to conduct compliance review to confirm eligibility of the proposing SBC, and to take other relevant steps necessary prior to making an award.

Award Type. Phase I awards to this CSO will be executed as Prototype Other Transaction (OT) under 10 U.S.C. 4021/10 U.S.C. 4022.

Funding Limitations. The maximum Phase I proposal/award amount including all options is $175,000. The Phase I Base amount must not exceed $75,000 and the Phase I Option amount must not exceed $100,000.

Deliverables. Deliverables for Phase I are typically a kick-off brief, progress reports, and a final report. Required contract deliverables (as stated in the contract) must be uploaded to https://www.navysbirprogram.com/navydeliverables/.

Payments. The DON will make two payments from the start of the Open Topic Phase I Base period, and three payments from the start of the Open Topic Phase I Option period, if exercised. Payment amounts represent a set percentage of the Base or Option value as follows:

Days From Start of Base	Payment Amount
15 Days	50% of Total Base
120 Days	50% of Total Base

Days From Start of Option	Payment Amount
15 Days	50% of Total Option
90 Days	35% of Total Option
180 Days	15% of Total Option

PHASE II GUIDELINES

Evaluation and Selection. All Phase I awardees may submit an **Initial** Phase II proposal for evaluation and selection. The evaluation criteria for Phase II is the same as Phase I (as stated in this CSO). The Phase I Final Report and Initial Phase II Proposal will be used to evaluate the SBC's potential to progress to a workable prototype in Phase II and transition the technology to Phase III. Details on the due date, content, and submission requirements of the Initial Phase II Proposal will be provided by the awarding SYSCOM either in the Phase I contract or by subsequent notification.

Awards. Awards to this CSO will be executed as Prototype Other Transaction (OT) under 10 U.S.C. 4021/10 U.S.C. 4022. Phase II awards can be structured in a way that allows for increased funding levels based on the project's transition potential.

Navy SBIR Transition Program (STP). All Phase II awardees have the opportunity to participate in the virtual Navy STP Kickoff during the first or second year of the Phase II contract. While there are no travel costs associated with this virtual event, Phase II awardees should budget time of up to a full day to participate. STP information can be obtained at: https://navystp.com. Phase II awardees will be contacted separately regarding this program.

Funding Limitations. The maximum Phase II proposal/award amount including all options (including TABA) is $2,000,000 (unless non-SBIR/STTR funding is being added). Individual SYSCOMs may award amounts, including Base and all Options, of less than $2,000,000 based on available funding. The structure of the Phase II proposal/award will be provided to all Phase I awardees. In accordance with the SBIR and STTR Policy Directive section 4(b)(5), there is a limit of one sequential Phase II award per SBC per topic.

PHASE III GUIDELINES

A Phase III SBIR/STTR award is any work that derives from, extends, or completes effort(s) performed under prior SBIR/STTR funding agreements, but is funded by sources other than the SBIR/STTR programs. This covers any contract, grant, or agreement issued as a follow-on Phase III award or any contract, grant, or agreement award issued as a result of a competitive process where the awardee was an SBIR/STTR firm that developed the technology as a result of a Phase I or Phase II award. The DON will give Phase III status to any award that falls within the above-mentioned description. Consequently, DON will assign SBIR/STTR Data Rights to any noncommercial technical data and noncommercial computer software delivered in Phase III that were developed under SBIR/STTR Phase I/II effort(s). Government prime contractors and their subcontractors must follow the same guidelines as above and ensure that companies operating on behalf of the DON protect the rights of the SBIR/STTR firm.

Navy SBIR DoW 2026 CSO
Topic Index
Release 1

DON26BX01-NP001 TITLE: NAVWAR Open Topic for Resilient Wideband RF Photonic Architectures for Assured Communications and PNT in Contested Electromagnetic Environments

DON26BX01-NP001 TITLE: NAVWAR Open Topic for Resilient Wideband RF Photonic Architectures for Assured Communications and PNT in Contested Electromagnetic Environments

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Advanced Materials;Integrated Sensing and Cyber

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

The technology within this topic is restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: Develop, prototype, and demonstrate next-generation radio frequency (RF) photonic front-end technologies that improve the reliability, clarity, and resilience of wireless communications and navigation in high-interference environments. These solutions will leverage advances similar to those used in commercial fiber-optic telecommunications, satellite broadband (e.g., Starlink-class systems), 5G wireless infrastructure, and autonomous vehicle sensor systems to ensure the U.S. Navy maintains assured communications and assured position, navigation, and timing (APNT) during contested maritime operations.

DESCRIPTION: The United States Navy must maintain reliable communications and accurate navigation to operate effectively at sea, coordinate with allies, and ensure freedom of navigation in increasingly complex and contested environments. Modern naval operations depend on uninterrupted wireless communications and precise timing and positioning, much like commercial aviation, autonomous shipping, satellite internet providers, and global logistics companies.

The Navy's Communications and GPS Navigation Program Office (PMW/A 170) is responsible for delivering resilient and adaptive communications and APNT capabilities to Fleet forces and coalition partners. As commercial technology rapidly advances in areas such as fiber-optic networking, 5G/6G wireless systems, high-speed satellite communications, and advanced sensing platforms, the Navy seeks to harness and adapt these innovations to strengthen maritime mission performance.
The Golden Fleet initiative emphasizes modernizing not only ships, but also the systems that enable command, control, communications, navigation, and situational awareness. Modern Naval operations depend heavily on reliable communications and precise navigation, much like commercial aviation, satellite broadband networks, autonomous systems, and global logistics enterprises. As commercial industries continue to advance technologies that maintain reliable performance in crowded and interference-heavy environments, the Navy seeks to adapt and transition these innovations to strengthen maritime mission resilience.

Naval communications and navigation systems must operate reliably not only in routine conditions, but also in environments where adversaries attempt to disrupt signals or where the radio spectrum is heavily congested. Traditional RF front-end electronics can experience degraded performance or signal loss when exposed to jamming, electromagnetic interference, or strong competing signals. These vulnerabilities can create operational risk and threaten mission continuity in contested electromagnetic environments.

To address these challenges, this Open Topic invites system-level innovations in wideband RF photonic front-end architectures. RF photonics combines radio and optical technologies by using light and fiber-based components to carry, preserve, and condition radio signals with high fidelity. Similar approaches are widely used in commercial fiber-optic communications, high-capacity wireless infrastructure, and precision timing networks to improve signal quality, expand bandwidth, and reduce distortion over long distances. When adapted to Naval RF systems, these technologies offer a promising path to lower noise, improved resistance to interference, wider signal capture, and more reliable signal recovery than conventional electronic front ends.

Proposed solutions may incorporate commercially inspired technologies such as:

- Coherent optical signal processing used in high-speed telecom networks
- Advanced phase-tracking techniques similar to those used in precision satellite navigation and autonomous vehicle localization
- Interference suppression approaches used in dense commercial wireless environments (e.g., stadiums, smart cities, and industrial IoT networks)
- Compact photonic integrated circuits (PICs), similar to those being developed for next-generation data centers and lidar systems

Desired capabilities include systems that:

- Reduce receiver noise without relying on traditional RF amplifiers
- Maintain signal integrity under heavy interference and jamming
- Capture and reconstruct wideband signals with high accuracy
- Automatically detect and remove unknown interference sources
- Support scalable, ruggedized deployment on ships, aircraft, and distributed maritime platforms
- Reduce size, weight, power, and cost while improving survivability

Of particular interest are integrated, fiber-remoted, and packaged front-end modules that can operate reliably in harsh maritime environments, similar to ruggedized telecom and offshore energy communications equipment. Solutions that enable real-time interference excision without prior knowledge of the signal or threat are strongly encouraged.

Work produced in Phase II may become classified. Note: The prospective contractor(s) must be U.S. owned and operated with no foreign influence as defined by 32 U.S.C. § 2004.20 et seq., National Industrial Security Program Executive Agent and Operating Manual, unless acceptable mitigating procedures can and have been implemented and approved by the Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA) formerly Defense Security Service (DSS). The selected contractor must be able to acquire and maintain a secret level facility and Personnel Security Clearances. This will allow contractor personnel to perform on advanced phases of this project as set forth by DCSA and NAVWAR in order to gain access to classified information pertaining to the national defense of the United States and its allies; this will be an inherent requirement. The selected company will be required to safeguard classified material during the advanced phases of this contract IAW the National Industrial Security Program Operating Manual (NISPOM), which can be found at Title 32, Part 2004.20 of the Code of Federal Regulations.

PHASE I: Phase I will explore technical feasibility and different approaches and identify a solution based on the investigation and technical tradeoffs. During Phase I, develop a coherent link architecture addressing the specifications detailed in the Description. Develop a design, chip level layout, and packaging concept for an integrated front end transceiver module. The transceiver should contain at minimum a sub 1V Vp coherent modulator deriving a signal and local oscillator from a remote optical source and a nominal 50 ohm antenna input. The transceiver package should incorporate necessary optical

I/O to deliver I and Q signals to the backend. The link architecture should contain polarization management to eliminate the need for polarization maintaining fiber. The expected analog performance of the proposed transceiver should be determined and incorporated in an end-to-end link model to determine the expected performance (e.g. minimum detectable signal, input voltage range, digital sampling rate, operating bandwidth and SFDR) of the digital back end. Analysis of the effects of specific hardware and software innovations to reduce digitization and processing requirements is encouraged.

PHASE II: Phase II should optimize the Phase I design. Create, and test a functioning transceiver front end. Demonstrate a packaged, fiberized transceiver front end suitable for interface to a broadband antenna in a realistic environment. Update the end-to-end link model with the measured performance of the front-end transceiver and optimize the link architecture. Perform a feasibility demonstration of back-end signal recovery. The demonstration does not need to implement the entire planned functionality but should produce quantitative results that can be used to extrapolate the expected link performance with reasonable fidelity. Phase II should include a set of performance specifications for the identified solution and prototype(s). Proposals should also include the use of Systems Engineering Technical Review (SETR) events, plans for testing, demonstration, and validation of the solution within the target Program of Record (PoR) or an equivalent and Government approved development environment. Proposals should also include the development of a strategy or plan for post-Phase II activities to include the development of production representative articles, Formal Qualification Tests (FQT) plans, life-cycle support strategies and concepts, commercialization opportunities, etc.

It is highly likely that the work, prototyping, test, simulation, and validation may become classified in Phase II (see Description for details). However, the proposal for Phase II will be UNCLASSIFIED.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: Support the transition of developed technology to the Fleet. Investigate the dual use of the developed solution(s) for commercial applications. Commercial technology is rapidly advancing in areas such as fiber-optic networking, 5G/6G wireless systems, high-speed satellite communications, and advanced sensing platforms. Commercial aviation, shipping, satellite broadband networks, autonomous systems, and global logistics enterprises depend heavily on reliable communications and precise navigation. There will be many dual uses in the commercial sector for capabilities developed under this topic that maintain reliable performance in crowded and interference-heavy environments for command, control, communications, navigation, and situational awareness.

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KEYWORDS: EMI; jamming; RF photonics; interference; HF; co-channel interference

Appendix A
TECHNICAL PROPOSAL TEMPLATE (VOLUME 2)

INSTRUCTIONS

These instructions and template apply to DoW SBIR/STTR Phase I topics and provide general guidelines for completing the Phase I Technical Volume. Information provided in the Service/Component-specific instructions for the topic of interest take precedence over any instructions listed below.

The template (beginning on the following page) is the format model that may be used to prepare the Phase I Technical Volume. Do not include the instructions provided on this page or any bracketed [ ] guidance in the template.

Disclosure

Offerors that include in their proposals data which they do not want disclosed to the public for any purpose, or used by the U.S. Government except for evaluation purposes, must:

(1) Mark the first page of each Volume of the Submission with the following legend:
"This proposal includes data that must not be disclosed outside the Government and must not be duplicated, used, or disclosed-in whole or in part-for any purpose other than to evaluate this proposal. If, however, a contract is awarded to this offeror as a result of-or in connection with-the submission of this data, the Government has the right to duplicate, use, or disclose the data to the extent provided in the resulting contract. This restriction does not limit the Government's right to use information contained in this data if it is obtained from another source without restriction. The data subject to this restriction are contained in pages [insert numbers or other identification of sheets]";

(2) Mark each sheet of data it wishes to restrict with the following legend:
"Use or disclosure of data contained on this page is subject to the restriction on the first page of this volume."

Format

The Technical Volume shall meet the following requirements:

- Please refer to Service/Component-specific topic instructions for the page limit and how a technical volume is handled if the stated page count is exceeded. It is the proposing firm's responsibility to verify that the Technical Volume does not exceed the page limit after upload to DSIP. Unless otherwise noted, all content in the Technical Volume will count toward the limit.
- Single column format single-spaced typed lines.
- Standard 8 ½" x 11" paper format.
- Page margins one inch on all sides. A header and footer may be included in the one-inch margin.
- **The header on each page of the Technical Volume should contain your company name, topic number, and DSIP-assigned proposal number.**
- No font smaller than 10-point. For headers, footers, imbedded tables, figures, images, or graphics that include text, a font size of smaller than 10-point is allowable, though proposers are cautioned that the text may be unreadable by evaluators.

Do not lock or encrypt the uploaded file. Do not include or embed active graphics such as videos, moving pictures, or other similar media in the document.

Delete this instruction page and begin the Technical Volume starting with the following page.

[Title]

Volume 2: Technical Volume

[Note: Remove the disclosure statement below if not applicable to your proposal. Refer to Instructions.]

This proposal includes data that must not be disclosed outside the Government and must not be duplicated, used, or disclosed – in whole or in part – for any purpose other than to evaluate this proposal. If, however, a contract is awarded to this offeror as a result of – or in connection with – the submission of this data, the Government has the right to duplicate, use, or disclose the data to the extent provided in the resulting contract. This restriction does not limit the Government's right to use information contained in this data if it is obtained from another source without restriction. The data subject to this restriction are contained in pages <insert numbers or other identification of sheets>.

1. Identification and Significance of the Problem or Opportunity.

[Define the specific technical problem or opportunity addressed and its importance.]

2. Phase I Technical Objectives.

[Enumerate the specific objectives of the Phase I work, including the questions the research and development effort will try to answer to determine the feasibility of the proposed approach.]

3. Phase I Statement of Work (include Subcontractors and/or Research Institutions).

(a) [Provide an explicit, detailed description of the Phase I approach. If a Phase I option is required or allowed by the Component (refer to Component-specific instructions for topic of interest), describe appropriate research activities which would commence at the end of Phase I base period should the Component elect to exercise the option. The Statement of Work should indicate what tasks are planned, how and where the work will be conducted, a schedule of major events, and the final product(s) to be delivered. The Phase I effort should attempt to determine the technical feasibility of the proposed concept. The methods planned to achieve each objective or task should be discussed explicitly and in detail. This section should be a substantial portion of the Technical Volume.

(b) The solicitation may contain topics that have been identified by the Program Manager as research or activities involving Human/Animal Subjects and/or Recombinant DNA. If Phase I performance includes performance of these kinds of research or activities, please identify the applicable protocols and how those protocols will be followed during Phase I. Please note that funds cannot be released or used on any portion of the project involving human/animal subjects or recombinant DNA research or activities until all of the proper approvals have been obtained. **SBCs proposing research involving human and/or animal use are encouraged to separate these tasks in the technical proposal and cost proposal in order to avoid potential delay of contract award.**]

4. Related Work.

[Describe significant activities directly related to the proposed effort, including any conducted by the principal investigator, the proposing firm, consultants, or others. Describe how these activities interface with the proposed project and discuss any planned coordination with outside sources. The Technical Volume must persuade evaluators of the proposer's awareness of the state of the art in the topic. Describe any previous work not directly related but similar to the proposed effort. Provide the following: (1) a short description, (2) the client for which work was performed (including the Government Point of Contact to be contacted including e-mail address and phone number), and (3) date of performance including project completion.]

5. <u>Relationship with Future Research or Research and Development</u>.

(a) [State the anticipated results of the proposed approach if the project is successful.

(b) Discuss the significance of the Phase I effort in providing a foundation for a Phase II research or research and development effort.

(c) Identify the applicable clearances, certifications and approvals required to conduct Phase II testing. Outline the plan for ensuring timely completion of stated authorizations in support of a Phase II research or research and development effort.]

6. <u>Commercialization Strategy.</u>

[Describe in approximately one page the SBC's strategy for commercializing this technology in DoW, other Federal Agencies, and/or private sector markets. Provide specific information on the market need the technology will address and the size of the market. Also include a schedule showing the quantitative commercialization results from the project that your company expects to achieve.]

7. <u>Key Personnel</u>.

[Identify key personnel who will be involved in the Phase I effort including information on directly related education and experience. A concise technical resume of the principal investigator, including a list of relevant publications (if any), must be included (Please do not include Privacy Act Information). All resumes will count toward the page limit for Volume 2, as specified in the Component-specific instructions.]

[Principal Investigator Name]
[School, Degree, Year]

Relevant Experience
[A concise description of the principal investigator's relevant technical experience and its application to this topic.]

Relevant Awards or Patents
[List any awards received or patents granted or applications submitted for work related to this topic.]

Relevant Publications
[List any publications relevant to this topic.]

[Repeat this format as necessary to address the qualifications of all key personnel.]

8. <u>Foreign Citizens</u>.

[Identify any foreign citizens or individuals holding dual citizenship expected to be involved on this project as a direct employee, subcontractor, or consultant. For these individuals, please specify their country of origin, the type of visa or work permit under which they are performing and an explanation of their anticipated level of involvement on this project. The proposal may be deemed nonresponsive if the requested information is not provided. You may be asked to provide additional information during negotiations in order to verify the foreign citizen's eligibility to participate on a SBIR/STTR contract. Supplemental information provided in response to this paragraph will be protected in accordance with the Privacy Act (5 U.S.C. 552a), if applicable, and the Freedom of Information Act (5 U.S.C. 552(b)(6)). Note: If no foreign nationals will be involved in proposed work, the word "None" can be substituted for the table.]

Name [include direct employees, subcontractors, and consultants]	Foreign National (Yes/No)	Country of Origin	Type of Visa or Work Permit	Level of Involvement (Role)

9. Facilities/Equipment.

[Describe available instrumentation and physical facilities necessary to carry out the Phase I effort. Justify equipment purchases in this section and include detailed pricing information in the Cost Volume. State whether or not the facilities where the proposed work will be performed meet environmental laws and regulations of federal, state (name), and local Governments for, but not limited to, the following groupings: airborne emissions, waterborne effluents, external radiation levels, outdoor noise, solid and bulk waste disposal practices, and handling and storage of toxic and hazardous materials.]

10. Subcontractors/Consultants.

[Propose efforts as applicable to either SBIR or STTR as follows:

SBIR. Involvement of a university or other subcontractors or consultants in the project may be appropriate. A minimum of two-thirds of the research and/or analytical work in Phase I, as measured by direct and indirect costs, must be carried out by the proposing small business firm, unless otherwise approved in writing by the Contracting Officer. SBIR efforts may include subcontracts with Federal Laboratories and Federally Funded Research and Development Centers (FFRDCs). A waiver is not required for the use of Federal Laboratories and FFRDCs; however, proposers must certify their use of such facilities on the proposal cover sheet. Subcontracts with other Federal organizations are not permitted. Note that universities cannot publicly release information related to Export Controlled/ITAR restricted topics. (Refer to the DoW SBIR/STTR solicitation for detailed eligibility requirements as it pertains to the use of subcontractors/consultants.)

STTR. Involvement of a Research Institution in the project is required. A minimum of 40 percent of the research and/or analytical work in Phase I, as measured by direct and indirect costs, must be conducted by the proposing small business firm, and a minimum of 30 percent of the research and/or tasks in Phase I, as measured by direct and indirect costs, must be conducted by a single Research Institution. STTR efforts may include subcontracts with Federally Funded Research and Development Centers (FFRDCs). A waiver is not required for the use of Federal Laboratories, but they do not qualify as a Research Partner; proposers may only subcontract to Federal Laboratories within the remaining 30 percent and must certify their use of such facilities on the proposal cover sheet. Subcontracts with other Federal organizations are not permitted. Note that universities cannot publicly release information related to Export Controlled/ITAR restricted topics. (Refer to the DoW SBIR/STTR solicitation for detailed eligibility requirements as it pertains to the use of subcontractors/consultants.]

11. Prior, Current or Pending Support of Similar Proposals or Awards.

[If a proposal submitted in response to this solicitation is substantially the same as another proposal that was funded, is now being funded, or is pending with another Federal Agency, another or the same DoW Service/Component, you must disclose this on the proposal cover sheet and provide the following information:

a) Name and address of the Federal Agency(s) or DoW Component to which a proposal was submitted, will be submitted, or from which an award is expected or has been received.

b) Date of proposal submission or date of award.

c) Title of proposal.

d) Name and title of principal investigator for each proposal submitted or award received.

e) Title, number, and date of solicitation(s) under which the proposal was submitted, will be submitted, or under which award is expected or has been received.

f) If award was received, provide contract number.

g) Specify the applicable topics for each proposal submitted or award received.

Note: If this does not apply, state in the proposal "No prior, current, or pending support has been provided for proposed work."]

12. <u>Identification and Assertion of Restrictions on the Government's Use, Release, or Disclosure of Technical Data or Computer Software.</u>

The Offeror asserts for itself, or the persons identified below, that the Government's rights to use, release, or disclose the following technical data or computer software should be restricted:

Technical Data or Computer Software to be Furnished with Restrictions	Basis for Assertion	Asserted Rights Category	Name of Person or Organization Asserting Restrictions
[(LIST)]	[(LIST)]	[(LIST)]	[(LIST)]

[Completion of this table and submission of the proposal constitutes signature for the information listed in the table above.]

[**ADDITIONAL INFORMATION/INSTRUCTION:** Rights in technical data, including software, developed under the terms of any contract resulting from proposals submitted in response to this solicitation generally remain with the contractor, except that the Government obtains a royalty-free license to use such technical data only for Government purposes during the period commencing with contract award and ending twenty years after completion of the project under which the data were generated. This data <u>must</u> be marked with the restrictive legend specified in DFARS 252.227-7018 (JAN 2025). Upon expiration of the twenty-year restrictive license, the Government has unlimited rights in the SBIR data. During the license period, the Government may not release or disclose SBIR data to any person other than its support services contractors except: (1) For evaluation purposes; (2) As expressly permitted by the contractor; or (3) A use, release, or disclosure that is necessary for emergency repair or overhaul of items operated by the Government. See DFARS clause 252.227-7018 (JAN 2025).

If a proposer plans to submit assertions in accordance with DFARS 252.227-7017 (JAN 2025), those assertions must be identified and assertion of use, release, or disclosure restriction MUST be included with your proposal submission. The contract cannot be awarded until assertions have been approved. Please note that only the table is included in the page limitation; any supporting data concerning the contract/grant number and awarding agency, as well as planned use or need of the data asserted, can be provided in Volume 5, Supporting Documents.

The following instructions apply to the fields in the table above (Identification and Assertion of Restrictions on the Government's Use, Release, or Disclosure of Technical Data or Computer Software).

1) For technical data (other than computer software documentation) pertaining to items, components, or processes developed at private expense, identify both the deliverable technical data and each such item, component, or process. For computer software or computer software documentation identify the software or documentation.

2) Generally, development at private expense, either exclusively or partially, is the only basis for asserting restrictions. For technical data, other than computer software documentation, development refers to development of the item, component, or process to which the data pertain. The Government's rights in computer software documentation generally may not be restricted. For computer software, development refers to the software. Indicate whether development was accomplished exclusively or partially at private expense. If development was not accomplished at private expense, or for computer software documentation, enter the specific basis for asserting restrictions.

3) Enter asserted rights category (e.g., Government purpose license rights from a prior contract, rights in SBIR/STTR data generated under another contract, limited, restricted, or government purpose rights under this or a prior contract, or specially negotiated licenses).

4) Corporation, individual, or other person, as appropriate.

Enter “none” when all data or software will be submitted without restrictions.]

Appendix B
DEFINITIONS

The following definitions from the SBA SBIR/STTR Policy Directive, the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) and other cited regulations apply to this solicitation.

Commercialization

The process of developing products, processes, technologies, or services, and the production and delivery (whether by the originating party or others) of the products, processes, technologies, or services for Federal Government or commercial markets purchase or use.

Cooperative Research and Development

An SBC and a research institution jointly conduct R&D. For purposes of the STTR Program, the SBC performs 40 percent of the work, and the single research institution performs not less than 30 percent of the work. For purposes of the SBIR Program, this refers to work a research institution conducts as the SBC's subcontractor. The proposing SBC must conduct at least two-thirds of the research and/or analytical work in Phase I.

Covered Individual

An individual who contributes in a substantive, meaningful way to the scientific development or execution of a R&D project proposed to be carried out with a DoW-funded award. DoW has further designated covered individuals as including all proposed key personnel.

Essentially Equivalent Work

Work that is substantially the same research, which is proposed for funding in more than one contract proposal or grant application submitted to the same federal agency or submitted to two or more different federal agencies for review and funding consideration; or work where a specific research objective and the research design for accomplishing the objective are the same or closely related to another proposal or award, regardless of the funding source.

Export Control

The International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120 through 130, and the Export Administration Regulations (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730 through 799, apply to all projects with military or dual-use applications that develop beyond fundamental research, which is basic and applied research ordinarily published and shared broadly within the scientific community. Details are available here.

NOTE: Export control compliance statements found in the individual Service/Component-specific proposal instructions are not meant to be all inclusive. They do not remove any liability from the submitter to comply with applicable ITAR or EAR export control restrictions or from informing the U.S. Government of any potential export restriction as fundamental R&D efforts proceed.

Federal Laboratory

In 15 U.S.C. §3703, it means any laboratory, any federally funded R&D center (FFRDC), or any center established under 15 U.S.C. §§ 3705 & 3707 that a federal agency owns, leases, or otherwise uses and the Federal Government funds, whether the U.S. Government or the contractor operates.

Federally Funded Award

A Phase I, Phase II (including Direct to Phase II, sequential Phase II/subsequent Phase II and cross-agency Phase II), or Phase III SBIR or STTR award made using a funding agreement.

Foreign Affiliation

Under 15 U.S.C. § 638(e)(16), foreign affiliation means a funded or unfunded academic, professional, or institutional appointment or position with a foreign government or government-owned entity, whether full-time, part-time, or voluntary (including adjunct, visiting, or honorary). This includes appointments or positions deemed adjunct, visiting, or honorary with research institutions located in a foreign country of concern.

Foreign Country of Concern

In 15 U.S.C. § 638(e)(17), foreign country of concern means the People's Republic of China, the Democratic People's Republic of Korea, the Russian Federation, the Islamic Republic of Iran, or any other country the Secretary of State determines as a country of concern.

Foreign Entity

Foreign entity means any branch, partnership, group or sub-group, association, estate, trust, corporation or division of a corporation, non-profit, academic institution, research center, or organization that foreign owners, foreign investors, foreign management, or a foreign government establish, direct, or control.

Foreign Government

Foreign government means any government or governmental body, organization, or instrumentality, including government owned-corporations, other than the U.S. Government or U.S. state, territorial, tribal, or jurisdictional governments or governmental bodies. The term includes, but is not limited to, non-U.S. national and subnational governments, including their respective departments, agencies, and instrumentalities.

Foreign National

Foreign National (also known as Foreign Person) under 22 CFR 120.16 mean any natural person who is not a lawful permanent resident as defined by 8 U.S.C. § 1101(a)(20) or who is not a protected individual as defined by 8 U.S.C. § 1324b(a)(3). It also means any foreign corporation, business association, partnership, trust, society, or any other entity or group that is not incorporated or organized to do business in the United States, as well as international organizations, foreign governments and any agency or subdivision of foreign governments (e.g., diplomatic missions).

"Lawfully admitted for permanent residence" means the status of having been lawfully accorded the privilege of residing permanently in the United States as an immigrant in accordance with the immigration laws, such status not having changed.

"Protected individual'' means an individual who (A) is a citizen or national of the United States, or (B) is an alien who is lawfully admitted for permanent residence, is granted the status of an alien lawfully admitted for temporary residence under 8 U.S.C. § 1160(a) or 8 U.S.C. § 1255a(a)(1), is admitted as a refugee under 8 U.S.C. § 1157, or is granted asylum under Section 8 U.S.C. § 1158; but does not include

(i) an alien who fails to apply for naturalization within six months of the date the alien first becomes eligible (by virtue of period of lawful permanent residence) to apply for naturalization or, if later, within six months after November 6, 1986, and (ii) an alien who has applied on a timely basis, but has not been naturalized as a citizen within two years after the date of the application, unless the alien can establish that the alien is actively pursuing naturalization, except that time consumed in the Service's processing the application shall not be counted toward the two-year period.

Fraud, Waste and Abuse

a. Fraud includes any false
b. about a material fact or any intentional deception designed to deprive the United States unlawfully of something of value or to secure from the United States a benefit, privilege, allowance, or consideration to which an individual or business is not entitled.
c. Waste includes extravagant, careless or needless expenditure of government funds, or the consumption of government property, that results from deficient practices, systems, controls, or decisions.
d. Abuse includes any intentional or improper use of government resources, such as misuse of rank, position, or authority or resources.
e. The SBIR/STTR Program training related to Fraud, Waste and Abuse is available here. See Section 1.13 for reporting fraud, waste, and abuse.

Funding Agreement

Any contract, grant, or cooperative agreement entered between any Federal Agency and any SBC for the performance of experimental, developmental, or research work, including products or services, Federal Government-funded in whole or in part. DoW Services/Components will only use contracts and other transaction authority (OTA) agreements for all SBIR awards.

Historically Black Colleges and Universities, and Minority-Serving Institutions

Department of Education list for historically Black colleges and universities and minority-serving institutions.

HUBZone Certified Small Business Concern

An SBC with SBA certification under the Historically Underutilized Business Zones (HUBZone) Program (13 C.F.R. § 126) as a HUBZone firm listed in the dynamic small business search (DSBS).

Innovation

As defined and as used in SBA Policy Directive 3(t), the term innovation means-
Something new or improved, having marketable potential, that includes the development of new technology, the refinement of existing technology, or the development of new applications for existing technology.

Malign Foreign Talent Recruitment Program

As defined in 42 U.S.C § 19237, the term “malign foreign talent recruitment program” means-

(A) any program, position, or activity that includes compensation in the form of cash, in-kind compensation, including research funding, promised future compensation, complimentary foreign travel, things of non de minimis value, honorific titles, career advancement opportunities, or other

types of remuneration or consideration directly provided by a foreign country at any level (national, provincial, or local) or their designee, or an entity based in, funded by, or affiliated with a foreign country, whether or not directly sponsored by the foreign country, to the targeted individual, whether directly or indirectly stated in the arrangement, contract, or other documentation at issue, in exchange for the individual-

(i) engaging in the unauthorized transfer of intellectual property, materials, data products, or other nonpublic information owned by a United States entity or developed with a Federal R&D award to the government of a foreign country or an entity based in, funded by, or affiliated with a foreign country regardless of whether that government or entity provided support for the development of the IP, materials, or data products;

(ii) being required to recruit trainees or researchers to enroll in such program, position, or activity;

(iii) establishing a laboratory or company, accepting a faculty position, or undertaking any other employment or appointment in a foreign country or with an entity based in, funded by, or affiliated with a foreign country if such activities are in violation of the standard terms and conditions of a Federal R&D award;

(iv) being unable to terminate the foreign talent recruitment program contract or agreement except in extraordinary circumstances;

(v) through funding or effort related to the foreign talent recruitment program, being limited in the capacity to carry out a R&D award or required to engage in work that would result in substantial overlap or duplication with a Federal R&D award;

(vi) being required to apply for and successfully receive funding from the sponsoring foreign government's funding agencies with the sponsoring foreign organization as the recipient;

(vii) being required to omit acknowledgment of the recipient institution with which the individual is affiliated, or the Federal research agency sponsoring the R&D award, contrary to the institutional policies or standard terms and conditions of the Federal R&D award;

(viii) being required to not disclose to the Federal research agency or employing institution the participation of such individual in such program, position, or activity; or

(ix) having a conflict of interest or conflict of commitment contrary to the standard terms and conditions of the Federal R&D award; and

(B) a program that is sponsored by-

(i) a foreign country of concern or an entity based in a foreign country of concern, whether or not directly sponsored by the foreign country of concern;

(ii) an academic institution on the list developed under section 1286(c)(8) of the John S. McCain National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2019 (10 U.S.C. 2358 note; 1 Public Law 115–232) ; or

(iii) a foreign talent recruitment program on the list developed under section 1286(c)(9) of the John S. McCain National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2019 (10 U.S.C. 2358 note; 1 Public Law 115–232).

Performance Benchmark Requirements

SBCs with multiple SBIR/STTR awards must meet minimum performance requirements to be eligible to apply for a new Phase I or Direct-to-Phase II award. The purpose of these requirements is to ensure that Phase I SBCs with multiple prior SBIR/STTR awards are making progress towards commercializing the work done under those awards. The Phase I to Phase II transition rate addresses the extent to which an awardee progresses a project from Phase I to Phase II. The commercialization benchmark addresses the extent to which an awardee has moved past Phase II work towards commercialization.

The SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 (Pub. L. 117-183) amended the benchmarks' applications for more experienced firms. Detailed information on benchmark calculations and increased performance standards for more experienced firms can be found here.

Personal Conflict of Interest

A situation in which an individual has a financial interest, personal activity, or relationship that could impair the employee's ability to act impartially and in the best interest of the government when performing under the contract. (A de minimis interest that would not "impair the employee's ability to act impartially and in the best interest of the government" is not covered under this definition.)

Among the sources of personal conflicts of interest are:

a. The covered employee's, their close family members' or other members of their household's financial interests;
b. Other employment or financial relationships (including seeking or negotiating for prospective employment or business); and
c. Gifts, including travel.

Financial interests referred to in this definition's first paragraph may arise from:

a. Compensation, including wages, salaries, commissions, professional fees, or fees for business referrals;
b. Consulting relationships (including commercial and professional consulting and service arrangements, scientific and technical advisory board memberships, or serving as an expert witness in litigation);
c. Services provided in exchange for honorariums or travel expense reimbursements;
d. Research funding or other forms of research support;
e. Investment in the form of stock or bond ownership or partnership interest (excluding diversified mutual fund investments);
f. Real estate investments;
g. Patents, copyrights, and other IP interests; or
h. Business ownership and investment interests.

Principal Investigator/Program Manager

The principal investigator/project manager is the proposing SBC-designated individual who provides the scientific and technical direction to a funding agreement-supported project.

Proprietary Information

Proprietary information is any information that an SBC considers to be non-public information the SBC owns and is marked accordingly.

Research Institution

Any organization located in the United States that is:

a. A university.
b. A nonprofit institution as defined in Section 4(5) of the Stevenson-Wydler Technology Innovation Act of 1980.
c. A contractor-operated federally funded R&D center, as identified by the National Science Foundation in accordance with the government-wide FAR issued in accordance with the Office of Federal Procurement Policy Act Section 35(c)(1). A list of eligible FFRDCs is here.

Research or Research and Development

Any activity that is:

a. A systematic, intensive study directed toward greater knowledge or understanding of the subject studied.
b. A systematic study directed specifically toward applying new knowledge to meet a recognized need; or
c. A systematic knowledge application toward the production of useful materials, devices, systems, or methods, including design, development, and improvement of prototypes and new processes to meet specific requirements.

Research Involving Animal Subjects

All activities involving animal subjects shall be conducted in accordance with DoDI 3216.01 "Use of Animals in DoW Programs," 9 C.F.R. parts 1-4 "Animal Welfare Regulations," National Academy of Sciences Publication "Guide for the Care & Use of Laboratory Animals," as amended, and the Department of Agriculture rules implementing the Animal Welfare Act (7 U.S.C. §§ 2131-2159), as well as other applicable federal and state law and regulation and DoW instructions.

"Animal use" protocols apply to all activities that meet any of the following criteria:

a. Any research, development, test, evaluation or training, (including experimentation) involving an animal or animals.
b. An animal is defined as any living or dead, vertebrate organism (non-human) that is being used or is intended for use in research, development, test, evaluation or training.
c. A vertebrate is a member of the subphylum Vertebrata (within the phylum Chordata), including birds and cold-blooded animals.

See DoDI 3216.01 for definitions of these terms and more information about the applicability of DoDI 3216.01 to work involving animals.

Research Involving Human Subjects

All research involving human subjects shall be conducted in accordance with 32 C.F.R. § 219 "The Common Rule," 10 U.S.C. § 980 "Limitation on Use of Humans as Experimental Subjects," and DoDI 3216.02 "Protection of Human Subjects and Adherence to Ethical Standards in DoD-Supported Research," as well as other applicable federal and state law and regulations, and DoW Services/Component guidance. Proposing SBCs must be cognizant of and abide by the additional restrictions and limitations imposed on the DoW regarding research involving human subjects, specifically as they regard vulnerable populations (DoDI 3216.02), recruitment of military research subjects (DoDI 3216.02), and informed consent and surrogate consent (10 U.S.C. § 980) and chemical and biological agent research (DoDI 3216.02). Food and Drug Administration regulation and policies may also apply.

"Human use" protocols apply to all research that meets any of the following criteria:

a. Any research involving an intervention or an interaction with a living person that would not be occurring or would be occurring in some other fashion but for this research.
b. Any research involving identifiable private information. This may include data/information/specimens collected originally from living individuals (broadcast video, web-use logs, tissue, blood, medical or personnel records, health data repositories, etc.) in which the

identity of the subject is known, or the identity may be readily ascertained by the investigator or associated with the data/information/specimens.

See DoDI 3216.02 for definitions of these terms and more information about the applicability of DoDI 3216.02 to research involving human subjects.

Research Involving Recombinant DNA Molecules

Any recipient performing research involving recombinant DNA molecules and/or organisms and viruses containing recombinant DNA molecules shall comply with the National Institutes of Health Guidelines for Research Involving Recombinant DNA Molecules, dated January 2011, as amended. The guidelines can be found at: https://osp.od.nih.gov/wp-content/uploads/2016/05/NIH_Guidelines.pdf. Recombinant DNA is defined as (i) molecules that are constructed outside living cells by joining natural or synthetic DNA segments to DNA molecules that can replicate in living cells or (ii) molecules that result from the replication of those described in (i) above.

Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business (SDVOSB)

A service-disabled veteran or service-disabled veterans-owned and controlled SBC defined in Small Business Act 15 USC § 632(q)(2) and SBA's implementing SDVOSB regulations (13 CFR 125).

Small Business Concern (SBC)

A concern that meets the requirements set forth in 13 C.F.R. § 121.702 (available here).

An SBC must satisfy the following conditions on the date of award:

a. Is organized for profit, with a place of business located in the United States, which operates primarily within the United States, or which makes a significant contribution to the United States economy through payment of taxes or use of American products, materials or labor;
b. Is in the legal form of an individual proprietorship, partnership, limited liability company, corporation, joint venture, association, trust or cooperative, except that if the concern is a joint venture, each entity to the venture must meet the requirements set forth in paragraph (c) below;
c. Is more than 50 percent directly owned and controlled by one or more individuals (who are citizens or permanent resident aliens of the United States), other SBCs (each of which is more than 50 percent directly owned and controlled by individuals who are citizens or permanent resident aliens of the United States), or any combination of these; and
d. Has, including its affiliates, not more than 500 employees. (See here for definition of an affiliate.)

Subcontract

A subcontract is any agreement, other than one involving an employer-employee relationship, including consultants, the funding agreement awardee enters calling for supplies or services for the performance of the original funding agreement.

Subcontractor

Subcontractor means any supplier, distributor, vendor, firm, academic institution, research center, or other person or entity that furnishes supplies or services pursuant to a subcontract, at any tier.

United States

United States means the fifty states, the territories and possessions of the Federal Government, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, the Republic of the Marshall Islands, the Federated States of Micronesia, the Republic of Palau, and the District of Columbia.

Women-Owned Small Business Concern

An SBC where one or more women own at least 51 percent, or in the case of any publicly owned business, women own at least 51 percent of the stock, and women control the management and daily business operations.

Appendix C
POTENTIAL APPLICABLE FEDERAL ACQUISITION REGULATION, DEFENSE FEDERAL ACQUISITION REGULATION SUPPLEMENT CLAUSES

Note: An independent review and determination of required clauses should be complete for each award. Green cells are potential required Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) and Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) clauses. Blue cells are potential required FAR and DFARS clauses, when applicable.

Clause Number	Title	Date	When Applicable
52.203-17	Contractor Employee Whistleblower Rights	Nov-23	
52.203-19	Prohibition on Requiring Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements or Statements	Jan-17	
52.204-10	Reporting Executive Compensation and First-Tier Subcontract Awards	Jun-20	
52.204-13	System for Award Management Maintenance	Oct-18	
52.204-18	Commercial and Government Entity Code Maintenance	Aug-20	
52.204-19	Incorporation by Reference of Representations and Certifications	Dec-14	
52.204-21	Basic Safeguarding of Covered Contractor Information Systems	Nov-21	
52.204-23	Prohibition on Contracting for Hardware, Software, and Services Developed or Provided by Kaspersky Lab and Other Covered Entities	Dec-23	
52.204-25	Prohibition on Contracting for Certain Telecommunications and Video Surveillance Services or Equipment	Nov-21	
52.204-27	Prohibition on a ByteDance Covered Application	Jun-23	
52.204-30	Federal Acquisition Supply Chain Security Act Orders—Prohibition	Dec-23	
52.209-06	Protecting the Government's Interest When Subcontracting with Contractors Debarred, Suspended, or Proposed for Debarment	Jan-25	
52.209-10	Prohibition on Contracting with Inverted Domestic Corporations	Nov-15	
52.219-06	Notice of Total Small Business Set-Aside	Nov-20	
52.219-08	Utilization of Small Business Concerns	Jan-25	
52.219-28	Post-Award Small Business Program Representation	Jan-25	
52.222-03	Convict Labor	Jun-03	
52.222-19	Child Labor-Cooperation with Authorities and Remedies	Jan-25	
52.222-21	Prohibition of Segregated Facilities	Apr-15	
52.222-25	Affirmative Action Compliance	Apr-84	
52.222-26	Equal Opportunity	Sep-16	
52.222-36	Equal Opportunity for Workers with Disabilities	Jun-20	

Clause Number	Title	Date	When Applicable
52.222-50	Combating Trafficking in Persons	Nov-21	
52.225-01	Buy American-Supplies	Oct-22	
52.225-13	Restrictions on Certain Foreign Purchases	Feb-21	
52.226-07	Drug-Free Workplace	May-24	
52.226-08	Encouraging Contractor Policies to Ban Text Messaging While Driving	May-24	
52.227-01 Alt I	Authorization and Consent - Alternate I (Apr-84)	Jun-20	
52.227-02	Notice and Assistance Regarding Patent and Copyright Infringement	Jun-20	
52.227-11	Patent Rights-Ownership by the Contractor	May-14	
52.227-20	Rights in Data-SBIR Program	May-14	
52.232-01	Payments	Apr-84	
52.232-11	Extras	Apr-84	
52.232-23	Assignment of Claims	May-14	
52.232-25	Prompt Payment	Jan-17	
52.232-33	Payment by Electronic Funds Transfer - System for Award Management	Oct-18	
52.232-39	Unenforceability of Unauthorized Obligations	Jun-13	
52.232-40	Providing Accelerated Payments to Small Business Subcontractors	Mar-23	
52.233-01	Disputes	May-14	
52.233-04	Applicable Law for Breach of Contract Claim	Oct-04	
52.242-15	Stop-Work Order	Aug-89	
52.243-01 Alt V	Changes-Fixed-Price Alternate V (Apr-84)	Aug-87	
52.244-06	Subcontracts for Commercial Products and Commercial Services	Jan-25	
52.246-09	Inspection of Research and Development (Short Form)	Apr-84	
52.252-02	Clauses Incorporated by Reference	Feb-98	
52.252-06	Authorized Deviations in Clauses	Nov-20	
52.253-01	Computer Generated Forms	Jan-91	
252.203-7000	Requirements Relating to Compensation of Former DoD Officials	Sep-11	
252.203-7002	Requirement to Inform Employees of Whistleblower Rights	Dec-22	
252.204-7000	Disclosure of Information	Oct-16	
252.204-7003	Control of Government Personnel Work Product	Apr-92	
252.204-7008	Compliance with Safeguarding Covered Defense Information Controls	Oct-16	
252.204-7009	Limitations on the Use or Disclosure of Third-Party Contractor Reported Cyber Incident Information	Jan-23	
252.204-7012	Safeguarding Covered Defense Information and Cyber Incident Reporting (DEVIATION 2024-O0013)	May-24	

Clause Number	Title	Date	When Applicable
252.204-7016	Covered Defense Telecommunications Equipment or Services—Representation	Dec-19	
252.204-7017	Prohibition on the Acquisition of Covered Defense Telecommunications Equipment or Services—Representation	May-21	
252.204-7018	Prohibition on the Acquisition of Covered Defense Telecommunications Equipment or Services	Jan-23	
252.204-7019	Notice of NISTSP 800-171 DoD Assessment Requirements	Nov-23	
252.204-7020	NIST SP 800-171 DoD Assessment Requirements	Nov-23	
252.204-7022	Expediting Contract Closeout	May-21	
252.204-7024	Notice on the use of the Supplier Performance Risk System	Mar-23	
252.227-7016	Rights in Bid or Proposal Information	Jan-23	
252.227-7018	Rights in Other Than Commercial Technical Data and Computer Software—Small Business Innovation Research Program and Small Business Technology Transfer Program	Jan-25	
252.227-7019	Validation of Asserted Restrictions--Computer Software	Jan-25	
252.227-7025	Limitations on the Use or Disclosure of Government-Furnished Information Marked with Restrictive Legends	Jan-25	
252.227-7030	Technical Data--Withholding of Payment	Mar-00	
252.227-7037	Validation of Restrictive Markings on Technical Data	Jan-25	
252.227-7039	Patents--Reporting of Subject Inventions	Apr-90	
252.232-7003	Electronic Submission of Payment Requests and Receiving Reports	Dec-18	
252.232-7006	Wide Area WorkFlow Payment Instructions	Jan-23	
252.232-7010	Levies on Contract Payments	Dec-06	
252.235-7010	Acknowledgment of Support and Disclaimer	May-95	
252.235-7011	Final Scientific or Technical Report	Dec-19	
252.243-7001	Pricing of Contract Modifications	Dec-91	
252.244-7000	Subcontracts for Commercial Items	Nov-23	
52.203-03	Gratuities	Apr-84	Exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.203-05	Covenant Against Contingent Fees	May-14	Exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.203-06 or Alt I	Restrictions on Subcontractor Sales to the Government or ALT I	Nov-21	Exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold, Alt I commercial products or commercial services.
52.203-07	Anti-Kickback Procedures	Jun-20	Contracts exceeding $150,000.
52.203-08	Cancellation, Rescission, and Recovery of Funds for Illegal or Improper Activity	May-14	Exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.203-10	Price or Fee Adjustment for Illegal or Improper Activity	May-14	Exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.203-12	Limitation on Payments to Influence Certain Federal Transactions	Jun-20	Contracts exceeding $150,000.

Clause Number	Title	Date	When Applicable
52.204-02	Security Requirements	Mar-21	May require access to classified information; cost contract (see 16.302) for research and development with an educational institution is contemplated.
52.212-04	Contract Terms and Conditions—Commercial Products and Commercial Services	Nov-23	Commercial products or commercial services.
52.212-05	Contract Terms and Conditions Required to Implement Statutes or Executive Orders-Commercial Items	May-24	Commercial products or commercial services.
52.219-14	Limitations on Subcontracting	Oct-22	Set aside for small business and the contract amount is expected to exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.222-35	Equal Opportunity for Veterans	Jun-20	Contracts exceed $150,000.
52.222-37	Employment Reports on Veterans	Jun-20	If contract contains 52.222-35.
52.222-40	Notification of Employee Rights Under the National Labor Relations Act	Dec-10	Exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.222-54	Employment Eligibility Verification	Jan-25	Contracts exceed $150,000.
52.223-03	Hazardous Material Identification and Material Safety Data	Feb-21	Requires the delivery of hazardous materials.
52.229-03	Federal, State, and Local Taxes	Feb-13	A fixed-price contract is contemplated; and the contract is expected to exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.232-02	Payment under Fixed-Price Research and Development Contracts	Apr-84	Fixed Price R&D.
52.233-03	Protest After Award	Aug-96	Exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.242-13	Bankruptcy	Jul-95	Exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.242-17	Government Delay of Work	Apr-84	Supplies other than commercial or modified-commercial products.
52.245-01	Government Property	Sep-21	When property is expected to be furnished.
52.245-09	Use and Charges	Apr-12	When the clause at 52.245-1 is included.
52.246-04	Inspection of Services-Fixed Price	Aug-96	Services, or supplies that involve the furnishing of services, when a fixed-price contract is contemplated, and the contract amount is expected to exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.246-16	Responsibility for Supplies	Apr-84	Supplies, services involving the furnishing of supplies, or research and development, when a fixed-price contract is contemplated, and the contract amount is expected to exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.246-23	Limitation of Liability	Feb-97	Exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.
52.247-34	F.o.b. Destination	Nov-91	When the delivery term is f.o.b. destination.
252.204-7015	Notice of Authorized Disclosure of Information for Litigation Support	Jan-23	Commercial products and commercial services.
252.209-7004	Subcontracting with Firms that are Owned or Controlled by the Government of a Country that is a State Sponsor of Terrorism	May-19	Contracts value of $150,000 or more.
252.211-7003	Item Identification and Valuation	Jan-23	For supplies, and for services involving the furnishing of supplies.
252.223-7001	Hazard Warning Labels	Dec-91	Requires submission of hazardous material data sheets.
252.223-7008	Prohibition of Hexavalent Chromium	Jan-23	For supplies, maintenance and repair services, or construction.

Clause Number	Title	Date	When Applicable
252.225-7001	Buy American and Balance of Payments Program	Feb-24	Acquisition of commercial products and commercial services.
252.225-7002	Qualifying Country Sources as Subcontractors	Mar-22	(i) 252.225-7001, Buy American and Balance of Payments Program. Use if one or more is included: (ii) 252.225-7021, Trade Agreements. (iii) 252.225-7036, Buy American - Free Trade Agreements - Balance of Payments Program.
252.225-7012	Preference for Certain Domestic Commodities	Apr-22	Commercial products and commercial services.
252.225-7052	Restriction on Acquisition of Certain Magnets, Tantalum, and Tungsten	May-24	Products and commercial services, that exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.
252.225-7056	Prohibition Regarding Business Operations with the Maduro Regime	Jan-23	Commercial products and commercial services.
252.225-7060	Prohibition on Certain Procurements from the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region	Jun-23	Products utilizing funds appropriated or otherwise made available for any fiscal year.
252.225-7972	Prohibition on the Procurement of Foreign-Made Unmanned Aircraft Systems (DEVIATION 2024-O0014)	Aug-24	Commercial products and commercial services.
252.225-7967	Prohibition Regarding Russian Fossil Fuel Business Operations (DEVIATION 2024-O0006, Revision 1)	Feb-24	Exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold and for commercial products and commercial services.
252.228-7001	Ground and Flight Risk	Mar-23	Acquisition, development, production, modification, maintenance, repair, flight, or overhaul of aircraft owned by or to be delivered to the Government.
252.228-7005	Mishap Reporting and Investigation Involving Aircraft, Missiles, and Space Launch Vehicles	Nov-19	Acquisition, development, production, modification, maintenance, repair, flight, or overhaul of aircraft owned by or to be delivered to the Government.
252.235-7002	Animal Welfare	Dec-14	Uses live vertebrate animals.
252.235-7004	Protection of Human Subjects	Jul-09	Involving human subjects.
252.243-7002	Requests for Equitable Adjustment	Dec-22	Exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold.
252.245-7003	Contractor Property Management System Administration	Jan-25	Containing the clause at FAR 52.245-1, Government Property.
252.245-7005	Management and Reporting of Government Property	Jan-24	Containing the clause at FAR 52.245-1, Government Property.
252.247-7023	Transportation of Supplies by Sea	Oct-24	Except - those with an anticipated value at or below the simplified acquisition threshold.